TUESDAY
September 1, 2026

DELHI
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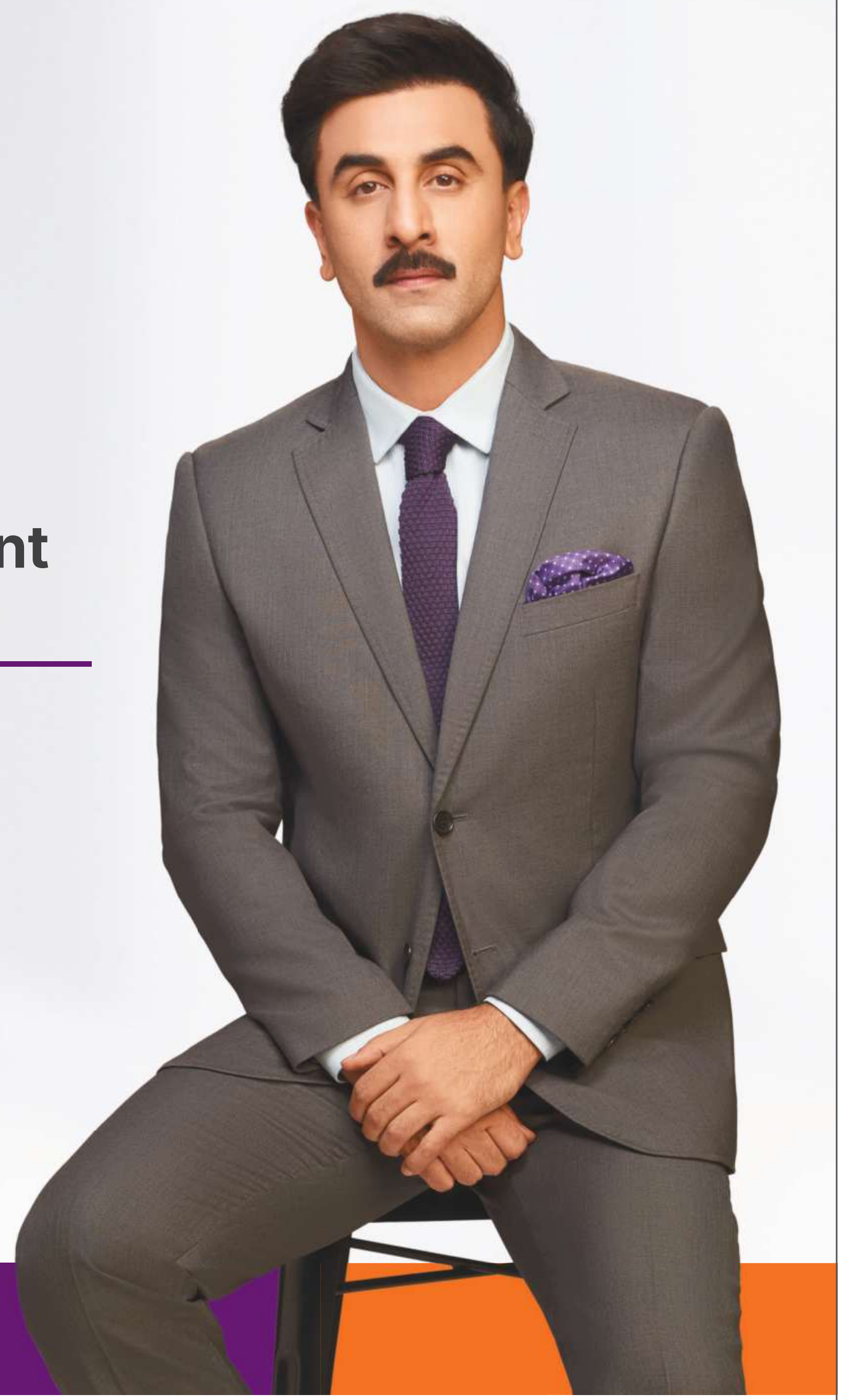

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IN BRIEF

11 killed in blast at firecracker factory in U.P.

LUCKNOW
Eleven people were killed and several injured in a massive explosion at a firecracker factory in Kaushambi district of Uttar Pradesh on Monday. » Page 3

SC Collegium picks new CJ for Rajasthan HC

NEW DELHI
The Supreme Court Collegium on Monday recommended Chhattisgarh High Court judge, Justice Sanjay K. Agrawal, for appointment as the Chief Justice of Rajasthan High Court. » Page 10

Ensure peace, freedom of navigation, PM urges Iran

Modi meets Iran President on sidelines of SCO summit, calls for stability in West Asia; Pezeshkian requests India to use its 'extensive contacts' to help with the dialogue process, blames U.S. for war

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

In the first top-level meeting between Iran and India since the beginning of the war on Iran in February, Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday met Iranian President Masoud Pezeshkian in Kyrgyzstan's Bishkek and urged him to ensure peace and stability in West Asia and freedom of navigation in the Strait of Hormuz.

Mr. Pezeshkian blamed Israel and the U.S. for the conflict and requested Mr. Modi to "use India's extensive contacts with various parties" and help the dialogue process.

After the meeting that took place on the sidelines of the SCO summit, Mr. Modi said on X, "Reiterated our commitment to strengthening India's long-standing friendship with Iran across diverse sectors. We want to expand and diversify our trade basket in the times to come. We had a discussion on the prevailing situation in the region. India will continue to support all efforts aimed at ensuring lasting peace." The Ministry of External Affairs said Mr. Modi called for freedom of navigation and commerce.

"Civilians and civilian infrastructure, including commercial shipping and seafarers must not be harmed under any circumstances," he said.

Mr. Modi said he looked forward to welcoming Mr. Pezeshkian to India for the upcoming BRICS summit.

Strategic meet: Prime Minister Narendra Modi with Iran President Masoud Pezeshkian in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, on Monday. PTI

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PM MEETS PUTIN
» PAGE 11

U.S., Iran trade strikes for first time in weeks

TEHRAN
U.S. President Donald Trump threatened to hit Iran "hard" after the two countries traded fire for the first time in over a month. Late on Sunday, the U.S. said it had carried out strikes on an Iranian island, with Tehran quickly retaliating by attacking U.S. military targets in West Asia. » PAGE 14

Over 6 cr. names deleted so far in third phase of SIR

Sreeparna Chakrabarty
NEW DELHI

As the third phase of the Special Intensive Revision (SIR) of electoral rolls nears its end, more than 6 crore names have been deleted from the voters' registry as per the draft lists published so far.

The third phase was carried out in 16 States and three Union Territories. Draft rolls of all these States have been published, except for Nagaland and Tripura, which will be out on September 20 and October 21, respectively. The rolls for Delhi and Maharashtra were published on Monday.

Out of a total of 36.08 crore names that were on the electoral rolls in these States, 29.93 crore have been retained while 6.15 crore, or 17.04%, have been removed on the draft rolls.

However, the numbers in the final voter lists could be different, as the Election Commission (EC) provides a window for people to submit claims and objections for additions and deletions from the draft, as well as for the registration of new voters.

Steep cuts: Booth Level Officers distributing enumeration forms as part of the SIR of electoral rolls in Hyderabad. G. RAMAKRISHNA

Final rolls

The final rolls will start coming in on September 6, with Mizoram, Sikkim and Manipur set to be the first States to publish their lists.

In the draft rolls, Delhi has the highest deletions in percentage terms, at 32.78%, while Maharashtra saw the most names removed in terms of absolute numbers, at 2.06 crore. Delhi was followed by Dadra and Nagar Haveli, and Daman and Diu for highest percentage of deletions.

CONTINUED ON
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RELATED REPORT ON
» PAGE 2

Manipur Deputy CM, 8 MLAs threaten to walk out of govt.

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Manipur Deputy Chief Minister Losii Dikho has urged the Union government to take punitive measures against fellow Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen for "colluding" with a Kuki insurgent group allegedly involved in the killing of Naga civilians.

Mr. Dikho and eight other Naga MLAs also threatened to pull out of the Bharatiya Janata Party-led government in Manipur if no action is taken against Ms. Kipgen and the leaders of Kuki-Zo extremist groups.

Five of these MLAs, including Mr. Dikho, are from the Naga People's Front (NPF), two are from the BJP, one from the National People's Party, and one is an Independent.

They listed their demands in a letter to Union Home Minister Amit Shah on August 29. "The letter was hand-delivered today [Monday]," Mr. Dikho said.

In the letter, the MLAs demanded the arrest of Kuki-Zo leaders who publicly claimed responsibility for the killing and dismemberment of six Naga civilians, whose mutilated bodies were recovered on June 10 – almost a month after they were abducted.

They also demanded the arrest of Thangboi Kipgen, the head of the extremist Kuki National Front (Presidential) faction and Ms. Kipgen's husband.

"Initiate action against Deputy Chief Minister Nemcha Kipgen as her office is colluding with the Kuki militant group led by her husband Thangboi Kipgen..." the letter from the group read.

CONTINUED ON
» PAGE 10

Gunmen kill 3 Kuki villagers in Kangpokpi

GUWAHATI
Unidentified gunmen on Monday killed three Kuki villagers and injured four others along the same road in Kangpokpi district of Manipur, where four Liangmai Naga civilians were gunned down on August 27. » PAGE 10

After SC refusal to halt CJP march, police seek quashing of FIRs against protesters

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

Within hours of the Supreme Court refusing on Monday to halt a protest march announced by the Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) in central Delhi ahead of the BRICS Summit, the Delhi police moved an urgent plea to quash FIRs registered against students and youth who participated in the NEET-UG paper leak protests.

Days before the BRICS Summit on September 12-13, the CJP decided to hit the streets again on September 5, citing the Centre's failure to live up to its vows, including immediate withdrawal of FIRs against student protesters.

Earlier in the day, a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant found no "compelling circumstance" to interfere with CJP's plans for a protest march.

The Delhi police said it did not wish to pursue FIRs registered after the crackdown on July 20.

Hearing on Sept. 1

In the afternoon, as the Bench was preparing to rise for the day, Solicitor-General Tushar Mehta orally mentioned an application filed by the Delhi police urging the apex court to invoke Article 142 of the Constitution to quash the FIRs. Mr. Mehta pushed for a hearing on September 1 itself.

The Delhi police said it "no longer wished" to pursue the FIRs registered across police stations in central Delhi against students and protesters following the crackdown on July 20. These FIRs had arraigned charges of rioting, attempt to murder, and damage to public property against protesters.

The police expressed willingness to close any other FIRs that were not mentioned in the application. They sought the apex court's permission to file "fresh, specific" FIRs only against 2,873 individuals with criminal antecedents, who were reported to be present at the NEET-UG protest site.

Chief Justice Kant agreed to list the application on September 1, remarking, "If parties are reconciling, we have no difficulties."

The CJI Bench's refusal earlier in the day to intervene came in separate pleas filed by a retired Delhi Police officer, Rajender Singh, and another, who had objected to the announcement of the September 5 protest march.

Appearing for the petitioners, advocate Syed Rizwan Ahmed said to the best of his knowledge, the CJP had not sought permission from either the police or the courts; the decision to march had been announced on social media.

Nepal deaths surge to 939; over 3,900 still missing

Associated Press
KATHMANDU

Rescuers raced to free hundreds of workers believed to be trapped in tunnels at hydropower sites that were buried in mud by catastrophic flooding on the Nepal-China border, as the combined deaths in both countries surpassed 950.

Nepal's disaster agency said on Monday that 939 deaths had been counted in that country, with 3,925 people missing, including 592 foreigners.

The disaster was sparked by a glacial collapse, the U.S. Geological Survey said.

FULL REPORT ON
» PAGE 14

FIR against Rahul exposes BJP's casteist mindset: Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

After the Uttarakhand police registered a case against Congress leader Rahul Gandhi over his remarks on the "purification" ceremony that "insulted" party president Mallikarjun Kharge, the party on Sunday claimed that it "exposed BJP's casteist mindset".

Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal said party workers across the country would take to the streets.

DETAILS ON
» PAGE 11

JU students repaint graffiti whitewashed after CM's warning

Shiv Sahay Singh
KOLKATA

Students of Jadavpur University (JU) on Monday repainted graffiti on the campus that was whitewashed by the university administration after West Bengal Chief Minister Suvendu Adhikari took exception to them. Freshly painted graffiti emerged in the morning, with students claiming it was a bid to "reclaim" the walls of the campus.

One of the freshly painted graffiti "quoted German philosopher Karl Marx", saying, "We have no compassion/And we ask no compassion from you/When our turn comes, we shall not make excuses for the terror." Graffiti quoting Urdu couplets and Vietnamese leader Ho Chi Minh were also repainted.

One of the freshly painted graffiti 'quoting German philosopher Karl Marx' at Jadavpur University on Monday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Several graffiti on the campus were whitewashed on August 29 and 30 after Mr. Adhikari issued a stern warning to wean out "anti-national" elements from the campus. Graffiti in support of Palestine and Maoist leader Kishenji were among those that were whitewashed. The Chief Minister, in a social media post, had highlighted some of them and urged the university administration to take action.

'Political resistance'

Art Against Oppression, a JU student cultural collective that urged students to bring their brushes back to campus, said repainting is both an artistic expression and political resistance.

Vice-Chancellor Chiranjib Bhattacharjee said walls on the campus are the property of the university and he does not "encourage" political graffiti though it has been a tradition at the university. "I request those who are engaging in political graffiti to rethink what is the utility of it in the age of social media. We will also have to look at whether other universities follow such traditions," he said.

The Vice-Chancellor added that the "Reclaim the Wall" call given by the students should not be seen in the same spirit as the "Reclaim the Night" call given by civil society groups after the rape and murder of a woman doctor at the R.G. Kar Hospital in Kolkata in August 2024.

Meanwhile, Communist Party of India (Marxist) State Secretary Mohammad Salim said the wall writings reflected public sentiment and could not be dismissed by simply erasing them. "Read what is written on the walls and understand what people are trying to say. The issue is not whether one agrees with a slogan, but whether people have the freedom to express their grievances and dissent," he said.

JU emerged as a flashpoint after Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad supporters allegedly entered the campus on August 19 and tried to tear posters and burn flags put up by a Left-backed students' union.

The university has been on the boil since then.

BIDDING ADIEU
Messi retires from international football
SPORT » PAGE 15

ECONOMIC PICTURE
GDP growth stands at 7.8% in first quarter
BUSINESS » PAGE 13

SIR draft roll out; 47.56 lakh names deleted

Kejriwal takes a swipe at EC over exclusions; AAP chief must submit proof instead of levelling allegations: Delhi BJP president; Cong. claims denial of info on unmapped voters; 33 lakh voters to be served notices over missing details, anomalies; CEO to be final authority on appeals against deletions

Suruchi Kumari
NEW DELHI

The names of 47.56 lakh (32.78%) voters in Delhi were removed from the draft electoral roll published on Monday. The deletion of names, carried out during the 49-day enumeration phase of the ongoing special intensive revision (SIR) drive, is based on forms that were not returned, said poll officials.

One in three out

The exclusion rate for men in the national capital is 5.38 percentage points higher than that for women

ELECTORAL ROLL AS ON JUNE 16: **1,45,10,299**

Voters in draft roll: **97,53,577** (67.22%)

GENDER-WISE INCLUSION RATE

MEN	WOMEN	THIRD GENDER
49,88,993	47,64,137	447
(64.7%)	(70%)	(43.65%)

EXCLUSION CATEGORIES: ■ Shifted, absent, others: **43,32,775** (91.10%) ■ Deceased: **2,82,412** (5.93%) ■ Duplicate: **1,41,535** (2.97%)

DEADLINES: ■ **September 30:** Claims and objections ■ **October 29:** Disposal of claims and objections ■ **November 4:** Publication of final electoral roll

A Booth Level Officer tallying enumeration forms in New Delhi. SHIV KUMAR PUSHPAKAR

Source: Delhi Chief Electoral Officer

War of words

Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) national convener Arvind Kejriwal took a swipe at the Election Commission (EC) over the deletion of names.

In a post on X, he wrote: "The names of 47 lakh voters are missing. The Government of India is unnecessarily worried about the population. Through SIR, the Election Commission will reduce our country's population from 140 crore to 50 crore."

Delhi Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) chief Harsh Malhotra said, "If Kejriwal believes that any genuine and eligible voter has been left out despite submitting the form, he should present such cases before the EC instead of levelling allegations."

Meanwhile, the Congress's Delhi unit alleged that despite repeated requests, Chief Electoral Officer (CEO) Ashok Kumar's office has refused to share data on unmapped electors and those identified under 'absent', 'shifted', 'dead', 'duplicate' and 'others' categories.

Of the 97.53 lakh voters in the draft roll, over 33 lakh will receive notices because their forms could not be mapped to previous SIR or because they were flagged for various anomalies, including multiple children linked to the same parent; an age gap of under 15 years between parent and child; mismatched names between rolls; and differences in surnames.

The highest number of notices is set to be issued to voters in the North East district (3 lakh), which includes the constituencies of Karawal Nagar, Mustafabad, Gokalpur, and Babarpur, as per data accessed by *The Hindu*.

BLOs to serve notices

A senior official said that from the date of the issuance of the notice, which will carry details such as the reason, time and location of the hearing, the voter will have seven days to reply and seek an extension.

The notices will be delivered by Booth Level Officers (BLOs) while hearings will be conducted by Electoral Registration Officers (EROs) or Assistant Electoral Registration Officers.

Appearance for hearing

The BLOs will go house to house to serve notices, the official said, adding that it is not mandatory for an elector to physically appear for the hearing.

"The notices will carry a QR code where voters can upload the document or send it through the BLO," the official said.

Appeal process

In cases where a person does not appear for a hearing, fails to provide any of the 11 prescribed documents or if their eligibility is in doubt, the ERO will issue an order removing the name and specifying the reasons for it.

Those whose names have been removed can approach the District Election Officer (the first appellate authority), followed by the CEO (the second and final appellate authority).

Records differ on category of names left out

Suruchi Kumari
Aroon Deep
NEW DELHI

Among the documents published by the Delhi Chief Electoral Officer's (CEO) office on Monday, two – the minutes of a meeting between Booth Level Officers and booth-level agents, and a media statement – placed voters whose names had been left out of the draft roll into five categories: 'absent', 'shifted', 'dead', 'duplicate' and 'others'. A third document, also containing details of the voters left out, however, did not contain the 'others' category.

The mismatch is significant because the CEO's office had earlier identified 'others' as electors who did not submit their enumeration forms (EFs) and were marked as 'EF refused'.

However, an analysis of the list of names removed across 14,947 polling booths found no separate category for 'EF refused'.

CM orders sealing of Jaffrabad playschool after 'sexual assault'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Chief Minister Rekha Gupta has directed the District Magistrate to initiate proceedings to seal a private day care and playschool facility in north-east Delhi's Jaffrabad, where a three-year-old boy was allegedly physically assaulted and sexually harassed, the Chief Minister's Office (CMO) said on Monday.

The case came to light when the boy's father filed a complaint with the police on August 28, alleging that his son was repeatedly tied to a chair, slapped and had his ears pulled by a teacher and a staff member inside the classroom. On Sunday, the Delhi police arrested an employee of the facility. A case was registered against the staff member, the school director, principal and a teacher on August 28 under various provisions, including the POCSO Act, at the Jaffrabad police station, a senior police officer said.

The CMO release stated that the government would provide necessary support if the family required legal assistance.

The Directorate of Education has constituted a panel to inquire into the incident, sources say

"The law is taking its course, but the government would not remain a mute spectator to such serious cases," the statement added.

Sources said the Directorate of Education has constituted a committee to inquire into the incident and inspect the school.

'Inquiry on'

Meanwhile, Education Minister Ashish Sood stated in a release that he had taken note of a sexual assault of a three-year-old girl by a bus driver at a private school in Bawana, after the Education Department confirmed that the school was "unrecognised". The accused was arrested on August 24, the same day the incident came to light. "The department has already conducted an inspection of the school premises, and a detailed inquiry is currently under way," he added.

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LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE PRINCIPLE JUNIOR CIVIL JUDGE PENUKONDA
I.A. NO. 363/2022 IN O.S.NO.121/2017
BETWEEN
01.P.Venkatamma
02.P.Thirupalu
03. P.Jaya Chandra
... Petitioners-Plaintiffs
AND
01.Oliver Vanija Privated Ltd., reptd. By Director.
02. K.Ramu
.... Respondents-Defendants
To.
R.1 Oliver Vanija Private Ltd., Regd Office :NO.B.2111/1, Gobind Naar, Ludhiyana, Panjab. Reptd., by its Director, Mr.Munish Sood S/o Armachand Jain, Resident H.No.5-4, Bagh N.M Jain, Ferozpur Road, Ludhiyana, Punjab State.
NOTICE TO RESPONDENT NO.1
Please take notice that the abve petitioners have filed the above final decree petition for the division of their legitimate share confirmed by the Hon'ble court in the preliminary decree and the above final decree petition is posted for your appearance to 23.09.2026 before the above said court. Hence you are directed by the Hon'ble ourt to appear before the above said court on the above said date at 10 AM. In person or through an advocate to express your objections if any , otherwise the above final decree petition will be decided in your absence .
(BY ORDER OF THE HON'BLE COURT)
C.R.NAGARJUNA, M.A., M.L.,
B.SREENIVSULU B.Com,LLB.,
Advocates, Penukonda
Sree Sathya Sai District.
Andhra Pradesh.

LEGAL NOTICE

IN THE COURT OF THE SENIOR CIVIL JUDGE AND J.M.F.C. AT HOSAKOTE
O.S. No. 244/2023
BETWEEN : Narayanappa since died by Lrs And others ...Plaintiffs
AND : Ramesh and others ..Defendants
DRAFT PAPER PUBLICATION
SUMMONS TO DEFENDANT NO. 4 UNDER ORDER V RULE 20 OF C.P.C.
4. M/S A.B. REPHCONS INFRASTRUCTURE PVT. LTD. No. B-7, Anand Nikethan, New Delhi, Represented by its Director Ravi Kanth Jain
Whereas the Plaintiffs have filed the suit for relief of Declaration and Permanent Injunction against you and others and you are hereby summoned to appear before this Hon'ble court on 7.12.2026 either in person or by a duly instructed pleader to answer the claim, failing which the application will be disposed off exparte against you.
SCHEDULE
All that piece and parcel of the land bearing Sy.No. 143/9 measuring 0-10-0 (ten) guntas situated at Hulluru Amanikere Village, Kasaba Hobli, Hoskote Bangalore Rural District bounded as shown in the Sale deeds of the Plaintiffs father Muniyappa on the East by land of Doddamuneppa; West by land of Uthanallappa; North by land of Ururbagil Munishamappa; South by land of Siddalingappa and Pilla Thotadappa and now as shown in the sale deed of fourth Defendant on the East by land of Munellappa and Ganeshappa; West by land of Krishnappa and Muniyappa; North by land of Narayanappa and South by land of Doddaiah and Chikkadoddaiah.
Given under my hand and seal of the court on 29.8.2026.
By order of the Court, Sheristedar, Senior Civil Judge & JMFC, Hosakote.
Advocate for Plaintiffs
K.G. Ramakrishnaiah, Advocate
Upstairs, S.C.F.S. Building, T.G. Extension, Hoskote-562114.

PUBLIC NOTICE

चुनाव सूचना (Election Schedule)

दिनांक: 01/09/2026

अग्रवाल कॉलेज ऑफ लॉ (महिला), बल्लभगढ़ की Governing Body के पदाधिकारियों–प्रधान, उपप्रधान, महासचिव, कोषाध्यक्ष, 11 कार्यकारिणी के सदस्यों (संख्या 01 से 11), 02 शिक्षक प्रतिनिधि एवं 01 गैर–शिक्षक प्रतिनिधि का चुनाव दिनांक 07/12/2026, दिन सोमवार, समय प्रातः 09:00 बजे से सायं 04:00 बजे तक अग्रवाल कॉलेज (तिगांव रोड, नियर– अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ के भवन में होगा। यह चुनाव 3 वर्ष के लिए होगा। चुनाव कार्यक्रम निम्नलिखित है:–

1.कॉलेजियम सदस्य अग्रवाल कॉलेज (मतदाता) सूची का सूचना बोर्ड पर प्रकाशन	दिनांक 23/10/2026, दिन शुक्रवार।
2. नामांकन	दिनांक 13/11/2026, दिन शुक्रवार से 17/11/2026, दिन मंगलवार, समय प्रातः 10:00 बजे से दोपहर बाद 03:00 बजे तक, अग्रवाल कॉलेज (तिगांव रोड, नियर–अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ के कार्यालय में स्वीकार किए जाएंगे, जो निर्वाचन अधिकारी के समक्ष सभा के संविधान के अनुसार भरे जाएंगे।
3. नामांकन पत्रों की जाँच	दिनांक 19/11/2026, दिन गुरुवार से 20/11/2026, दिन शुक्रवार, प्रातः 09:00 बजे से 12:00 बजे तक।
4. नामांकन वापसी	दिनांक 21/11/2026, दिन शनिवार, प्रातः 11:00 बजे से दोपहर बाद 03:00 बजे तक।
5.चुनाव चिह्न आवंटन	दिनांक 23/11/2026, दिन सोमवार, दोपहर बाद 03:00 बजे से सायं 05:00 बजे तक।
6.मतदान की तिथि	दिनांक 07/12/2026, दिन सोमवार, समय प्रातः 09:00 बजे से सायं 04:00 बजे तक अग्रवाल कॉलेज (तिगांव रोड, नियर– अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ के भवन में होगा। तत्पश्चात मतगणना आरम्भ की जाएगी एवं उसी दिन चुनाव परिणाम घोषित किए जाएंगे।

निर्वाचन मंडल संख्या 1 से 102 तक के कॉलेजियम सदस्यों की सूची, संविधान की प्रति प्रत्येक ₹100/– में तथा नामांकन फॉर्म ₹500/– में कॉलेज के कार्यालय (तिगांव रोड, नियर– अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ से प्राप्त कर सकते हैं। तथा Governing Body के प्रत्येक पद–प्रधान, उपप्रधान, महासचिव, कोषाध्यक्ष एवं 11 कार्यकारिणी के सदस्यों (संख्या 01 से 11)–के उम्मीदवार के लिए ₹2,000/– Refundable Security के रूप में जमा कराने होंगे।

विजय कुमार गुप्ता
निर्वाचन अधिकारी

चुनाव सूचना (Election Schedule)

दिनांक: 01/09/2026

अग्रवाल कॉलेज, बल्लभगढ़ की Governing Body के पदाधिकारियों–प्रधान, उपप्रधान, महासचिव, कोषाध्यक्ष, 11 कार्यकारिणी के सदस्यों (संख्या 01 से 11), 02 शिक्षक प्रतिनिधि एवं 01 गैर–शिक्षक प्रतिनिधि का चुनाव दिनांक 07/12/2026, दिन सोमवार, समय प्रातः 09:00 बजे से सायं 04:00 बजे तक अग्रवाल कॉलेज (तिगांव रोड, नियर–अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ के भवन में होगा। यह चुनाव 3 वर्ष के लिए होगा। चुनाव कार्यक्रम निम्नलिखित है:–

1. कॉलेजियम सदस्य अग्रवाल कॉलेज (मतदाता) सूची का सूचना बोर्ड पर प्रकाशन	दिनांक 23/10/2026, दिन शुक्रवार।
2. नामांकन	दिनांक 13/11/2026, दिन शुक्रवार से 17/11/2026, दिन मंगलवार, समय प्रातः 10:00 बजे से दोपहर बाद 03:00 बजे तक, अग्रवाल कॉलेज (तिगांव रोड, नियर–अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ के कार्यालय में स्वीकार किए जाएंगे, जो निर्वाचन अधिकारी के समक्ष सभा के संविधान के अनुसार भरे जाएंगे।
3. नामांकन पत्रों की जाँच	दिनांक 19/11/2026, दिन गुरुवार से 20/11/2026, दिन शुक्रवार, प्रातः 09:00 बजे से 12:00 बजे तक।
4. नामांकन वापसी	दिनांक 21/11/2026, दिन शनिवार, प्रातः 11:00 बजे से दोपहर बाद 03:00 बजे तक।
5.चुनाव चिह्न आवंटन	दिनांक 23/11/2026, दिन सोमवार, दोपहर बाद 03:00 बजे से सायं 05:00 बजे तक।
6.मतदान की तिथि	दिनांक 07/12/2026, दिन सोमवार, समय प्रातः 09:00 बजे से सायं 04:00 बजे तक अग्रवाल कॉलेज (तिगांव रोड, नियर– अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ के भवन में होगा। तत्पश्चात मतगणना आरम्भ की जाएगी एवं उसी दिन चुनाव परिणाम घोषित किए जाएंगे।

निर्वाचन मंडल संख्या 1 से 102 तक के कॉलेजियम सदस्यों की सूची, संविधान की प्रति प्रत्येक ₹100/– में तथा नामांकन फॉर्म ₹500/– में कॉलेज के कार्यालय (तिगांव रोड, नियर–अम्बेडकर चौक), बल्लभगढ़ से प्राप्त कर सकते हैं। तथा Governing Body के प्रत्येक पद–प्रधान, उपप्रधान, महासचिव, कोषाध्यक्ष एवं 11 कार्यकारिणी के सदस्यों (संख्या 01 से 11)–के उम्मीदवार के लिए ₹2,000/– Refundable Security के रूप में जमा कराने होंगे।

विजय कुमार गुप्ता
निर्वाचन अधिकारी

PUBLIC NOTICE

PUBLIC NOTICE
I, SHOBHIT GUPTA SON OF LATE MR. JAI PRAKASH GUPTA RESIDENT OF HOUSE NO. B-41, VIKAS MARG, SWASTHYA VIHAR, DELHI, do hereby declared my father Shri Jai Prakash Gupta was the owner of Shop No 1136 Area Measuring 16.50 Sq. mtrs. and 1137A Area Measuring 16.50 Sq. mtrs Ground Floor Without Roof Rights Situated at Chandni Chowk, Delhi.
That my father expired on 01.05.2021, my mother Mrs. Kavita Gupta expired on 26.04.2021, and the Original Sale Deed of the said property has been lost and not traceable and I have not deposit or mortgage the original sale deed with any bank or private person, if it will be found to any person then any misuse of sale deed is null and void.

TENDERS

TENDER NOTICE
THE ROYAL EMBASSY OF SAUDI ARABIA, NEW DELHI INVITES PROPOSALS FROM COMPETENT SECURITY COMPANIES FOR PROVIDING GUARDING SERVICES TO PREMISES OF THE EMBASSY, THE AMBASSADOR'S RESIDENCE AND THE SAUDI SCHOOL.
Interested companies may collect the tender form, from Gate No. 2 Monday to Friday between 9:00 a.m. to 4 p.m.
EP-30, Chandragupta Marg, Chanakyapuri New Delhi-21
Tel. No.: 011-24102000 (Extn. 1032-1033-1041)
email : inemb@mofa.gov.sa
Submission of bidding (sealed envelope) will be considered within 30 days from : 01.09.2026 to 30.09.2026

TENDERS

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)
FOR CONFIDENTIAL PRINTING WORK
We intend to invite Expression of Interest (EOI) to hire reputed Govt./Private Confidential Printing Agency for a period of 01 year (extendable) for the examination (DTP, designing, printing and supply of question booklets of various subjects along with carbonless OMR answer sheets and related materials for about 20000 candidates in a single sitting).
The agency should be a Company registered under the Companies Act, 1956/LLP Act, 2008; registered for GST with annual average turnover of 20 Crores during last 3 financial years with minimum five years related experience (must have experience for conducting such confidential printing in Govt. / PSU sector for having over 25,000 candidates in a single sitting for at least 3 years). It must have adequate in-house resources to meet the requirement. The Agency or any of its Director should not have been convicted by any Court of law or black listed by any Government concern *(submit all certificates & details etc. as proof)*.
The Interested Agency/Company shall submit the detail proposal along with documents as a single PDF through a dedicated confidential e-mail id i.e. *printereoiconf@gmail.com* latest by *6:00 pm, 10th September 2026.*
Name of Institution shall not be disclosed at any stage by the Agency. The Agencies shortlisted/ qualified on the basis of EOI shall be eligible for participating in further process of bidding through limited tender process and other terms and conditions.
Sd/- Coordinator

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Govt. school student dies; teacher made her stand in sun, alleges kin

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

A 10-year-old girl student of a government school in east Delhi's Vinod Nagar died during treatment after suffering a seizure, with her family alleging days later that she had fallen ill after a teacher made her stand in the sun as punishment for not bringing a book. The teacher has been transferred. However, the police said a preliminary inquiry found no evidence to support the allegation.

According to the police, the girl died on August 27 at the Institute of Human Behaviour and Allied Sciences (IHBAS) in east Delhi, where she had been undergoing treatment for nearly a month after suffering a seizure at school on July 22.

"After she suffered a seizure during school hours, the authorities called her parents and asked them to take her home. She was admitted to IHBAS, where she remained until her death. The family subsequently performed her final rites," a senior police officer said.

The 10-year-old girl had been undergoing treatment for nearly a month after suffering a seizure at school on July 22

Alleged punishment

On Monday, the family approached the school, alleging that the girl had died because of the punishment meted out to her. The school subsequently made a PCR call, following which the police conducted a preliminary inquiry.

"Preliminary verification of the medical and school records indicated that the cause of death was a seizure. We also questioned students and school staff and found no evidence that the girl had been made to stand in the sun. She had a history of epilepsy," the officer said.

The inquiry also found that the parents had neither lodged a complaint nor raised any grievance with the school or the police regarding the incident when it occurred, more than a month before the girl's death, the officer said.

"No case has been registered at this stage since the family is yet to submit a written complaint," he added.

Teacher transferred

In a statement, Education Minister Ashish Sood said the accused teacher had been transferred with immediate effect to ensure that the "investigation was conducted fairly and without interference". "An inquiry is currently under way into the death of the student. If the inquiry establishes any negligence, dereliction of duty or irregularity at any level, strict and decisive action will be taken against those found responsible, in accordance with the law," the Minister said.

AAP stages protest over 'bicycle scam'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on Monday staged a protest near the Delhi Secretariat, accusing the BJP government of an alleged bicycle procurement scam worth ₹40 crore.

"A bicycle is available in the market for ₹4,000. But when the government purchased 1.3 lakh bicycles, it bought each bicycle for ₹7,000. This means the government and the contractor jointly pocketed a commission of around ₹40 crore on the bicycles," AAP Delhi president Saurabh Bharadwaj said.

Responding to the allegations, Delhi BJP spokesperson Praveen Shankar Kapoor said, "To avoid answering questions from his party, Arvind Kejriwal makes 'hit-and-run' allegations against every scheme of the government."

ABVP names 13 probable candidates for DUSU election

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Akhil Bharatiya Vidyarthi Parishad (ABVP) on Monday announced a list of 13 probable candidates for the upcoming Delhi University Students' Union (DUSU) election and began its pre-campaigning exercise across the university.

The probable candidates are Alok Attri, Ayushi Sharma, Ishu Maurya, Krishna Yadav, Lakshya Raj Singh, Nitin Tanwar, Priyanshu Mahamana, Riya Chhawri, Riya Malik, Sunny Dedha, Tanya Mavi, Varun Yadav and Yash Dabas, according to the list released by the ABVP. The candidates will visit 47 colleges and five departments of the university during the week-long pre-campaigning exercise to interact with students and seek their views on issues concerning them, the ABVP said.

Candidates will have to file their nominations by September 10 while the last date for withdrawal is September 11.

CJP march: police step up security, to look out for participants at July 20 stir

Shrimansi Kaushik
Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

The Delhi police have drawn up a multi-layered security plan involving online monitoring, drone surveillance and call-record analysis at sensitive locations ahead of the proposed Cockroach Janta Party (CJP) protest march from India Gate to police headquarters on September 5, an officer said on Monday. The officer reiterated that no permission had been granted for a gathering at India Gate, the police headquarters or the approach routes.

Days before the BRICS Summit on September 12 and 13, the CJP has decided to hit the streets again, alleging that the Centre failed to fulfil its assurances after the Jantar Mantar protest, including on the immediate withdrawal of FIRs against student protesters.

CJP co-convener Saurav Das said, "Delhi Police can continue with their routine work. But, as we have done in the past, our protest marches have always been peaceful. There should be no apprehension this protest will not be peaceful."

Police personnel have been asked to visit the residences of those who participated in the July 20 protest. FILE PHOTO

Focus on gathering

Security personnel will be deployed at Delhi's inter-State borders, the periphery of New Delhi district, India Gate, police headquarters and routes leading to these locations, the officer said, adding that the focus would be on preventing large gatherings and filtering out protesters before they reach the proposed sites.

The Law and Order units across districts have been tasked with identifying Jantar Mantar participants who were flagged through facial recognition systems during the July 20 protest, the officer said.

Police personnel have been asked to visit the residences of those who participated in the earlier protest, issue advisories against participation and document compliance.

Preventive action

Preventive action under Sections 107 and 116 of the Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita (BNSS) is planned against identified organisers, another officer said.

Prohibitory orders under Section 163 of the BNSS are also likely, the officer added. Police will coordinate with the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation and other transport authorities to regulate movement around the protest sites.

App-based services, including food and delivery platforms, are also likely to be suspended within 5-km radius on September 5.

Billboard row: police, fire officials inspect Abhishek's office

Senjuti Sengupta
KOLKATA

A joint team of Kolkata Police and Fire Department officials on Monday visited the Camac Street office of Trinamool Congress (TMC) general secretary Abhishek Banerjee to conduct a fire safety audit and examine the building plan.

The visit came only four days after a team of Kolkata Municipal Corporation (KMC) officials and Kolkata Police visited the premises to remove an electric billboard that led to an alleged clash between the officials and party workers.

Trinamool Congress MP Abhishek Banerjee. FILE PHOTO

'Routine exercise'

Fire Department officials inspected the safety arrangements on the premises on Monday. The officials termed it a "routine exercise" and said the premises would be assessed based on applicable fire safety and building norms.

They added that a few more inspections may be conducted to examine the building plan.

The visit comes amid a political row over Mr. Banerjee's Camac Street office, with the TMC alleging that repeated "actions by the administration were politically motivated".

An alleged scuffle between the TMC leader and KMC officials and the police personnel had erupted on August 27 when the KMC personnel allegedly removed a billboard from a building where the party office is located.

A billboard reading 'All India Trinamool Congress' was put on top of the building located at 9, Camac Street. A large part of the premises serves as the office of Mr. Banerjee.

Blast at U.P. firecracker factory kills 11 people; several feared trapped

Rescue operations under way to evacuate those trapped under the debris in Kaushambi district; blaze brought under control; CM expresses grief, directs officials to provide all possible assistance

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Eleven people were killed and several others injured in a massive explosion at a firecracker factory in Kaushambi district of Uttar Pradesh on Monday.

Several people were feared trapped under the debris, and a rescue operation is under way. Teams of the National Disaster Response Force, State Disaster Response Force, State police, fire brigade, and Air Force personnel were at the site, officials said.

"Information was received about an explosion at a firecracker factory near Manori power house in Pipri police station area. Police and fire brigade teams reached the spot. The fire brigade brought the blaze under control, and rescue operations are under way to evacuate those trapped in the factory," Kaushambi District Magistrate Amit Pal said.

Smoke billowing from the charred remains after an explosion at a firecracker factory in the Pipri area of Kaushambi district on Monday; (right) family members of the blast victims mourning their loss. PTI

7 in serious condition

Seven individuals were rescued from the site in a serious condition and referred to SRN Hospital in Prayagraj for advanced treatment. The fire also damaged nearby structures, with at least four houses located adjacent to the factory collapsing due to the impact of the explosion, officials said.

Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath expressed grief over the incident and directed officials to provide all possible assistance.

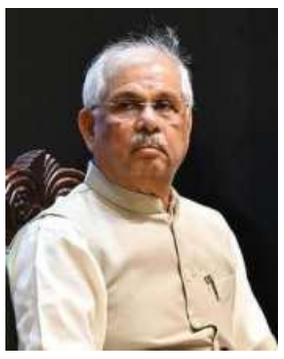
"My condolences are with the bereaved family. A financial assistance of ₹2 lakh each has been provided to the families of those who died in this accident and ₹50,000 each to the injured," Mr. Adityanath said in a post on X.

V-C row: Keralam govt., Governor reach formal settlement

The Hindu Bureau
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

The Keralam government and Governor have reached a formal settlement regarding appointment of Vice-Chancellors (V-C) to the APJ Abdul Kalam Technological University (KTU) and the Digital University Kerala (DUK).

Ending months of protracted legal conflict, both parties informed the Supreme Court of the resolution. Following the consensus, the court disposed of the petitions filed by the Governor, who also serves as the Chancellor of State-run universities, regarding the appointments.


Keralam Governor Rajendra Vishwanath Arlekar

Terms of agreement

The special leave petitions (civil) were concluded by a Bench comprising Justices Aravind Kumar and Vipul M. Pancholi during a special Lok Adalat session '2026 Samadhan Samaroh' on August 23.

Under the terms of the settlement, Ciza Thomas will continue as the V-C of KTU, while Saji Gopinath will continue as the V-C of DUK.

The resolution was achieved through a Pre-Special Lok Adalat conciliation meeting organised by the District Legal Services Authority, Thiruvananthapuram, ahead of the Supreme Court's Lok Adalat session.

Both parties agreed that the current appointments will continue while the broader legal issues and contentions raised in the plea will be left open.

Tejashwi hits out at Bihar govt. over four 'hooch' deaths

The Hindu Bureau
PATNA

Leader of the Opposition in the Bihar Assembly and Rashtriya Janata Dal leader Tejashwi Yadav criticised the State government on Monday over the deaths of four persons in a suspected hooch tragedy at Bedhna village under the Barh police station limits in Patna district on August 30.

Mr. Yadav said the law and order situation has "collapsed completely" and demanded a "thorough inquiry" into the incident. "Why are only poor people losing their lives in such tragedies?" he said.

The deceased were identified as Sashi Kumar, Vikas Ram, Pankaj Singh, and Nishu Kumar.

IAS officer's resignation a serious issue: U.P. Cong. chief to Governor

The Hindu Bureau
LUCKNOW

Uttar Pradesh Congress president Ajay Rai on Monday wrote to Governor Anandiben Patel raising the recent resignation of Divya Mittal, a 2013-batch IAS officer in the State.

He described it as "very serious" issue and said respect for honest officers, their independent and impartial functioning, and an environment free from administrative and political pressure is much needed.

"The resignation letter shared through social media by Ms. Mittal is in the public domain. The officer served the State and public for roughly 13 years and did pro-people work, it is a serious matter," read the letter by Mr. Rai.

'13 resignations'

"Since the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) government came to power, as many as 13 IAS officers have either resigned or taken voluntary retirement. The government should seriously investigate the matter and bring out the truth. If the morale of honest officers is broken, then trust in the system will also be broken," it stated.

The Congress leader urged the Governor to raise the issue with the Union government, so "respect and dignity of honest officers get protected".

Ms. Mittal had on Sunday announced her resignation from the service in a social media post and descibed her 13-year journey as "unforgettable".

CID arrests kingpin in Karnataka PSC 'scam'

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

The Criminal Investigation Department (CID), probing the alleged scam in the recruitment of veterinary officers by the Karnataka Public Service Commission (KPSC), arrested Basavaraj Kannale, reportedly a local BJP leader from Bidar district, on Monday. An alleged key middleman and one of the kingpins in the 'scam', he was arrested from Delhi, sources said.

The arrest comes amid Union Minister H.D. Kumaraswamy targeting Home Minister Priyank Kharge over the alleged scam.

The Congress was already targeting the BJP over the alleged scam, pointing out that KPSC, which is in the dock, was appointed during the BJP tenure.

10-day custody

The CID arrested IAS officer Gnanendra Kumar Gangwar, former Controller of Examination, KPSC, on Sunday. Both Mr. Gangwar and Mr. Kannale were produced before a magistrate court in the city on Monday and remanded in 10-day custody.

Meanwhile, the CID officials conducted searches at two houses linked to Mr. Kannale in Bidar district. The searches were carried out at his residence in Donagapur village and another house in Bhalki town.

Timings
DELHI

TUESDAY, SEP. 01		
RISE	05:59	SET 18:43
RISE	21:01	SET 09:50
WEDNESDAY, SEP. 02		
RISE	06:00	SET 18:42
RISE	21:41	SET 10:54
THURSDAY, SEP. 03		
RISE	06:00	SET 18:40
RISE	22:28	SET 12:02

Delhi Weather	max	min
Delhi City	36	28
Safdarjang	36	28
Palam	34	25

Delhi Palam Today
36°C The weather will be mostly dry. Day will be very warm with uneasy afternoon. Night will be comfortable.

Delhi Palam Tomorrow
36°C The weather will be very warm and uneasy. Night will be comfortable. Short spell of ight rain and thundershower may occur

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NAGPUR METROPOLITAN REGION DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY
Station Road, Kingsway, Sadar, Nagpur-440001.
e-TENDER NOTICE No. 12/2026-27
www.mahatenders.gov.in
Sealed Percentage Rate/Item Rate e-tenders are invited from Non-Registered / Registered Contractors with N.M.R.D.A./ N.I.T. /P.W.D. / N.M.C. or other Govt. Dept. as per eligibility criteria for **One** work. The details of work will be uploaded on tender website i.e. www.mahatenders.gov.in

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Amount of Work / E.M.D. in Rs.	Eligibility / Tender Cost in Rs.	Time Limit in Months	Division
1	**Appointment of Consultant for preparation of Feasibility Study Report, Detailed Project Report and Providing Transaction Advisory Services for Golden Ring Road in Nagpur, Maharashtra State.**	As Per Tender Document 25,00,000/-	As Per Tender Document 25,000/-	06	NMRDA

Money :- E.M.D. is to be paid by online only. **Plans & Estimates :-** Available in the Technical Section, Head Office, Sadar, Nagpur. **Tender Forms :-** From **02.00 P.M.** on Date **03.09.2026** up to **2.00 P.M.** on Date **18.09.2026** on www.mahatenders.gov.in **Receipt / Submission :-** From **02.00 P.M.** on Date **03.09.2026** up to **2.00 P.M.** on Date **18.09.2026** on www.mahatenders.gov.in. **Pre-Bid Meeting :-** On **4.00 P.M.** on Date **07.09.2026** in the office of S.E., NMRDA, Station Road, NMRDA, Head Office, Sadar, Nagpur. **Opening :-** At N.M.R.D.A. Office on Date **21.09.2026** at 2.00 P.M. or as decided by N.M.R.D.A.
-sd- Superintending Engineer,
Advt. No. : S.E.(NMRDA)/34/2026-27 Dated : 31.08.2026 Nagpur Metropolitan Region Development Authority

श्री चित्रातिरुनाल आयुर्विज्ञान और प्रौद्योगिकी संस्थान, त्रिवेंद्रम, केरल– 695 011, भारत
(एक राष्ट्रीयमहत्व का संस्थान, विज्ञान एवं प्रौद्योगिकी विभाग, भारत सरकार)
SREE CHITRA TIRUNAL INSTITUTE FOR MEDICAL SCIENCES AND TECHNOLOGY, TRIVANDRUM, KERALA – 695 011
(An Institution of National Importance, Department of Science and Technology, Govt. of India)
No.DAA/SCTIMST/1/Admission (January 2027)/2026 Dated: 01.09.2026
ADMISSION NOTICE FOR ACADEMIC SESSION JANUARY 2027
Applications are invited for admission to the following academic programs of the Institute.
1. **Post Doctoral Fellowship (PDF – after DM/MCh/DNB)**
2. **Post Doctoral Certificate Courses**
3. **PG Diploma/Diploma/Advanced Certificate Programs.**
4. **PhD Program (Full time & Part time)**

Apply online. Please visit our website for more details **(www.sctimst.ac.in)**.
Online registration will be available for PDF programs from 01.09.2026 to 25.11.2026 (up to 5.00 pm) and for other programs from 01.09.2026 to 30.09.2026 (up to 5.00 pm)
Entrance examination will be held at SCTIMST, Thiruvananthapuram.
Reservation will be followed as per Govt. of India policy.
Payment of Application fee by ONLINE ONLY
For more details contact:
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Sd/- DIRECTOR

APPOINTMENT
V.O.Chidambaranar Port Authority
General Administration Department, Tuticorin
(An Autonomous Body under MoPSW, GoI)
No.GAD-EST10ESTC(EST)/31/2024-GAD(6485)/D. Date:01.09.2026
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1.	Class – I	Chief Engineer	100000-260000

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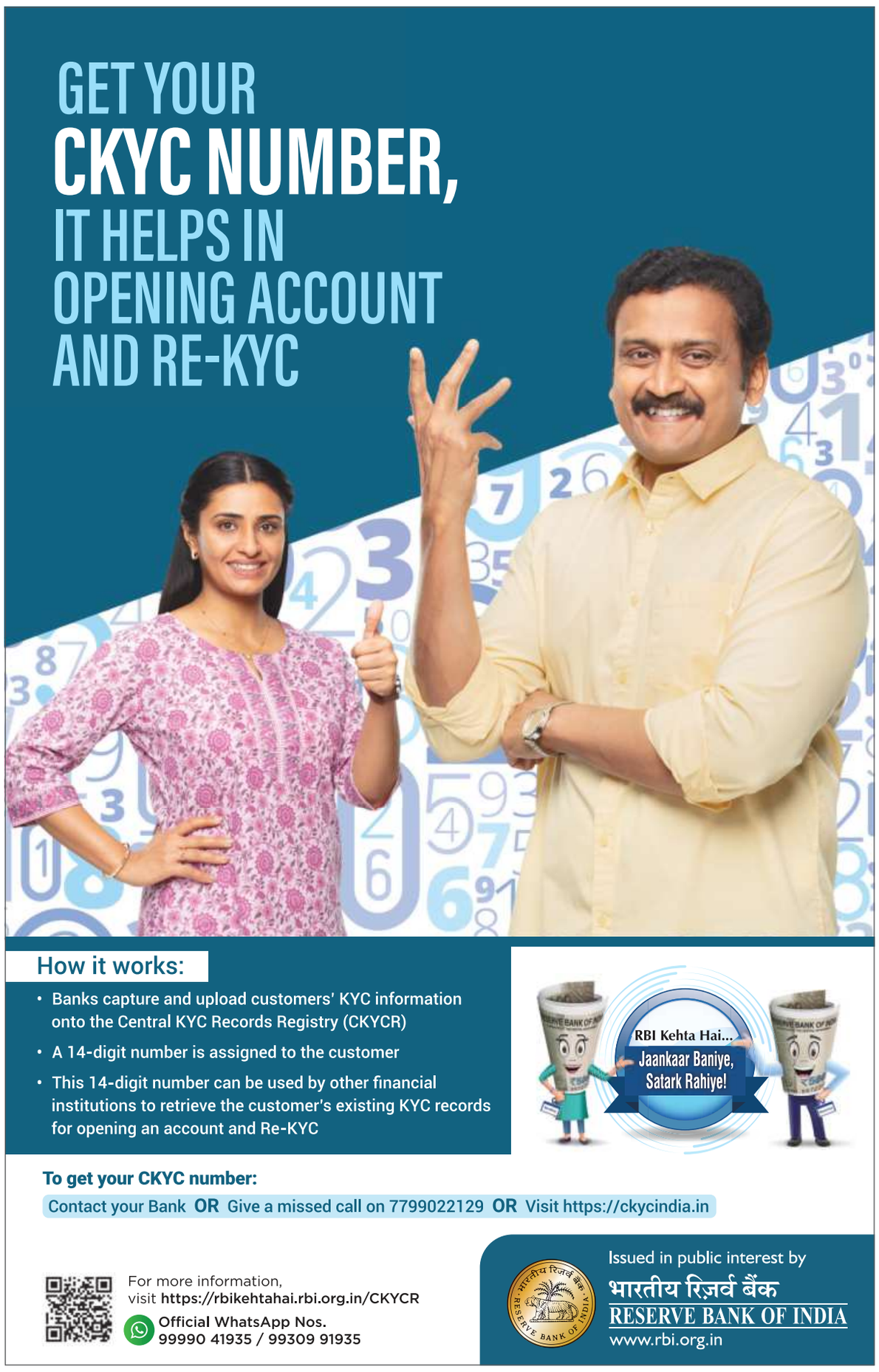
CIN No. U40101UR2001SGC025866 Website: www.ujvnl.com
Letter No: 748 **Date Extension Notice-02** Date: 31/08/2026
Due to unavoidable circumstances, due dates in respect of online Bid Identification No.T-01/EE(Solar)/2026-27 are revised as follows:
Last Date /Time of Receipt of bid on the portal: 07-09-2026 upto 16:00 Hrs.
Last Date /Time of submission of bid in Office :09-09-2026 upto 12:00 Hrs.
Date of opening of the bid on website :09-09-2026 from 13:00 Hrs.
All other details and terms & condition shall remain same. Detail of subsequent addendum/corrigendum/cancelation etc. may be obtained from the website.
Further details can be seen from the e-procurement portal **"http://uktenders.gov.in"**
Executive Engineer (Solar)
"AVOID WASTEFUL USE OF ELECTRICITY"



Green-blue infrastructure and heritage: building a resilient and timeless Delhi

OPINION

Taranjit Singh Sandhu

Lieutenant-Governor of Delhi

A city's greatness is measured as much by what it safeguards as by what it builds. On that count, Delhi has few equals. Its ecological wealth spans the Yamuna and its floodplains, the Ridge, urban forests and biodiversity parks, while its cultural wealth lives on in monuments, historic precincts, and archaeological sites that span centuries.

With the country working towards the Prime Minister's vision of Viksit Bharat 2047, Delhi carries the responsibility of showing how a fast-growing metropolis can pursue development alongside environmental restoration and heritage conservation. The Master Plan for Delhi (MPD) 2047 gives the national capital a framework to put both at the centre of its future.

Nature as core infrastructure

Urban planning today operates under rules that climate change has rewritten. Higher temperatures, extreme rainfall, water stress, worsening air quality, and shrinking biodiversity all bear directly on residents' health and daily lives. Rivers, forests, wetlands, lakes, and parks have moved beyond the status of amenities: they now function as core urban infrastructure.

> Delhi carries the responsibility of showing how a fast-growing metropolis can pursue development alongside environmental restoration and heritage conservation

At the heart of MPD-2047 is a connected green-blue network that draws the Yamuna, the Ridge, forests, biodiversity parks, water bodies, drains, and neighbourhood parks into one ecological system.

Urban forests and green corridors filter the air, cool heat-trapped neighbourhoods, and give native species a place to thrive. Revived water bodies, wetlands, and floodplains recharge groundwater and help the city cope with intense rainfall. Parks, trails, and cycling routes support active living and give communities spaces they can reach. The aim is straightforward: nature should run through daily urban life, not sit apart from it in scattered green patches.

Any picture of Delhi's future is incomplete without the Yamuna. The river has shaped the city's geography and civilisation for centuries, though rapid urbanisation has left its floodplains under unprecedented strain. MPD-2047 puts the Yamuna at the heart of this ecological renewal, proposing to protect, conserve, and ecologically restore close to 1,700 hectares of floodplain.

Pollution is to be addressed where it starts: drains emptying into the river will be intercepted and treated through upgraded sewage infrastructure, constructed wetlands and bioremediation, restoring the river's ecological health, and the floodplain's natural functions.

The ambition extends further than restoration: Delhi has to rebuild its relationship with the river. A planned 52-kilometre cycling corridor, with walking trails, green stretches and organised recreational areas, will bring citizens back to the waterfront, turning revived sections into lively public spaces without compromising their ecology. A restored Yamuna could serve as both an ecological lifeline and a landmark public space.

Standing alongside it is Delhi's other ecological pillar, the Ridge, an extension of the ancient Aravali range. MPD-2047 plans to restore roughly 7,784 hectares of it, guided by native species and scientific ecosystem management. The point is not simply to plant more trees but to build healthier ecosystems that sustain local biodiversity and secure the national capital's environmental balance over the long run.

A living heritage

Delhi's heritage has few rivals among cities. Its forts, monuments, stepwells, archaeological remains, and historic precincts each carry the story of an era that helped shape the city. Modernisation makes protecting this inheritance more urgent, not less. Yet conservation cannot mean preserving buildings and neighbourhoods as if frozen in time. Heritage has to stay a living part of the city, tied to the lives and ambitions of the people who inhabit it.

Under MPD-2047, close to 1,500 heritage assets are to come under Cultural Resource Management Plans, moving conservation from scattered efforts towards a structured, long-term system. Adaptive reuse is central to this: heritage buildings, carefully repurposed as museums, libraries, hotels, offices or cultural venues, stay useful to the city while their historic character remains intact.

A mix of planning and financial incentives, including Transferable Development Rights, façade retention and reasonable relaxation of space standards by the competent authority, subject to fire and life-safety norms, is meant to make conservation economically viable. It should be seen as an opportunity rather than a burden.

Heritage carries economic weight too: well-maintained historic areas draw tourism, create jobs, and open opportunities for local businesses. MPD-2047 proposes heritage, cultural and festival circuits linking monuments, precincts and public spaces, so visitors take in Delhi as a living historical landscape rather than a checklist of monuments. Precincts active around the clock, supported by better public spaces and walkable streets, can sustain local crafts, hospitality, and cultural enterprise.

Real strength

What gives MPD-2047 its real strength is bringing ecological and cultural planning together. Many historic sites sit within or beside forests, water bodies, the Ridge, and the Yamuna landscape. Linking them through greenways, cycling paths, and revived water systems builds a complete urban experience: water bodies as community spaces, green corridors joining neighbourhoods to biodiversity parks, residents cycling beside a restored river, and historic precincts humming with culture and commerce. As India works towards Viksit Bharat 2047, Delhi has to show that development and conservation reinforce rather than oppose each other. A Viksit Dilli cannot measure itself by growth alone. It must breathe easier, live healthier, and honour the heritage that gives it a soul.

INBRIEF

DA row: Punjab govt. transfers protesting employees' leader

The Punjab government on Monday transferred Sukhchain Singh Khera, one of the prominent faces of the employees' protest, from the administrative branch in the Punjab Civil Secretariat to the planning branch in Sector 33. He has now been posted outside the Punjab Civil Secretariat. The move drew criticism from the employees' bodies, which are already demanding that the AAP government accept their various demands, including release of pending dearness allowance (DA). PTI

Vande Mataram directive: Naga students to march to Assembly

The Naga Students' Federation (NSF) called for a demonstration and march to the State Assembly on Tuesday to protest the Centre's directive to compulsory singing of Vande Mataram at government programmes and official functions. The NSF claimed that the complete version of the National Song was not in keeping with the country's secular principles, arguing that its devotional and religious imagery conflicts with the conscience of those belonging to non-Hindu communities. The NSF, in a statement, said that its members would hold a demonstration at Naga Solidarity Park, and then march towards the Nagaland Assembly before the commencement of the Monsoon Session. PTI

Goa govt. stalls plan to table anti-conversion Bill in House amid pushback from within

Minority MLAs mount stiff opposition against move; no instances of forced religious conversions in State and hence no need for such a legislation, says Independent MLA and coalition partner

Press Trust of India
PANAJI

In a U-turn following pushback from legislators from the minority community, the Goa government on Monday decided not to introduce its anti-religious conversion Bill during the ongoing Monsoon Session of the State Assembly.

Chief Minister Pramod Sawant conveyed the decision after a meeting with BJP MLAs Michael Lobo and Delilah Lobo and Independent legislator Aleixo Reginaldo Lourenco on the opening day of the three-day session.

Chief Minister Pramod Sawant conveyed the decision after a meeting with BJP MLAs Michael Lobo and Delilah Lobo and Independent legislator Aleixo Reginaldo Lourenco. FILE PHOTO

Mr. Lourenco, who backs the BJP-led government, said Mr. Sawant assured the legislators that the Goa Prohibition of Unlawful Conversion of Religion Bill, 2026 would not be tabled in the ongoing session. "I had made my stand clear that, if the government tables it, I will oppose it," the Curtorim legislator told reporters.

There was no need for such a legislation in Goa, he asserted, claiming that the government data showed no instances of forced religious conversions in the State.

Strong assurance

Mr. Delilah Lobo, who attended the meeting, also confirmed that the government would not introduce the Bill in the House.

The development comes days after the State Cabinet approved the proposed legislation, which seeks to prohibit religious conversions allegedly carried out through force, coercion, undue influence, allurement, fraudulent means or marriage.

It proposes stringent punishment, including imprisonment of up to life, a minimum fine of ₹50,000 and compensation of up to ₹5 lakh for victims. The Bill also stated that a marriage could be declared void if it was found to have been solemnised solely for unlawful conversion. It prescribed enhanced punishment in cases involving minors, women, persons with disabilities or mental illness, and members of Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes.

The Bill had sparked opposition from the Congress and Aam Aadmi Party, who had argued that it could create communal disharmony in Goa.

Questions need for law

Christian organisations said they opposed forced or fraudulent conversions but questioned the need for a separate law, arguing that such acts were already punishable under existing criminal laws.

According to government data presented in the Assembly earlier this year, four cases of "illegal" religious conversion or attempts were registered in Goa between 2021 and 2025 – two each in 2022 and 2023 – with no such cases recorded in 2021, 2024 and 2025.

U.P. govt. to appoint Gen Z reel makers as cultural ambassadors

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

The Uttar Pradesh government on Monday announced a campaign to engage Gen Z content creators to promote tourism under the 'Visit My State Uttar Pradesh' campaign. It has invited participants to share 60-second reels showcasing what makes their city special. The winners will be appointed cultural ambassadors of their cities.

Gen Z is increasingly shaping digital culture, said the State Tourism Dept. FILE PHOTO

"As Gen Z increasingly shapes digital culture and travel discovery, the government is looking to give young residents a new role as cultural ambassadors. From heritage, culture, food and traditions to people, hidden gems and unique experiences, the campaign seeks to highlight destination stories through those who know these places closely," read a statement by the Tourism Department.

The government said the choice of reels reflects a wider change in how younger audiences discover destinations.

"Short videos, personal recommendations and creator voices increasingly shape travel conversations, helping established attractions and local experiences reach wider audiences.

The campaign seeks to direct this digital interest towards local culture, tourism and pride in one's city," it added.

Culture, traditions

"A resident of Lucknow, for instance, can speak about its cuisine, *chikankari*, old neighbourhoods or cultural spaces, just as participants from Braj, Bundelkhand, Purvanchal and the Terai can showcase traditions and experiences from their own cities," the Tourism Department said.

It added, "By using a format familiar to young digital users, the government aims to make tourism promotion more participatory and bring local stories into wider circulation."

Bihar Minister will be expelled from LJP(RV) if charges true: Chirag

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

JJD leader Tej Pratap Yadav had demanded a probe into the allegations against Sanjay Singh

Lok Janshakti Party (Ram Vilas) [LJP(RV)] national president and Union Minister Chirag Paswan on Monday responded to allegations against party MLA from Mahua and Bihar Minister Sanjay Kumar Singh.

A day after Janshakti Janata Dal (JJD) leader Tej Pratap Yadav demanded a probe into the allegations, the LJP(RV) chief said he would expel Mr. Singh from the party and "strictest action" would be taken against him if the "very serious" allegations are found to be true. The party has sought an explanation from Mr. Singh, he said.

Mr. Yadav had claimed on X that the State Minister allegedly behaved indecently with a woman and attempted to exploit her in a Delhi hotel. The incident was allegedly "hushed up" with a payment of about ₹25 lakh, he added.

Meanwhile, Mr. Singh has sent a legal notice to the JJD leader seeking an unconditional apology and ₹50 crore in damages for making "false" allegations against him on social media. He has sought a response within seven days.

Kanthapuram's directive on women triggers row in Keralam

Abdul Latheef Naha
MALAPPURAM

A recent directive by veteran Sunni leader Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar on Muslim women's participation in public religious celebrations has triggered a political controversy in Keralam and opened a fresh rift between his group and the Communist Party of India (Marxist) [CPI(M)].

Mr. Kanthapuram, general secretary of the Samastha Kerala Jamiyyathul Ulama and Grand Mufti of India, in the circular asked mahals (local social units in the Muslim community) and madrasas under Samastha to ensure that religious programmes follow Islamic norms.

The circular also asked them to prevent women from sharing stage or public space with unrelated men during religious celebrations. It advised against incorporating customs from other cultures into Islamic festivals. Mr. Kanthapuram later reiterated the position at a meeting in Kochi. He said women should remain at home and argued that their entry into the public sphere could lead to "chaos". He cited purdah as a means of preventing such problems.

Drawing flak

The remarks drew criticism from CPI(M) leaders and women's organisations. CPI(M) Central Committee member P.K. Sreemathy called for the withdrawal of the circular while former Minister K.K. Shailaja said keeping women confined to homes was a "feudal practice".

All India Democratic Women's Association leader C.S. Sujatha and Students Federation of India (SFI) State secretary P.S. Sanjeev also criticised the directive. Former Minister A.K. Balan said the CPI(M) would oppose Mr. Kanthapuram's position even if the Prophet himself came and made such a statement. State Women and Child Development Minister and Congress leader Bindhu Krishna said such views could push women "centuries back" and stressed their constitutional right to participate in public life. State Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala also said he did not support restricting women in public spaces.

Sunni leader Kanthapuram A.P. Aboobacker Musliar. FILE PHOTO

Defending remarks

The criticism has drawn a strong response from the Kanthapuram faction. Sunni Yuvajana Sangham State general secretary Rahmathulla Saqafi Elamaram defended the directive in an article in *Siraj*, the mouthpiece of the Kanthapuram Sunni faction.

Mr. Elamaram said the directive concerned the internal religious practices of Muslims and was not a restriction imposed on society as a whole. He said Islamic celebrations had a spiritual purpose and that young men and women singing and dancing together could shift the focus towards entertainment. He also rejected the charge that Mr. Kanthapuram's position was anti-woman. The article turned directly against the CPI(M), questioning the intervention of Ms. Sreemathy and Ms. Shailaja and accused them of showing "selective concern" for Muslim women.

Mr. Elamaram also accused the Democratic Youth Federation of India and SFI activists of using the controversy to divert attention from an internal dispute within the Left Democratic Front over the Assembly post of Deputy Leader of the Opposition.

The exchanges mark a departure from the long political and social association between Mr. Kanthapuram and the CPI(M). His associates have asked CPI(M) leaders not to interfere in religious matters. The CPI(M) has continued to frame the issue as one of women's rights and public participation. The dispute has moved beyond the wording of the circular to a wider argument over religious autonomy, gender rights and the meaning of progressive politics.

IUML takes no position

The Indian Union Muslim League (IUML) has not taken a public position on the directive. Local Administration Minister K.M. Shaji declined to comment on the issue. The row has remained largely an exchange between the Kanthapuram faction and CPI(M) leaders and organisations, with no major public challenge from the IUML or other Muslim groups.

Meanwhile, the Kerala Muslim Jamaat district committee has slammed Ms. Sreemathy and Youth Congress leader Jinto John for social media posts criticising the circular.

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Keralam CM orders SIT to probe Messi event row

G. Anand
THIRUVANANTHAPURAM

Keralam Chief Minister V.D. Satheesan on Monday directed the Home Department to constitute a special investigation team (SIT) for a anti-corruption and suspected tax fraud inquiry into the previous Left Democratic Front (LDF) government's endeavour to bring the 2021 FIFA World Cup-winning Argentina team and its captain, Lionel Messi, for a friendly exhibition match at the Jawaharlal Nehru Stadium in Kochi in August 2025.

Officials told *The Hindu* that Mr. Satheesan sent a letter to Home Minister Ramesh Chennithala flagging the findings of the Finance department's recently concluded inquiry into the suspected GST evasion on foreign remittances made by the sponsor, a news broadcasting company, ostensibly to secure the presence of Messi and his famed team.

According to them, the inquiry found that the sponsoring firm had wire transferred ₹126 crore to a foreign entity through banking channels in 2025. It concluded that the transaction triggered a service tax obligation of €22.68 crore to the exchequer.

Officials said Mr. Satheesan also ordered the Home Department to probe the suspected conspiracy to defraud the treasury. The Finance department inquiry faulted GST officials for putting the brakes on holding the sponsor to account for suspected tax evasion.

CWMA water-release order being enforced: Karnataka

State says it is implementing the order to ensure a flow of 9,000 cusecs of Cauvery water to T.N.; Karnataka's present compliance does not address accumulated shortfall, T.N. tells Supreme Court

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Karnataka government on Monday told the Supreme Court that it was complying with the Cauvery Water Management Authority's (CWMA) direction to ensure a flow of 9,000 cusecs of water to Tamil Nadu.

On August 25, the CWMA had upheld the Cauvery Water Regulation Committee's (CWRC) recommendation directing Karnataka to ensure a flow of 9,000 cusecs to Tamil Nadu for 15 days.

Appearing for Karnataka, senior advocate Shyam Divan said the State had released 9,888 cusecs on August 30, against the required 9,000 cusecs, while the flow had crossed 11,000 cusecs by Monday morning. "We have released an excess amount as of 8 a.m. this morning," Mr. Divan said, adding that Karnataka would endeavour to maintain the required flow of 9,000 cusecs.

Water shortage: A view of the dried Cauvery river at Tiruchi district of Tamil Nadu on August 29. M. MOORTHY

In an application filed on Sunday, Tamil Nadu had sought a direction to Karnataka to release 17.604 tmc ft of water, which it claimed was the balance due as of August 27 under the pro-rata formula.

On Monday, senior advocate C.S. Vaidyanathan, appearing for Tamil Nadu, contended that Karnataka's present compliance with the 9,000-cusec requirement did not address the accumulated shortfall in earlier releases.

The Bench pointed out that if Tamil Nadu sought water over and above what the CWMA had directed, the authority's decision would have to be challenged before the appropriate forum.

The court posted the matter for further hearing on September 15.

Karnataka HC quashes land acquisition for KHB project

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

In a major setback to the State government, the High Court of Karnataka has quashed the acquisition of 1,938 acres of land for the Karnataka Housing Board's (KHB) ambitious Suryanagar 4th phase residential layout project. The court held that the land is part of areas proposed to be declared as eco-sensitive zone (ESZ) of the Bannerghatta National Park (BNP) besides abutting elephant corridors.

A Division Bench comprising Justice D.K. Singh and Justice H. Shanthi Bhushan passed the order on August 29 while setting aside a single judge's January 2025 verdict.

Ankit Balyan murder: 2 suspects killed; father seeks 'complete justice'

Mayank Kumar
LUCKNOW

Two alleged sharpshooters involved in the murder of Haryanvi singer Ankit Balyan were killed in an encounter with a Special Weapons and Tactics (SWAT) team and police personnel from Shamli district, the Uttar Pradesh police said on Monday. The two men, identified as 24-year-old Sumit and 22-year-old Mohit, carried a reward of ₹50,000 each. A search for the other two accused is under way, said the police.

The singer's father welcomed the development and said the killing of the other two accused would bring the family "complete justice".

Police personnel along with kin of singer and YouTuber Ankit Balyan in Shamli, on Monday. PTI

Balyan was shot dead outside his gym in Shamli by four motorcycle-borne assailants on August 26

"Mohit and Sumit were injured by gunfire during retaliatory firing by the police in self-defence," read a statement issued by the police. It added that they were taken to Shamili Joint Hospital, where the two died during treatment.

Man held for rape, murder of nurse

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

The Hyderabad police arrested a 34-year-old man in connection with the alleged rape and murder of a 21-year-old nurse at Thukkuguda.

The accused was identified as Md. Sanaullah, a native of Begusarai district in Bihar who worked as a bike mechanic and stayed at a shop near the hospital, where the victim worked. According to the police, the woman's aunt lodged a complaint on August 29 after the victim's friend informed her that the woman had not come out of her room since morning. She was found dead with bleeding injuries on her face.

The police said their investigation, supported by technical evidence and specific information, led them to Sanaullah, who was apprehended on the evening of Sunday, within 30 hours of receiving the complaint. A mobile phone and clothes of the accused were seized.

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Rattan Lal alias Ratto S/O Hans Raj R/O Salote Billawar Kathua is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 234/1996 U/S 379 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Rattan Lal alias Ratto
S/O : Hans Raj
Address : Salote Billawar Kathua
Age : 40-45 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East : 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP/J- 9088/26, Aug 31 2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Ranjeet Singh alias Soni S/O Mohan Singh R/O House No. 14, Sector No. 03, Trikuta Nagar, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 204/2008 U/S 382/34 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.

It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-
Name : Ranjeet Singh alias Soni
S/O : Mohan Singh
Address : House No. 14, Sector No. 03, Trikuta Nagar, Jammu
Age : 40-45 Years

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East : 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133

Sr. Superintendent of Police
Jammu

DIP/J- 9090/26, Aug 31 2026

STATE INFRASTRUCTURE & INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT CORPORATION OF UTTARAKHAND LTD.
Regional Office : 5th Floor, Pentagon Mall, IIE, SIIDCUL, Haridwar
Phone No : 01334-235010, Website : www.siidcul.com

Notice Inviting Tender (E-Tendering)

SIIDCUL invites separate online bids from eligible bidders through e-tendering for the below mentioned works at IIE Haridwar and SIDC bahadrabad, Uttarakhand. Bids are invited through a single-stage single-envelope system. All the Tender-related information will be available on **www.uktenders.gov.in & www.siidcul.com** from 01.09.2026. The tender details are given below:-

S.N.	Description of Work	No. of Tenders /Works	Time Line
1.	Maintenance of drain, kerbstone and footpath at IIE SIIDCUL, Haridwar	01	**Bid Start Date 01.09.2026**
2.	Maintenance of roads by patchwork and repair of drains at SIDC Bahadrabad, Haridwar	01	
3.	Selection of agency for cleaning, sanitation and maintenance services of roads, drains, green areas and supply of manpower for functioning of street lights, pump house and tubewell of IIE-Haridwar and SIDC Bahadrabad.	01	**Last Date 14.09.2026**

Regional Manager

GOVERNMENT OF PUNJAB TENDER NOTICE

SR. NO.	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK/ NOTICE/ TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT/ EMD (APPROX.) IN LACS	NODAL OFFICER / CONTACT / EMAIL
1.	Director Technical Education and Industrial Training Punjab Chandigarh	Supply of Desktop Computer in different Central Jails. For detailed information visit website http://eproc.punjab.gov.in	01/09/2026 10/09/2026	8.00 Lac	9888337415 machinery.dit@punjab.gov.in
	FOR FURTHER INFORMATION AND CORRIGENDUM & ADDENDUM IF ANY, KINDLY VISIT: https://eproc.punjab.gov.in/, www.punjabitis.gov.in				**RO Number: 1001/12/2026-27/14721**

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(A Government of Karnataka Undertaking)
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Bengaluru-25. Ph : 080-25584103
Email: eecontractksphc@gmail.com Website: www.ksphc.org

No. EE/KSPH&IDCL/CNT/TND/02/2026-27/09/120 Date : 31.08.2026

SHORT TERM NOTICE INVITING TENDER

KSPH & IDCL invites online tender as per KTPP 2000 Act & as per Standard Tender Document through KPP Portal **https://kppp.karnataka.gov.in** for the below works.

Sl. No.	Name of the works
1	**Construction of PC Quarters under Police Gruha - 2025 Phase - VI at Various Locations in Karnataka.**

Interested eligible Contractors may participate in the tendering process. The details such as Tender Fee, EMD, Tender documents etc., are available on KPPP from **03.09.2026 onwards**
"KSPH & IDCL reserves the right to accept or reject any or all Bid without assigning any reasons".
Note : Henceforth any changes / modifications in the tender will be updateed only on KPPP.

Sd/-
DIPR/CP/YC/2498/2026-27 **Executive Engineer-Contracts**

NANAJI DESHMUKH VETERINARY SCIENCE UNIVERSITY, JABALPUR (M.P.)
ONLINE COUNSELLING NOTICE FOR ADMISSION IN B.V.SC. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. (2026-27)

No. 3252F/Vety./2026 Date: 31/08/2026

The 1st round of online counselling for admission in Bachelor of Veterinary Science and Animal Husbandry (B.V.Sc. & A.H.) (5½ years) and Bachelor of Fishery Science (B.F.Sc.) (4 years) for the session 2026-27 will start from **03/09/2026** on the basis of NEET(UG)-2026 merit. The details will be available on website **www.ndvsu.org** /portal **https://ndvsu.mponline.gov.in** The information about next rounds of counselling will be available in above mentioned websites. Corrigendum, if any, will be available in above websites, no separate press notice will be issued

Registrar

THE HINDU
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GST Regn No 22AABCM6288N5ZY,
Phone: 0771-6621000, Fax: 0771-2583794
Website: www.csidc.in, Email address: csidc.cg@gov.nic.in, csidc_raipur@yahoo.com

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL (RFP) (2nd Call)
(Through e-Procurement Portal Only)

CSIDC/Flat.Fac./RFP/03(01)/2026 **Raipur, Dated 27/08/2026**

Chhattisgarh State Industrial Development Corporation (CSIDC) a Government of Chhattisgarh Undertaking constituted under the Companies Act, 1956 engaged in Industrial Infrastructure Development & Other Related Activities in the State envisages to develop **"Flatted Factory"** at Bhilai, Chhattisgarh.

"Request for Proposal" (RFP) is for planning designing, financing, construction, development, marketing, operation & maintenance of proposed **"DEVELOPMENT OF FLATTED FACTORY UNDER PUBLIC PRIVATE PARNTERSHIP (PPP) MODE IN DBFOT MODEL AT AGRICULTURE IMPLEMENT FACTORY BHILAI (CHHATTISGARH)"** on leasehold as is where is basis.

Land	Area of land (in Acre/SQM)
Agriculture Implement Factory, Bhilai	4.51 Acres (approx.) (Leasehold on as is where is basis)

The RFP document containing detailed terms & condition, scope of work and other details is available for download from the web portal (website) **https://eproc.cgstate.gov.in** and shall be submitted online only Amendment in tender, if any, will only be uploaded on the website and shall not be published in any newspaper.

NOTE: The interested tenders for online submission of tender may contact CG e-Proc Helpdesk, Operated by Mjunction Servies Limited. they may reach Helpdesk using 18004199140 (from 9 AM to 11 PM) (therein press 2 for CG e-Proc) or you can email them at Helpdesk **eproc@cgswan.gov.in**.

Tenderer may contact to General Manager, CSIDC (Mob. No. +91 7697230751) Udyog Bhawan in working hours on working days to clear their doubts if any before online submission of the tender.

S-48904/3 **Managing Director**

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA - DEPARTMENT OF WATER RESOURCES
OFFICE OF THE CHIEF CONSTRUCTION ENGINEER, KANUPUR IRRIGATION PROJECT
AT/PO-BASUDEVPUR, DIST-KEONJHAR, ODISHA, PIN-758047
e-mail: ccekipbpur@gmail.com

"e"- PROCUREMENT NOTICE - Bid Identification No.: CCE, KIP (KCD-I)-08/2026-27
(Pertaining to Kanpur Canal Division-I, Jhumpura)

1.	Name of the Work	As per Detailed Tender Call Notice
2.	Total No. of Package	03 (Three Nos. of Work)
3.	Estimated Cost	Rs.191.69 Lakh to 654.23 Lakh
4.	Period of completion	As per Detailed Tender Call Notice
5.	Class of Contractor	"B" or "A" or "Special" Class as per Detailed Tender Call Notice
6.	Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal	Dt.02.09.2026 from 10.00 Hours to Dt.17.09.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
7.	Last date / Time for receipt of bids in the portal	17.09.2026 up to 17.00 Hours.
8.	Date & Time of Opening of Tender (Technical Bid)	18.09.2026 at 11.00 Hours
9.	Name and address of the Officer Inviting Bid	(Er. Mahendra Kumar Behera) Chief Construction Engineer, Kanupur Irrigation Project, At/Po.- Basudevpur, Dist.- Keonjhar, Odisha - 758047.

Further details can be seen from the e-Procurement portal **"https://www.tendersodisha.gov.in"**
(Er.Mahendra Kumar Behera)
Chief Construction Engineer,
Kanupur Irrigation Project, Basudevpur, Keonjhar, Odisha
32001/775/2627 OIPR-32001/32376/1/26-27/0005

SOUTH EAST CENTRAL RAILWAY
TENDER NOTICE FOR MISCELLA -NEOUS TRANSFORMER WORKS

Tender No. TRD-BSP-317-26-27-11. Dtd: 14.08.2026
Work: Dismantling, shifting, erection, testing & commissioning of 21.6/30.24 MVA, TELK, Kerala Make Power Transformers from BPH TSS to BSP TSS.
Tender Value : ₹ 23,81,266.33/-. EMD : ₹ 47,600.00/-. Submission of Tender: Up to 15:00 hrs. on 07/09/2026.
For further details/ purchase of Tender document, eligibility criteria & the complete details for the above works, please contact Office of the Sr.DEE/TRD/SECR/Bilaspur or refer/download Tender document which is available on our website: **www.ireps.gov.in**.

Divl. Elect. Engineer (TRD)
CPR/10/356 **S.E.C. Railway, Bilaspur.**
South East Central Railway @secrail

HIMACHAL PRADESH PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
e-Procurement Notice
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The **Executive Engineer, HPPWD Jubbal, Distt. Shimla**, H.P. on behalf of Governor of H.P. invites the online bids on percentage rate, in electronic tendering system, in 2 Cover System of the under mentioned work from the eligible and approved contractors / firms registered with HPPWD Department

Sr. No.	Name of Work	Estimated Cost	Earnest Money	Cost of Form	Time
1.	Construction of Indoor Stadium at Government Collage Sarswatinagar, Tehsil Jubbal, Distt, Shimla HP(SH:-Construction of building portion, providing WS & SI, Septic Tank, Rain Water Harvesting tank & electrical installation etc.	116025780/-	2320500/-	20000/-	18 Months

Tender document and other instruction scan be downloaded or viewed online from the portal https://hptenders.gov.in by the firm / individual registered on the website which is free of cost. **Key Dates:-**

1.	Date of Online Publication	27-08-2026 15:00 HRS
2.	Document Download Start and End Date	27.08.2026 15:30 HRS upto 08.09.2026 18:00 HRS
3.	Bid Submission Start and End Date	27.08.2026 15:30 HRS upto 08.09.2026 18:00 HRS
4.	Physical Submission of EMD and Cost of Tender Document	Online Mode
5.	Date of Technical Bid Opening,	09.09.2026 11:00 HRS
6.	Evaluation of Technical Bid followed by Opening of Financial Bid	Date to be announced

Executive Engineer, (B&R) Division HPPWD, Jubbal.
HP / 3046/26-27 On behalf of Governor of Himachal Pradesh

HIMACHAL PARDESH
PUBLIC WORKS DEPARTMENT
INVITATION FOR BIDS (IFB)

The Executive Engineer HP.PWD., Division Nadaun District Hamirpur H.P on behalf of Governor of H.P invites the Percentage rate bids, in electronic tendering system from the eligible class for the works as detailed below on the table below:-

Sr. No.	Name of work	Estimated Cost in lacs	Starting Date for download-ing Bid	EMD (Rs.)	Deadline for submission of Bid
1.	Construction of Community centre for skill Up-gradation in Sports Discipline near the State Excellence Centre Nadaun at Kharidi, District Hamirpur (HP). Part-I: Civil Work (SH:- i.e. building portion i/c WS & SI, Septic Tank & Soak Pit, Rail water Harvesting Tank, Site Development, Boundary Wall etc.) Part-II (Electrical work) (SH:- Providing E.I., Fire Fighting System, Fire Alarm System, DG set, CCTV Surveillance system therein.. Time Limit:- Twelve Months Cost of tender form: 10000/-	70365199/-	27-08-2026 from 10:30 AM	1407400/-	03-09-2026 upto 10:30 AM

The bidders are advised to note other details of tenders from the department website.

Executive Engineer,
Nadaun Division,
HPPWD, Nadaun.
Pin Code 177033
Telephone No. 01972-298570
e-mail: ee-pwdndn-hp@hp.gov.in
On behalf of Governor of Hima,chal pradesh.

HP / 3072/26-27 **him suchna avam jan sampark**

Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board
Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010
Website : https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in, e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com

Advt. No. :–JCECEB/46/26- 74 ,Ranchi/Dated: 31/08/2026
Indicative information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to B.D.S. course
PRESS COMMUNIQUE

In compliance of direction issued by Medical Counselling Committee, New Delhi on 27.08.2026 regarding NEET-UG Schedule – 2026 for Round-2 of State Counselling, the Board will hold 2nd (Second) Round of Online Counselling for **vacant 60% seats earmarked for qualified students from across the country (All India Quota) & 15 % seats earmarked for NRI supported students (NRI Quota) in** B.D.S. course **in Vananchal Dental College and Hospital, Garhwa under Babu Dinesh Singh University, Garhwa.**

The Detailed information in regards with above is available in the Press Communique titled **"Important Information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to M.B.B.S., B.D.S. & B.H.M.S. Courses"** uploaded under the **"Important Notice"** section on the Board's website: http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in

By the order of Controller of Examination
Sd/-
(Officer on Special Duty)

PR 388713Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board (26-27)#D

Govt. of Jharkhand
Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board Science & Technology Campus, Sirkha Toli, Namkum-Tupudana Road, Namkum, Ranchi – 834010
Website : https://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in, e-mail : jceceboard@gmail.com

Advt. No. :–JCECEB/46/26- 75 ,Ranchi/Dated: 31/08/2026
Indicative information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to M.B.B.S. course
PRESS COMMUNIQUE

In compliance of direction issued by Medical Counselling Committee, New Delhi on 27.08.2026 regarding NEET-UG Schedule – 2026 for Round-2 of State Counselling, the Board will hold 2nd (Second) Round of Online Counselling for **vacant 60% seats earmarked for qualified students from across the country (All India Quota) & 15 % seats earmarked for NRI supported students (NRI Quota) in** M.B.B.S. course in Laxmi Chandravansi Medical College & Hospital, Palamu; Netaji Subhas Medical College and Hospital, Seraikela-Kharsawan; Sido Kanhu Medical College & Hospital, Dumka and Birsa Institute of Medical Sciences & Research Khunti.

The Detailed information in regards with above is available in the Press Communique titled **"Important Information regarding Revised Schedule for 2nd (Second) Round of online counselling for admission to M.B.B.S., B.D.S. & B.H.M.S. Courses"** uploaded under the **"Important Notice"** section on the Board's website: http://jceceb.jharkhand.gov.in

By the order of Controller of Examination
Sd/-
(Officer on Special Duty)

PR 388714 Jharkhand Combined Entrance Competitive Examination Board(26-27)#D

Step up regulation

Alternative medicine systems should comply with quality control

Non-government institutions accounted for 86% of Ayurveda and 85% of homoeopathy colleges in 2024, according to government data, showing that the private sector is leading the AYUSH medical education infrastructure's rapid expansion. Permitted seats also rose by 43% and total admission capacity by 25% between 2021 and 2024, when the Centre's AYURGYAN allocation for AYUSH education, training, research, innovation and capacity-building, increased nearly sixfold. While similar concerns *vis-à-vis* allopathic medical education have been confined to whether institutions adequately prepare students for evidence-based practice, the questions of the AYUSH systems are about the quality of training and what students are being trained to practise. Given the combination, it is notable that quality issues in India's AYUSH system long predate the current boom. In a 2005 audit, the Comptroller and Auditor General found insufficient hospital beds, outpatient services, and/or staff widespread among homoeopathy colleges, with bed occupancy from 1% to 71%. A 2020 *Journal of Ayurveda and Integrative Medicine* article similarly reported that many institutions had a shortfall exceeding 50% in the teaching staff required by standards then. The regulator, the National Commission for Indian System of Medicine (NCISM), has often withheld or denied permission to institutions after inspections have found gaps in faculty strength and infrastructure.

While this shows a working regulatory system, the expansion led by the private sector is of additional concern as it is accompanied by incentives for these institutions to maximise student intake while maintaining faculty size and laboratory infrastructure. As of August 21, the NCISM had listed 17 Ayurveda colleges – all private – whose permissions it had denied, several for "non-compliance with inspection process". In *Hillside Ayurveda Medical College* (2023), the Karnataka High Court acknowledged that "often educational institutions are ... guilty of admitting excess students for financial gains". The National Commission for Homoeopathy has given 41% of all homoeopathy colleges the lowest grade, including nearly half of all private institutions. Effectively, the expansion of AYUSH education is amid persistent quality issues, including inadequate or disputed faculty strengths, failures in inspection requirements and student intake numbers, and even allegations of fictitious faculty. While it would be premature to infer that the rapid expansion evident will have amplified these problems, the persistent regulatory non-compliance warrants tougher quality control and a reexamination of the incentives for private institutions, together with questions about the evidence backing AYUSH medicinal systems.

Deadly span

India's power infrastructure is emerging as a big threat to vultures

Whereas for many decades the chief concern about vulture safety was centered on chemical threats, the threat of electrocution posed by India's expanding power infrastructure may supersede it. In the 1990s, India's vultures suffered one of the world's worst population crashes, nosediving 99.5% by 2007 from a high of around four crore in the 1980s; the white-rumped, Indian, and slender-billed vultures were nearly wiped out. The culprit was diclofenac, a painkiller for cattle that wrecks vulture kidneys. The government banned the use of diclofenac, with additional bans in 2023 to mitigate threats posed by aceclofenac and ketoprofen, among some other NSAIDs. The birds' decline left carcasses exposed for longer, supporting feral dog populations and leading to rabies outbreaks; a 2024 study in American Economic Review estimated that human mortality thus rose 4% and the associated damages cost India $69.4 billion a year. While electrocution has not become as deadly as NSAIDs have been, the fragility of the vulture population and the proliferation of unsafe power infrastructure warrant early action. One official survey reported in 2025 that vultures were nesting at only 50% of their historic nesting sites. It is no trivial detail that the raptors' wide wingspans mean a large individual can contact two conductors at once. They also have a habit of perching on elevated structures, are attracted to open landscapes, and have incentives to congregate where the availability of food is predictable, a risk enhanced by people dumping food waste around electrical installations.

As *The Hindu* reported based on a recent study in the *Journal of Threatened Taxa*, "relocating a livestock carcass dump 2.4 km away from high-tension power infrastructure near Uttarakhand's Dehradun may have saved these large scavengers from ... electrocution". An assessment prepared for the State Climate Resilient Power System Development Project also noted an Egyptian vulture and some steppe eagles had been electrocuted on medium-voltage, rather than high-voltage, lines. Research has noted that persistent mortality due to electrocution alone could render a local population extinct. Avian electrocution is also likely under-documented in India since dead birds can be removed by humans or scavenged. As the study indicated, one inexpensive solution is to separate vulture feeding sites from power infrastructure. Other measures to protect raptors, and even other birds, especially near settlements, include insulating conductors, increasing the gap between energised and grounded components or otherwise preventing a bird from bridging them – non-trivial considering vulture wingspans – and installing safe perches.

Political demography, the future of democracy

Varghese K. George

What is common between Elon Musk, M.K. Stalin, a Catholic bishop in Keralam, N. Chandrababu Naidu, C. Joseph Vijay and Mohan Bhagwat? All of them are asking 'their' people to have more children.

The political consequences of changing patterns of birth, death and the movement of people are being felt the world over. The ongoing Census 2027 operations in India have brought a sense of urgency to this question of uneven population trends across regions and communities. The impending question of delimitation of Lok Sabha constituencies, which is to follow the first Census after 2026, adds another layer of urgency.

Natalism, or pronatalism, is a belief system or policy stance that encourages human reproduction and high birth rates, and there are vocal advocates of this these days in communities around the world. Elections and political debates increasingly involve questions of fertility, migration, ageing, identity and belonging. Mr. Musk speaks of falling birth rates as a major threat to civilisation, particularly western. In India, Mr. Naidu, president of the Telugu Desam Party (TDP) and Chief Minister of Andhra Pradesh, has urged Telugu families to have more children. Mr. Stalin, president of the Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam and former Tamil Nadu Chief Minister, invoked the idea of having "16 children", rhetorically, for Tamils. Mr. Bhagwat, Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) chief, has explicitly called for Indian, rather Hindu, families to have three children. The Catholic church asks its members to have bigger families. In the most recent development, the Tamil Nadu government, led by Mr. Vijay, Chief Minister and founder and president of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam (TVK), has extended one-year maternity leave to women government employees having a third child in Tamil Nadu. In 2024, West Bengal and Trinamool Congress (TMC) Minister Firhad Hakim's remark that Muslims could soon become a majority in the State drew criticism, with the TMC distancing itself from the comment and condemning it.

Take the subject seriously

All this makes political demography – the study of how population changes, such as births, deaths, ageing, and migration, affect government policies, political power, and international security – more salient. Sadly, while there is abundant politics around demography, true scholarship is being stifled by conspiracy theorists seeking political capital and by demographic sceptics who view any discussion of the subject as nativism or xenophobia.

While the global population will continue to grow for some time, that growth is uneven across political boundaries and social groups. India itself is moving rapidly through a fertility transition. India's total fertility rate has fallen below replacement level, to 2.0 children per woman according to the National Family Health Survey (NFHS)-5. Fertility has declined across every major religious community; though the pace of decline has been uneven across regions and communities, the gap is narrowing. Pew Research, using NFHS data, found that Muslim fertility declined from 4.4 children per woman in 1992 to 2.4 in 2019-21, fertility declined among every major religious group and fertility gaps between religious communities have narrowed.

Demographic factors will challenge the existing electoral process. The 'One person, one vote, one value' principle in India is not applied blindly, but in consonance with group rights of representation. Social federalism and political federalism are both part of India's democratic design. Rich and poor people both move, though for different reasons. In recent years, around two lakh Indians have been giving up their Indian citizenship on average, each year. The poor also move – from places with fewer opportunities to places with greater opportunities. According to the 2011 Census, India had about 45 crore internal migrants. Some regions are ageing, while others will remain younger for longer. Keralam has the highest median age in India, estimated at 37 years in 2026, and this is projected to reach 47 years by 2051. The median age in Uttar Pradesh is approximately 26.9 years, making it one of the youngest States in India. India's projected median age is about 29.2 years in 2026. Even by 2036, the median age of Uttar Pradesh is projected to reach only 31.7 years, according to some estimates.

> Politics must move from profiting from demographic change to sensitively managing and navigating its consequences

What is in focus

Natalism is simplistic rhetoric in response to complex realities. No country or society has easily or consistently reversed a sustained decline in fertility. Countries such as Japan, South Korea, China, and Italy have introduced financial incentives, childcare support, parental leave, and other pronatalist measures, but none has succeeded in restoring fertility to the levels seen in earlier decades. South Korea, despite extensive family policies, continues to have extraordinarily low fertility. Italy, too, has continued to experience declining births despite financial incentives and family-support measures. This suggests that fertility is not simply a question of money. It is tied to housing, employment, education, gender relations, the cost of raising children, and people's expectations about the future.

The reason for continued population growth in many societies is increasingly expanding lifespan and population momentum rather than increasing births. The spread of that growth is uneven across political boundaries and social groups. Similarly, wealth creation and distribution remain uneven and will remain so. Fewer people are being born, people are living longer, moving faster and farther; these factors in combination with demands of democracy and federalism raise challenges that require cool thinking and new imaginative capacity.

Studying the interlinkage between politics and demography is a marginal field within political science and demography, but it should not remain so. In many countries, such as the United States and India, the question of federalism is also in play alongside demography and the economy. A balance will have to be achieved both across social groups nationally and across States in terms of development outcomes, growth, opportunities, and political power. India's southern States, for instance, achieved fertility decline earlier and now face the possibility of ageing faster than States with relatively younger populations.

The political question is not simply who has more people, but who has invested in development, who has fewer young people entering the workforce, who needs resources, and how representation should respond to these differences. In a utopian world, if all of humanity were one, no consideration other than individual identity should come into play. But these questions are, for better or worse, framed in terms of group identities. Recognition of group identities is not alien to democratic practice; it can be an integral and essential part of it. The political problem, therefore, is not that groups exist. It is how democratic institutions and development planning can accommodate changing group identities without turning demographic differences into permanent political antagonism.

Impact on planning and politics

The changes in demographic patterns affect both planning and politics. Groups with larger populations will claim greater political power, while groups that are shrinking will feel increasingly insecure. As the number of older and retired people grows relative to the working-age population, their care will require higher commitment of national resources. When these demographic differences vary across regions, they can create friction between States as resources and people move across borders – from regions where there is more to regions where there is less. Regional demographic differences can also cause disputes over taxation, fiscal transfers, development, and political representation.

World over, conversations about demographic shifts have become a source of diatribe. While one group talks about replacement theory and fears that its race is being wiped out, another dismisses such concerns as conspiracy theories. Demographic change is neither a conspiracy to replace any community nor an imagined phenomenon. It is real, natural, and likely to be difficult to reverse. Politics needs to shift from trying to profit from demographic change to sensitively managing and navigating it. The question, then, is whether there can be a more expansive idea of "The People."

varghese.g@thehindu.co.in

The Baltic Way — Gandhi's imprint on Baltic freedom

K.B. Usha

Associate Professor, School of International Studies, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi

August 23, 2026, marked the 37th anniversary of the Baltic Way, the historic 1989 human chain that became a watershed moment in the Gandhian-inspired Singing Revolution in Lithuania, Latvia, and Estonia, culminating in the restoration of Baltic independence in 1990-91. Conversations across the Baltic states revealed powerful personal reflections on the Baltic Way and Gandhian non-violence: "We studied India's freedom struggle and chose Gandhian non-violent resistance to reclaim our national freedom from Soviet rule." "We watched the film *Gandhi* on Lithuanian national television, telecast for 24 hours." "It was thrilling to join a non-violent protest against the Soviet army at Vilnius Cathedral Square; even as a bullet passed near my ear, I stood firm." "Baltic Way matters a lot for us today."

A turning point

The Singing Revolution (1986-91), shaped by songs and non-violence during Mikhail Gorbachev's perestroika and glasnost, reached a turning point with the Baltic Way, when two million people formed a 675-kilometre human chain from Tallinn through Riga to Vilnius, demanding freedom from Soviet rule. It remains a powerful symbol of unity, solidarity, and freedom. The Baltic Way was organised on the 50th anniversary of the 1939 Molotov-Ribbentrop Pact to expose its secret protocol, which divided Eastern Europe into German and Soviet spheres of influence, and paved the way for the Soviet annexation of the Baltic states in 1940. Having gained independence in 1918, the Baltics lost it after 22 years. The Baltic Way exposed Soviet-era repression, leading to the Soviet Union's acknowledgement of the secret protocol's existence and the Baltic states' re-independence in 1991. Its global media coverage drew international attention, while its inscription in UNESCO's Memory of the World Register and Guinness World Records recognition reinforced its international legacy.

> The Mahatma's principles of non-violence have forged enduring bonds between the Baltics and India

An enduring influence

Gandhi's ideas travelled globally, inspiring movements from the American civil rights struggle to South Africa and beyond. Today, the Baltic Way reflects the enduring relevance of his principles of non-violence, truth, and human dignity, while echoing the non-cooperation and civil disobedience of his 1930 Dandi March.

Gandhi showed that moral authority could outweigh military power through ahimsa, satyagraha, civil resistance, mass mobilisation, and the principle that a nation's rule depends on people's consent and cooperation. The Baltic Way and the Singing Revolution stand as a testimony to the success of people's power and civilian-based defence drawn from the Gandhi-led Indian freedom movement.

The Singing Revolution's leaders drew on global traditions of non-violent resistance. Latvian scholar Maija Kūle noted that, lacking local theorists, they turned to Gandhi and Martin Luther King Jr.; Latvia's earlier cultural links with India may also have encouraged this attraction to Gandhian ideas. Lithuania, too, played a key role in developing non-violent civilian-based defence inspired by Gandhi.

In a 2012 conversation with this writer, the late Prof. Gražina Miniotaitė, a leading ideologue of Lithuania's Singing Revolution, recalled that non-violence was widely understood from the outset as essential. The December 1990 "Republic in Danger" declaration urged adherence to "non-violence and non-cooperation with the occupational authorities".

Unlike other thinkers of non-violence, Miniotaitė regarded Gandhi as the most successful in both theory and practice, demonstrating that non-violent struggle could effectively resist foreign rule. Richard Attenborough's 1982 film *Gandhi* was broadcast on Lithuanian national television to educate citizens about non-violent resistance. Confronting Soviet troops, people repeated: "We won't fight," "We follow Gandhi," and "We are peaceful people."

Building closer ties

Since 1992, the Baltic states have drawn on Gandhian and cultural ties to deepen relations with India, expanding cooperation in technology, sustainability, the blue economy, and culture. The Government of India's Ministry of Commerce and Industry estimates show that India's total bilateral trade with Lithuania reached $490.61 million; with Latvia, $475.66 million, and with Estonia, $219.69 million in 2025-26.

Baltic political discourse reflects Gandhian influence through Gandhi's Lithuanian-born Litvak "soulmate" Hermann Kallenbach; Vydūnas's engagement with Gandhian thought; Antanas Poška's meetings with Gandhi; Sonja Schlesin's secretaryship; and Estonian translations of Gandhi by Linnart Hall. These ties continue through annual commemorations of the 2015 Gandhi-Kallenbach monument in Kallenbach's birthplace, Rusnė, most recently in July 2026; the Kallenbach Memorial Lectures; and the India-Lithuania Friendship Award (this year, it honoured the people of Goa during the 400th anniversary of missionary Andrius Rudamina). India has also gifted Gandhi memorials to the Baltics, including a bust unveiled in Latvia in 2019 and a statue installed in Estonia in 2025.

The Baltic Way endures as a chain of freedom and ideas, linking courage with conscience. Its contemporary significance is multifaceted: a model of non-violent resistance, a site of contested memory, a narrative in Russia-West tensions, and ultimately, a tribute to Gandhi and India.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

Turning to science

The tragedy in Nepal is heartbreaking with the loss of many lives and displacement of many. The Himalayas are home to massive glaciers and experts now warn that regions closer to India could face similar avalanches. Instead of waiting for the next calamity, should not governments invest in research for preventive action? For instance, exploring scientific methods to safely scatter unstable ice masses before they collapse naturally? If science can contemplate diverting asteroids in space, surely we can find a solution for a threat whose location and magnitude are well known to us. This could be taken up as a global project under the United Nations, with all nations contributing funds and expertise to save humanity from such disasters.

B.C. Ramani,
Hyderabad

Trees felled in one swoop

There is increasing felling of trees in the name of development. Roads, highways, buildings and other construction projects are expanding rapidly, but unfortunately, thousands of trees are being cut down. Development is necessary for progress, but it should not come at the cost of our environment. Trees provide oxygen, reduce air pollution, regulate temperatures and help maintain ecological balance. Their large-scale removal contributes to rising temperatures, air pollution, soil erosion and the loss of wildlife habitats. Authorities should adopt development plans that minimise tree loss. Wherever trees must be removed, they should be replaced through proper plantation drives.

Vandit Jain,
Chandigarh

Letters emailed to letters@thehindu.co.in must carry the postal address.

The battle within the BJP in Bengal

Sayantan Ghosh

teaches at St. Xavier's College (Autonomous), Kolkata, and is the author of 'Battleground Bengal' and 'The Aam Aadmi Party'

One hundred days after the Bharatiya Janata Party (BJP) ended 15 years of Trinamool Congress rule in West Bengal, a consequential battle is unfolding in the State within the BJP itself.

By taking oath as Bengal's first BJP Chief Minister, Suvendu Adhikari inherited a State that had voted for rupture. Voters rejected extortion, strongmen, patronage, unreliable employment, and the migration of young Bengalis. The mandate carried special weight for the BJP, and the Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) which had spent decades building an organisation in the State when electoral power seemed distant.

Yet Bengal has changed political colour faster than political culture. Trinamool offices, auto and e-rickshaw stands once controlled by Trinamool workers now carry BJP flags; strongmen who once stood beside Trinamool legislators now appear beside BJP leaders. The contradiction is stark: Mr. Adhikari who promised to dismantle Mamata Banerjee's political system, is consolidating power by absorbing the very same system and networks.

This has created a contest between three forces within the party: the Sangh, seeking ideological continuity; Samik Bhattacharya, the State BJP president, seeking restraint; and Mr. Adhikari, whose instincts were shaped inside the Trinamool.

Three-pronged battle

The RSS's concern is rooted in memory and sacrifice. Its cadres spent decades building the BJP in Bengal, amid violence and isolation. For them, victory was supposed to begin a different political culture.

> Suvendu Adhikari who promised to dismantle Mamata Banerjee's political system, is consolidating power by absorbing the very same system and networks

However, the Chief Minister sees Bengal differently. Power does not reside only in the Assembly or secretariat but in clubs, booths, contractors, transport networks, and strongmen. Bengal has repeatedly shown that while political personnel can change parties, networks survive: Congress moved to the Left, the Left to Trinamool, and now sections of that ecosystem are moving to the BJP. This is where political scientist Dwaipayan Bhattacharya's concept of "party society" becomes crucial – in Bengal, the political party has historically become the principal mediator between citizens, institutions and the State. The CM understands this; his strategy is not to destroy the party society but to inherit it as it consolidates power the fastest.

Mr. Bhattacharya has tried to draw boundaries. He warned cadres against extortion, indiscipline, and misuse of the BJP's name. The party has expelled more than 30 leaders and suspended around 250 over allegations involving corruption, extortion, and anti-party activity. But victory's political energy is fast outrunning organisational restraint.

The contradiction is sharper in the BJP's handling of the Trinamool Congress. While the party says its doors are closed, three former Trinamool Rajya Sabha members have joined the BJP and received nominations immediately. In Parliament, around 20 rebel Trinamool MPs have merged with the Nationalist Citizen Party of India, which in turn, is desperate to merge with the BJP, making claims of distance difficult to sustain.

Mr. Adhikari's play here is strategic as Ms. Bannerjee cannot rebuild her organisation if her leaders are absorbed and networks are transferred. For the RSS, however, the harder question is whether absorbing Trinamool networks also means absorbing their habits. Grassroots workers are unsettled; BJP cadres now see former adversaries accommodated as *Bhalo Trinamool* (good Trinamool). For those who lost homes, livelihoods, and family members during the Trinamool rule, rehabilitation can look like betrayal.

Disrupter or custodian?

A party can absorb individuals without becoming the party they came from. However, inheriting its methods, networks, and political instincts is different.

These 100 days are more than a report card on Mr. Adhikari's government. They mark an argument over what the Bengal BJP will become. For the Sangh, victory vindicated decades of work. For Mr. Bhattacharya, it was supposed to create a disciplined alternative. For the CM, the priority is ensuring that the Trinamool cannot recover. All three can coexist for now. They may not coexist forever.

The danger is that, in seeking permanence rather than merely victory, the BJP may preserve, instead of disrupt, the political system that made the Trinamool powerful. Bengal has changed its government; the harder question is whether the BJP will change the system it inherited or simply become its new custodian.

The need for political unity in Kashmir

Anando Bhakto

New Delhi-based senior journalist reporting on Kashmir developments

Jammu and Kashmir Chief Minister Omar Abdullah descended onto New Delhi's streets, in July, with his Cabinet in tow to press for restoration of J&K's federal guarantees – he was denied permission to protest at the emblematic Jantar Mantar. The Peoples Democratic Party chief Mehbooba Mufti, and Srinagar MP Ruhullah Mehdi spearheaded separate programmes in Delhi in the following days. If one had expected this line up of events in the capital to be a surreal moment of reclaiming Kashmir's democratic space for dissent, one was not enthused. What was more prominently illustrated was the deep divisions within the Kashmiri leadership.

After Omar Abdullah came to power in October 2024, he prudently focused on repairing ties with New Delhi. He had hoped that a calibrated navigation would be helpful in negotiating a respectable arrangement for J&K. But in Srinagar, Mr. Abdullah's political opponents described his exploration of areas of agreement with New Delhi and the tailored camaraderie it entailed, as pusillanimous. They iterated that there couldn't be a lesser political goal post in Kashmir than reversing the August 5, 2019 legislations that stripped the Himalayan region of its semi-autonomous status.

While Kashmir's right to dignity and respectable federal arrangement is non-negotiable, the way to realising it cannot be the daily whipping of a rather disempowered local government for not being combative enough. Though this resentment is received well in the echo canyons of people's online lives, it serves no other purpose except to create a veneer of ideological supremacy for a few. The need of the hour for all of Gupkar's politicians is to contemplate political unity even when grave disagreement simmers beneath the surface. The importance of political unity cannot be overlooked at a time when rest of India's Opposition is palpably wary of involving itself in the Kashmir question.

> While Kashmir's right to dignity and respectable federal arrangement is non-negotiable, the way to realising it cannot be the daily whipping of a rather disempowered local government for not being combative enough

Nearly two years after the electorate turned out in impressive numbers to elect a local Government and upend the "bureaucratic apparatus" that had settled snugly in its absence, the unelected office of the Lieutenant Governor (LG) continues to wield significant power, heightening confusion. In a region with proximity to violence, it may express itself in a spatter of political dismissiveness: not just of the local government but of participatory democracy itself.

Ensuring Kashmiri participation in elections has always been tricky. It is often the outcome of mainstream leaders' penetrating patronage networks. Rural belts vote more briskly because people have dependence on local politicians, for amenities, and as protective shields against police arbitrariness.

Case studies of several Public Safety Act detainees underscored that local legislators are often the "go to" persons for political and legal support, a favour paid off with the ballot even when one may not be otherwise upbeat about elections. The bureaucratic apparatus created a vacuum which people voted to reverse. Disarming elected legislators not only runs roughshod on the country's federal underpinning but has the potential to erode their ground connect and influence on which Kashmir's participatory democracy is erected.

The importance of handing over full executive powers to J&K's elected government has also to be understood in terms of its indispensability in law and order related decision-making, especially in a fragile security situation. The non-local bureaucrats advising the LG on Home Affairs are walled off from the region's political topography, and may deploy rushed, tactless mechanisms in the face of a threat.

After the Baisaran terrorist attack in April 2025, the houses of at least 10 alleged militants were razed, including that of Aadil Thoker, the key suspect, at Guri Thukarpora village in Anantnag. Guri Thakurpora had been an Ikhwan (renegade) village, reportedly pro-India even when militancy raged in the 1990s. If the elected leadership was a stakeholder in security, it could flag the use of brute force, especially at a peripheral space invested with years of trust-building.

The National Conference ought to have understood much earlier that New Delhi was in no mood to cede full-scale executive powers to J&K. It perhaps does so now, and is contemplating a range of resistance activities, though orchestrating street-protests is off its table. While Kashmiris' struggle is for dignity and rights, not merely statehood, a plausible course to it has to be contrived with political ingenuity and collectively.

V-dem's democracy index rates India at its lowest since 1975

The UN CERD's concerns about the exclusion of a large number of voters is in line with the V-Dem Institute's data on India's democratic backslide

DATA POINT

Sambavi Parthasarathy
Gauri Singavarapu

Last week, the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (CERD), said it was "gravely concerned" about "reports of large-scale violations perpetrated by law enforcement officials" in its first review of India since 2007. The committees' observations included concerns over the exclusion of large number of voters, Muslims in particular, as part of the Special Intensive Revision of electoral rolls.

UN CERD's criticism seems to be in line with some of the observations in the latest democracy report by the University of Gothenburg-based Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Institute, which uses a multidimensional approach to "conceptualising and measuring democracy." It noted India as one of the countries that is "autocratising" slowly with a systematic dismantling of democratic institutions. This is reflected in the institute's electoral democracy index released in March. While India's performance has gradually declined since 2009, the latest index score is India's lowest since 1975, when the country was under Emergency rule **(Chart 1)**. India's scores across parameters such as judicial accountability and corruption, autonomy of the Election Management Body (EMB), and impartial administration by public officials are at their lowest in 50 years. **(Charts 2, 3, 4)**.

The decline in autonomy of institutions, as per the report, seems to have accompanied deteriorations in freedom of academic and cultural expression and harassment of journalists **(Chart 5)**. Academic freedom measured through indicators such as freedom of academic expression, freedom to research and teach, and institutional autonomy have also declined **(Chart 6)**.

New depths

The data for the charts were sourced from the Varieties of Democracy (V-Dem) Institute, University of Gothenburg, Sweden.
Gauri Singavarapu is interning with The Hindu's Data team

CHART 1: V-Dem's democracy index score for India is at its lowest since 1975. It was 0.39 in 1975, slightly higher than the 0.38 recorded in 2025

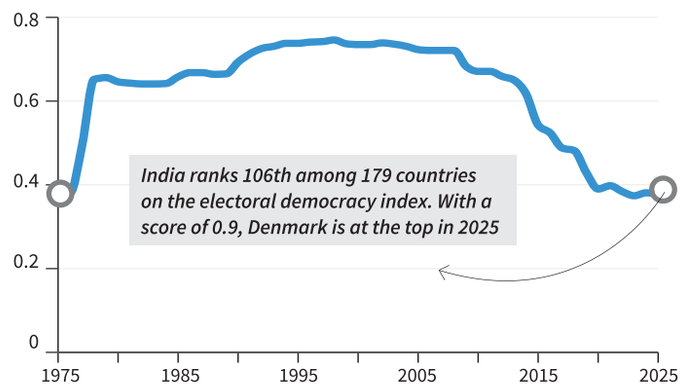


CHART 2: India's scores across election-related indicators involving the functioning of Election Management Body (EMB) and conduct of elections

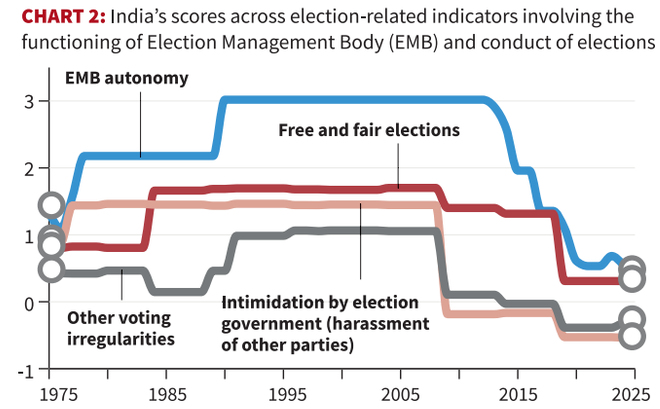


CHART 3: India's scores across indicators on religion, private property, access to justice, and public administration, as per V-Dem Institute's report

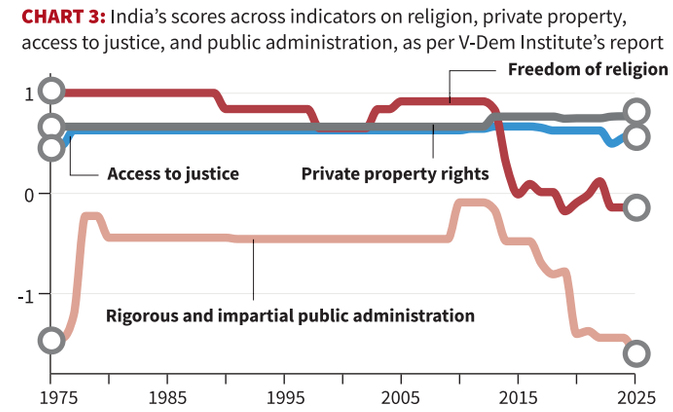


CHART 4: Select judicial-ary-related indicators such as compliance with court orders by executives, judicial corruption and accountability

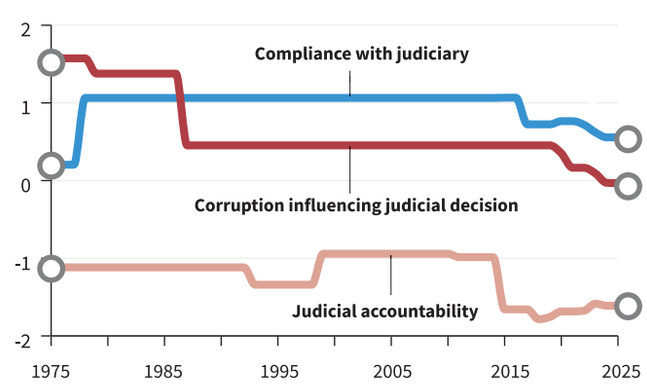


CHART 5: India's scores across indicators related to media and freedom of expression, as per V-Dem Institute's report

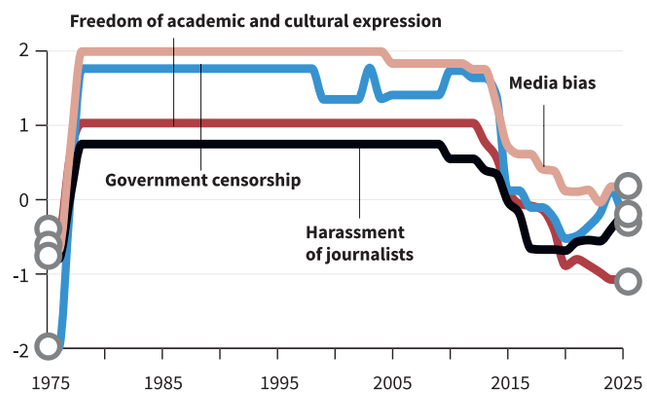
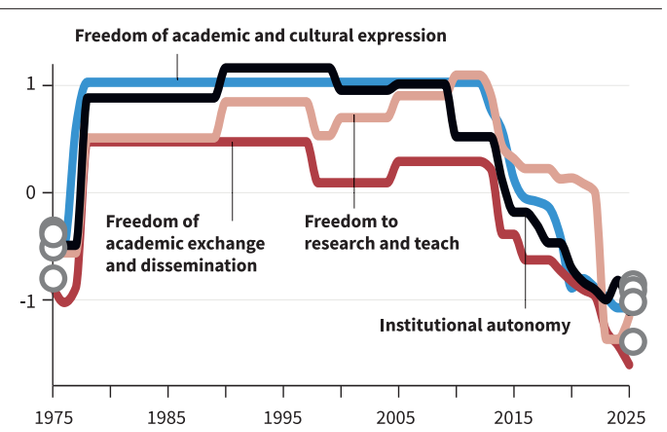


CHART 6: Select parameters assessing India's academic freedom and institutional autonomy, as per V-Dem Institute's report



FROM THE ARCHIVES

The Hindu.

FIFTY YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 1, 1976

Efforts to improve life of Sikkim Lepchas

Gangtok, August 31: The original inhabitants of Sikkim, the Lepchas, who to-day constitute a mere 15 per cent of the State's total population, have a special reason to be happy now. For the first time a detailed land survey has started in their area known as Dzongu in North Sikkim, as a major step towards effective implementation of land reforms in the State.

The backward people of Dzongu do not have any proper records of their rights and lands. For long this place has been considered as the property of the former royal family and the poor Lepchas have been exploited by them for decades. Dzongu being in the extreme north of the State has no easy communication with the outside world and so the people have yet to know the world outside. Very few of them can be seen even in the capital of Gangtok.

Most of the earnings of these families are spent on eating and drinking, of which they are extremely fond. Oldtimers in the capital even to-day recall incidents of these people coming here to sell their produce, mainly cardamom, and being satisfied with the liquor served to them by the business community as consideration for their produce.

At a recently organised meeting at Tingbhum in Dzongu, a group of the community elders, passed a resolution favouring drastic changes in their way of life, especially in regard to expenses on marriage.

A HUNDRED YEARS AGO SEPTEMBER 1, 1926

Marconi's new invention

An "Englishman" cable from London, dated August 29 states:-

Signor Marconi has successfully experimented with a special loud speaker giving great amplification with enlarged batteries which magnify sounds without sacrificing quality.

He believes they can be developed until the voice carries twenty miles. He is leaving for Italy in his yacht the "Electra" on September 1 and will carry out a series of experiments to determine the strength of the beams operating between England and Canada and England and South Africa in order to increase the efficiency of long distance transmission and prevent countries for which they are not intended receiving the waves.

Text&Context

THE HINDU

NEWS IN NUMBERS

Amount outlined for Semicon programme by government

1.27 in ₹ lakh crore. The government on Monday notified the ₹1.27-lakh-crore Semicon 2.0 programme, spelling out eligibility and incentives across the semiconductor value chain, including 40% fiscal support for silicon wafer fabs with a minimum investment of ₹20,000 crore, and sweeteners for chip design. PTI

Surplus liquidity in banking system at the end of August

5 in ₹ lakh crore. Surplus liquidity in the banking system surged to nearly ₹5 lakh crore at the end of August, its highest level in over four months, boosted by month-end government spending and robust foreign currency deposits. According to data compiled by PTI from the Reserve Bank of India, surplus system liquidity stood at ₹5.05 lakh crore as on August 30. PTI

Monthly stipend of medical interns in J&K that triggered strikes

12,300 in ₹. MBBS and BDS interns across medical colleges in Jammu and Kashmir went on an indefinite strike on Monday, protesting a monthly stipend of just ₹12,300 and demanding it be raised to 30,000. The protesting interns claimed that their stipend had remained unchanged for nearly seven years. PTI

Number of houses sanctioned by A.P. under PMAY-Urban 2.0

17,912 The Andhra Pradesh government on Monday sanctioned nearly 18,000 houses at a cost of about ₹448 crore under the PMAY-Urban 2.0. An official said the unit cost of each house is ₹2.5 lakh, of which 60% will be provided as assistance by the Centre and the remaining 40% by the State government. PTI

Value of Israel's defence export deal with Greece

3.5 in $ billion. Israel signed a multi-billion-dollar weapons deal with Greece, as Israeli defence exports soar. Israel's Defence Ministry said the nearly €3 billion ($3.5 billion) defence export deal, coined Achilles Shield, is one of the country's largest and includes a multilayered air defence system for Greece using Israeli technology. AP

COMPILED BY THE HINDU DATA TEAM

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The broken promise of right to work

The replacement of MGNREGA with the VB-GRAM G Act has weakened the rural right-to-work framework; restoring a meaningful right to work through adequate funding, living wages and stronger local institutions would advance constitutional aims while also supporting rural demand and economic growth

ECONOMIC NOTES

Rajendran Narayanan
Vijay Ram S.

On August 21, a three-judge Supreme Court Bench led by the Chief Justice of India dismissed a petition and sought a fresh one in a case on minimum wages in rural employment guarantee programmes. The Bench lauded MGNREGA's role in rural development. It probed whether the 'Right to Work' should be treated on par with Article 21, the fundamental right to life, sparking an important discussion on the constitutional foundations of this right.

A guarantee under strain

Despite its limited scope of only 100 days of work per rural household and chronic underfunding, the Mahatma Gandhi National Rural Employment Guarantee Act (MGNREGA) was the only law anchored in the core principle of the right to work. In December 2025, the Union government replaced MGNREGA with the Viksit Bharat – Guarantee for Rozgar & Ajeevika Mission (Gramin) (VB-GRAM G) Act, and its implementation began on July 1. About 3.44 crore households worked for about 44 crore person-days under MGNREGA in July and August, on average, over the previous five years **(Table 1)**. There has been a 68% decrease in employment in July and August this year compared with the average of the preceding five years. Notwithstanding the proverbial 'teething issues', the dismantling of MGNREGA's demand-driven right-to-work framework and the disproportionate fiscal burden that the new law places on States are likely to be major factors behind the dramatic fall in employment under the VB-GRAM G Act.

The impact of taking away even this limited right to work is therefore palpable. Discussions around the recent Supreme Court observations on the right to work can be traced back to the Constituent Assembly debates.

While most members agreed that a right to work was vital, the debate rested on whether it should be a fundamental right or be part of the Directive Principles of State Policy (DPSP). The DPSPs do not automatically constitute rights but are meant to serve as precepts for governments to formulate laws and policies. This became the basis of the differences in perspective.

Professor K.T. Shah had strongly advocated recognising the right to work as a fundamental right, arguing that the State needed a constitutional and positive legal mandate to guarantee socio-economic security to its citizens. Dr. B.R. Ambedkar, among others, held that while the right to work was an essential goal, its immediate universal enforcement was not fiscally and institutionally viable in a newly independent India that had been hollowed out of its resources. The placement of the right within the Directive Principles, rather than among the fundamental rights, thus reflected a deliberate constitutionalism of aspiration, rather than an abandonment of the welfare ideal. As scholars Anjani Kapoor and Manu Bhagwan have written in their essay 'Ambedkar and the anti-isolation of Fellowship', "The constitution does not establish the nation, but rather provides the tools to help achieve it."

Therefore, Article 41 of the DPSP states: 'The State shall, within the limits of its economic capacity and development, make effective provision for securing the right to work..." Embodying stronger progressive consecrations, Articles 39, 42 and 43 call for the "right to an adequate means of livelihood, equal pay for equal work for both men and women, just and humane conditions of work" and to "secure to all workers a living wage and decent standard of life."

A shrinking safety net

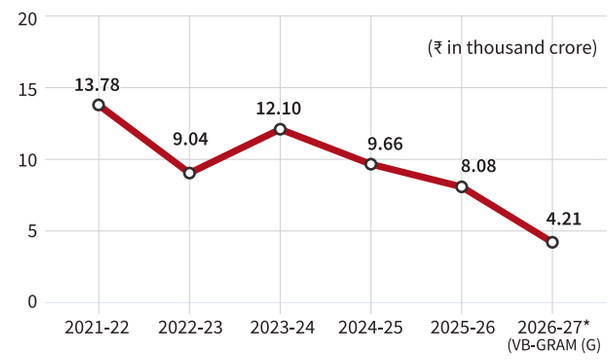
The shift from MGNREGA to VB-GRAM G has sharply reduced rural employment and earnings

Table 1: The number of households (HH) employed, persondays of work generated and average daily wages paid in July and August

Financial year	HH provided employment (in crore)	Persondays of work generated (in crore)	Average daily wage paid in July & August (₹)
2021-22	4.79	65.74	210
2022-23	3.13	40.14	225.5
2023-24	3.82	49.13	246.5
2024-25	3.04	37.36	259
2025-26	2.44	29.78	272
2026-27* (VB-GRAM G)	1.39	14.94	282.5

Sources: MGNREGA and VB-GRAM G MIS reports.
**Data as on 31st August 2026 for FY 2026-27.*

Figure 1: Estimated household earnings in July and August



**Data as on 31st Aug 2026 | Note: Total household earnings = sum of average wage rate paid x persondays of work generated in July and August*

Sources: MGNREGA and VB-GRAM G MIS reports.

From aspiration to a statutory right

The Supreme Court, in *Olga Tellis vs Bombay Municipal Corporation* (1985), ruled that the right to livelihood was a necessary condition for the fundamental right to life, giving a judicial fillip to the right to work. Spurred by the collective efforts of activists and rural workers, the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act was passed in 2005. Although limited in scope, it made a pan-India right-to-work law a reality for the first time. The State had to ensure its statutory obligation to provide employment at minimum wages.

In 2009, MGNREGA wages were delinked from the Minimum Wages Act, 1948. Over time, MGNREGA wages barely kept pace with inflation and continued to remain lower than the minimum agricultural wages in most States. Low wages and an inadequate budget for generating employment have resulted in a steep decline in household earnings, with estimated total household earnings halving in July and August this year compared with the same months last year **(Figure 1)**.

During the recent hearing, the Supreme Court Bench remarked that if financial resources remained the same, having a minimum wage threshold could reduce the number of workers who could be provided employment. This remark, which appears to align with the Union government's approach to employment guarantee, merits scrutiny on at least two counts.

First, it vitiates the judgment in *Sanjit Roy vs State of Rajasthan* (1983) where the Supreme Court observed that payment of wages below minimum wages violates Article 23 of the Constitution and is akin to 'forced labour.' Second, it rests on a misleading economic logic that financial resources to implement a welfare programme must remain unchanged and constrained.

In reality, higher wages for rural workers increase their purchasing power, enhance their freedoms, and improve human development outcomes. These, in turn, increase effective demand for goods and services, creating a positive multiplier effect, resulting in higher economic productivity. Therefore, higher government spending on an employment guarantee programme at increased wages can yield a mutually reinforcing cycle between development and growth.

A retreat from the right to work

By putting an arbitrary cap on funds for the VB-GRAM G Act and not linking it with minimum wages, the very notion of employment guarantee stands delegitimised. States are already grappling with fiscal constraints and curtailed borrowing limits under the Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management (FRBM) framework. The increased burden of funding the VB-GRAM G Act will prevent States from generating employment. The sharp drop in employment and earnings is a reflection of this change.

The VB-GRAM G Act also contains provisions to denotify certain areas and exclude them from the scheme, thereby limiting the universality of MGNREGA's right to work.

Lawyer Purbayan Chakraborty highlights how the Supreme Court has affirmed the doctrine of non-retrogression in *Navtej Singh Johar vs Union of India*. The doctrine implies that once the State has achieved a certain level of progressive legislation and enforceability of a right, it cannot implement measures that deliberately undo it. Non-retrogression operates as a check on State power, ensuring that rights, once realised, are not diluted later. The replacement of MGNREGA with the VB-GRAM G Act appears to be in violation of this doctrine.

Rural wages have been stagnant for a decade, while women are increasingly employed as 'unpaid family workers'. In such light, the minimal requirements for affirming the commitment to the right to work are: linking MGNREGA wages to living wages, timely payment of wages, a focus on social audits by empowering local institutions to be partners in mitigating corruption, and giving more powers to Panchayati Raj institutions.

All these measures could be implemented within a legal framework of the right to work. The VB-GRAMG Act, unfortunately, is silent on most of them. Reinstating the right to work would therefore not only be a legal course correction advancing constitutional aims, but would also be sound economics.

(The authors are affiliated with the Centre for the Study of the Indian Economy, Azim Premji University. The views expressed are personal)

THE GIST

- The Supreme Court's recent observations have revived the Constituent Assembly-era debate over whether the right to work should be a fundamental right or remain under the directive principles
- Keeping employment guarantee budgets constrained and wages below minimum wages can undermine both the constitutional promise of the right to work and rural household earnings
- Higher wages and greater public spending on employment can boost workers' purchasing power, stimulate demand for goods and services, and support wider economic growth

BUILDING BLOCKS

GETTY IMAGES

What goes on behind the screen when you pay through UPI?

UPI enables instant bank-to-bank payments by connecting users' apps and banks through a system operated by the National Payments Corporation of India; launched in 2016, it has grown into a massive digital payments network and is now being adopted in several countries

Vasudevan Mukunth

The Unified Payments Interface (UPI) is India's preeminent digital payments system. In July 2026 alone, it processed 2,366 crore transactions – or around 7,600 transactions per second – in total worth nearly ₹30 lakh crore. Across the 2025-26 financial year, UPI handled 24,160 crore transactions worth ₹314 lakh crore, accounting for 85% of the country's digital payment transactions by volume. According to the International Monetary Fund, UPI also accounted for a stunning 49% of all real-time payments worldwide in 2025.

How does UPI work?

Say Selvi has an account in Violin Bank and Shankar has an account in Flute Bank. Selvi wants to send Shankar ₹100 via UPI. First, Selvi tells her UPI app – which could be Google Pay, PhonePe, etc. – whom she wants to pay. Obviously the app will not understand who 'Shankar' is. Instead, she will have to tell the app in a language the app understands.

In this language, Shankar's identity has two parts: his unique name and his unique bank name. So it will be something like shankar@flutebank. This UPI ID will be connected to Shankar's bank account. In technical terms, the ID is an alias of the account.

So when Selvi tells her UPI app that she needs to send money to shankar@flutebank, the app will know which account the money should go to.

Second, the app will send a payment request to the UPI system. UPI is operated by the National Payments Corporation of India (NPCI). It provides the switching and routing infrastructure that links the 730 or so participating banks, allowing users to transfer money between accounts at these banks.

The UPI system will respond to Selvi's app's request by asking Selvi to authenticate the transaction. This is like a confirmation: "Let me make sure you want this transaction to happen." Selvi will do this by entering her UPI PIN. Now the system will know she has signed off on it.

The third step is for the actual transaction to happen. Selvi's bank, which is Violin Bank, will check the transaction. This involves asking questions such as whether Selvi's account is valid, has enough money, if the request is authentic, if the transaction limit has been reached, and if the transaction shows any signs of fraudulent activity.

If the check passes all tests, Violin Bank will let the UPI system know that it is ready to execute the transaction.

Fourth, the UPI system will route the transaction to Flute Bank, which is Shankar's bank, and into the account associated with shankar@flutebank.

Fifth, Violink Bank will deduct ₹100 from Selvi's account and Flute Bank will add ₹100 to Shankar's account.

Sixth, and finally, Flute Bank will report the addition to the UPI system, which will then relay it to Violin Bank, and finally to the UPI app in Selvi's hand.

How complex is the system?

This simplified picture is essentially what the UPI system makes possible. However, it is not complete. The system has more technical components to ensure that different banks can trust each transaction, update records correctly, and be able to respond in a predictable way when a transaction goes awry.

For a glimpse, to connect to Violin Bank – from where Selvi initiated the transaction – the UPI app (Google Pay, PhonePe, etc.) will communicate with TPAP/PSP infrastructure, which allows apps to interact with banking services. TPAP is a company that provides the app used to make UPI payments, e.g., PhonePe. And PSP is the bank or company that connects the app to the NPCI infrastructure.

For another, Violin Blank and Flute Bank will exchange multiple messages during the transaction, including to start payment, authenticate it, authorise it, confirm debit, confirm credit, and confirm status at each step.

And so on.

On the hardware side, UPI requires thousands of servers, which process transactions, store and use databases, facilitate API calls, run monitoring and security systems; high-speed network switches and routers, which connect banks and data centres; and redundant servers, cooling systems, networking equipment, and of course power supplies.

On the software side, the system is made possible by APIs, transaction switches and routers, databases, message queues, encryption and authentication services, fraud detectors, reconciliation software, and disaster recovery protocols. The banks and the apps also have software to connect their systems with the NPCI infrastructure.

The UPI ID

The UPI ID, e.g., shankar@flutebank or selvi@violinbank, is created and maintained by the respective bank, based on a rule the bank has.

For example, if two account holders have the same name, their IDs can be distinguished by a number – selvi1@violinbank and selvi2@violinbank. Users may also be able to customise their UPI IDs, e.g. selvithestar@violinbank.

Fundamentally, the UPI app knows that the string before the '@' is the user account's alias and the string after the '@' is the bank's identity. The latter tells the UPI system which service will know which account the former is an alias of.

An individual user can have multiple UPI IDs because their bank account can have multiple aliases. These aliases can also be encoded in QR codes.

UPI – past, present, future

The NPCI built the UPI system with entrepreneur and Infosys co-founder Nandan Nilekani as an advisor and with the Reserve Bank of India (RBI) providing regulatory guidance. Its foundation was as an interoperable layer over the Immediate Payment Service (IMPS), which is a system to quickly transfer funds from one bank to another round the clock.

Then RBI Governor Raghuram Rajan piloted UPI in April 2016 with 21 banks, with the service also becoming available via the banks' apps a couple months later. UPI 2.0 followed in mid-2018 with new features like linking overdraft accounts, adding mandates (authorising periodic transactions into the future), verifying invoices before payment, signed QR codes (to better verify merchants before transactions), and enhanced autopayments.

The UPI system crossed 100 crore transactions per month in October 2019.

NPCI International Payments, Ltd. (NIPL) is a wholly owned subsidiary of the NPCI whose job is to facilitate international adoption of India's digital payments systems, especially UPI.

In 2021, NIPL and the Royal Monetary Authority of Bhutan enabled UPI in the kingdom – the first foreign adoption. Then, Singapore followed in 2021, the UAE in 2022, France, Mauritius, Sri Lanka, and Nepal in 2024, Qatar in 2025, and Cambodia, Greece, and the Maldives so far in 2026.

NIPL is reportedly also working on making UPI interoperable with the payment systems of Indonesia, Malaysia, and Thailand.

THE DAILY QUIZ

Please send in your answers to dailyquiz@thehindu.co.in

August 31 happens to be the birthday of former Philippine president Ramon Magsaysay. Here is a quiz on Indian Magsaysay Award winners

Srinivasan Ramani

QUESTION 1

Who was the first Indian to win the Magsaysay Award as early as 1958?

QUESTION 2

Who won the award in 1965 for public service? What was the title that he was known by?

QUESTION 3

Name the Indian who won the award in 1974. Apart from her primary area of expertise, she also acted in films in her youth. Name the last and most prominent film featuring her?

QUESTION 4

Another award winner in 2005, this person was born into a family that had two distinguished Nobel laureates. She served as a leading doctor and director of the Cancer Institute in Chennai for a number of years. Name her.

QUESTION 5

A former IAS officer, this awardee led major campaigns, the most prominent of which was the National Campaign for the People's Right to Information, which culminated in the Right to Information Act being passed in 2005. Name her.

Visual Question:

Identify this awardee. Cited for "guiding the people of [Andhra Pradesh] to end the scourge of child labour and send all of their children to school". WIKIPEDIA

Questions and Answers to the previous day's daily quiz: 1. Malaysians celebrate 'Hari Merdeka' on August 31 to commemorate the independence of the Federation of Malaya from British rule. On what date do they celebrate Malaysia Day, which marks the formation of Malaysia? **Ans: September 16**

2. What is the monarch, who is elected from nine hereditary Malay Rulers for a five-year term, called, and who is the present ruler? **Ans: Yang di-Pertuan Agong and Sultan Ibrahim**

3. Whose portrait is featured on the Malaysian Ringgit? **Ans: Tuanku Abdul Rahman (the first Yang di-Pertuan Agong)**

4. Name the famous archipelago with 99 islands and geological formations that became Malaysia's first UNESCO Global Geopark. **Ans: Langkawi**

5. Name the Malaysian-born actress who became the first Asian woman to win the Best Actress Oscar in 2023. **Ans: Michelle Yeoh for her role in *'Everything Everywhere All at Once'***

6. In which sport did Nicol David win a record eight World Open titles? **Ans: Squash**

7. Which Bornean primate is known for its large, pendulous nose in males? **Ans: The proboscis monkey**

Visual: Name the place where this famous statue of Lord Muruga is located. **Ans: Batu Caves on the outskirts of Kuala Lumpur**

Early Birds: C. Saravanan | Mohan Lal Patel | Erfanally Oosmany | Tito Shiladitya | Prodosh Mitra

FROM THE ARCHIVES

Know your English

S. Upendran

"You haven't finished reading that article yet?"

"Give me a couple of minutes, will you? Tell me, how do you pronounce p..r..e..c..o..c..i..o..u..s?"

"Has that word been used in the article?"

"You bet. The author has used it several times."

"I see. Well, the 'e' in the first syllable 'pre' is pronounced like the "i" in "sit", "bit" and "pit"; the following 'o' is like the 'o' in 'so', 'go' and 'no'."

"The final 'ious' is like the 'ious' in 'precious' and 'ambitious', I suppose?"

"Exactly! The 'c' in the second syllable is like the 'k' in 'kit', 'kin', and 'kiss', while...."

".... the final 'c' is like the 'sh' in 'ship', 'sheep', and 'sheet'. I had already guessed that. But tell me, what does the word mean?"

"Why don't you try and figure it out? How does the author use the word?"

"Well, he says that Jennifer Capriati 'burst onto the world tennis scene as a precocious 14-year old'."

"So what do you think the author is trying to say?"

"That 14-year old Jennifer was very talented?"

"That's right! The word is normally used with children. When you say that a child is 'precocious' what you are implying is that he/she is very clever or talented at something. The kind of talent that you would expect to find in an adult, but certainly not in a child."

"In other words, the child is mature beyond his/her years. Is that what you are saying?"

"Well, I guess you could say that."

"Devayani had precocious talent for music and dance."

"Though as a five-year-old, Saritha displayed precocious talent for tennis, her parents refused to send her to coaching camps."

"Were you a precocious child?"

"Me? You must be joking. I don't think anyone in my family was precocious."

"Didn't you say that your cousin Suresh was precocious? I remember you...."

"...I definitely didn't say that."

"But you said that he was a wonderful pilot. And I also think...."

"I probably said that he is rash. He is one of those who flies by the seat of his pants."

"Flies by the seat of his pants?"

"When you say that someone is doing something by the seat of his pants, what you are implying is that he is doing something instinctively. He is not doing things according to any well thought out plan."

"No thinking involved, eh? Then, can I say, our Chief Minister has no clue what he is doing. He is flying by the seat of his pants."

"I don't think so. You see, our poor Chief Minister is not doing anything, actually. He is merely a mouthpiece for somebody else. Somebody else is running the State for him. Try this example. The electrician that the company sent had no clue what he was doing. He was merely flying by the seat of his pants."

"Most traders don't know what is happening in the stock market. Many of them are flying by the seat of their pants."

"The expression can also be used to mean, 'by sheer luck and very little skill'. My cousin got through school by the seat of his pants."

"If I get through, it will probably be by the seat of my pants."

Published in The Hindu on October 23, 2001

Word of the day

Tact: consideration in dealing with others and avoiding giving offence.

Synonyms: diplomacy, manners, courtesy, respect

Usage: *She handled the sensitive issue with great tact.*

Pronunciation: newsth.live/tact

International Phonetic Alphabet: /tækt/

For feedback and suggestions for Text & Context, please write to **letters@thehindu.co.in** with the subject 'Text & Context'

From Page One

Ensure peace, freedom of navigation: PM to Iran

President Pezeshkian said his country had a "responsibility" to defend the Iranian people "from danger and insecurity and to create conditions necessary for them to achieve peace, tranquillity and security". He said Iran was "focused on ensuring peace and security and resolving issues through dialogue and negotiations."

Mr. Pezeshkian blamed Israel and the U.S. for creating "restrictions and obstacles" before Iran and said that "despite the pressures and restrictions being imposed in an attempt to obstruct Iran's relations with other countries, Tehran is ready to expand its cooperation with India".

He referred to the ceasefire and said, "The Islamic Republic of Iran has remained committed to the obligations it has undertaken within the framework of the agreements, but unfortunately, the American side has failed to fulfil its commitments."

Over 6 crore names deleted so far in SIR 3.0

In absolute numbers, Karnataka had the second-most deletions, at 1.07 crore, after Maharashtra. Telangana has the third-highest number of deletions, with 73,39,235 names removed, followed by Delhi, Andhra Pradesh, 44,89,512, and Jharkhand, 43,61,987. In Haryana, 33.83 lakh names were deleted in the draft list, while Punjab saw 20,66,635 deletions and Odisha 20,12,557.

In a letter to Chief Election Commissioner Gyanesh Kumar, Karnataka Chief Minister D.K. Shivakumar has raised serious concerns over what he called the "massive and unjustified" voter deletions under the SIR process, urging the EC to extend the claims and objections window. Telangana Chief Minister has also done the same.

The SIR exercise has already been conducted in Bihar, West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Puducherry, Uttar Pradesh, Rajasthan, Madhya Pradesh, Gujarat, Chhattisgarh, Goa, the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, and Lakshadweep. In Assam, due to the legalities of the National Register of Citizens (NRC), a "special revision" of electoral rolls was conducted instead of SIR.

With the third phase, the SIR exercise has covered most of the country, except Himachal Pradesh, Jammu and Kashmir, and Ladakh. The SIR schedule for these will be announced later, after the completion of Phase II of the Census and with due consideration of the weather in the snowbound areas, the EC had said earlier.

The SIR process has led to acrimony between Opposition parties and the EC, and it has also been challenged in courts. In March, the Supreme Court unanimously upheld the constitutional validity of the EC's move to carry out the SIR.

Manipur Deputy CM threatens to walk out

The Naga MLAs further demanded the immediate abrogation of the Suspension of Operation agreement that the Centre had signed with 25 Kuki-Zo rebel groups in 2008, citing alleged repeated violations and acts of terror against civilians.

"When the mutilated bodies of the six Naga men are still unclaimed in protest against the non-arrest of the perpetrators, another four Naga men were mercilessly killed in the IT road ambush on August 27, carried out by the Kuki militants," the MLAs wrote, citing some other incidents of violence. They warned that if action were not initiated, they would be "unable to defend or adequately respond to the challenges raised by the public concerning our continued support to the Government of Manipur."

Manipur had 10 Naga MLAs. One of them, N. Kayisii of the NPP, died in January 2025.

Minor girl gang-raped on moving bus in Noida

Driver, conductor of sleeper bus offered to drop the girl at Noida's Sector 63 after she had mistakenly reached Pari Chowk before the crime, say police; Congress, AAP slam Delhi govt.

Lavpreet Kaur
NEW DELHI

A 17-year-old girl from Uttar Pradesh was allegedly gang-raped by a bus driver and conductor inside a moving sleeper bus after they offered her a lift amid heavy rain in the Delhi-National Capital Region, the police said on Monday.

The alleged sexual assault reportedly took place around 11.30 p.m. on August 4 during a 60-km journey from Pari Chowk in Greater Noida to Sector 63 in Noida and then towards Outer Ring Road, where the girl was abandoned.

The accused, Kuldeep (driver) and Sandeep (conductor), have been arrested while the bus has been seized and sent for forensic examination.

Speaking to *The Hindu*, Deputy Commissioner of Police (North) Niharika Bhatt said the girl, a Class 11 student from Mainpuri district of Uttar Pradesh, had left her home to visit her cousin in Sector 63. Amid heavy rain and darkness, she accidentally reached Pari Chowk in Greater Noida.

The empty sleeper bus passing through the area stopped after she signalled to the driver. The driver and conductor told her they were heading towards Noida Sector 63 and offered to drop her there, the official said.

The police have seized the bus for forensic examination; the sleeper bus is seen parked near Timarpur police station. SUSHIL KUMAR VERMA

Assault and threats

Shortly after the bus began moving, the conductor made obscene gestures towards the girl. The two accused then allegedly sexually assaulted her inside the bus and threatened to kill her if she resisted, according to her statement to the police.

The girl told the police that the bus reached Sector 63 but the driver continued towards Delhi, eventually taking her to Ring Road near the Kashmere Gate area.

The accused then dropped her near Kashmere Gate and fled. The girl took an autorickshaw to Kashmere Gate police station and reported the incident, the DCP said.

The police immediately formed teams to trace the bus and identified the vehicle. The two accused were subsequently traced to a bus parking lot in Timarpur in north Delhi and arrested. The seized bus has been sent for forensic examination.

The police are now preparing to file a chargesheet in the case.

The case triggered a political row, with the Congress targeting the BJP governments in Delhi and Uttar Pradesh over women's safety. In a post on X, the party said the incident had "shaken the nation".

The party alleged that there was no adequate patrolling or checking, and said the case exposed what it described as "hollow claims" about women's safety under the BJP governments.

CM slammed

AAP leader Saurabh Bharadwaj criticised Delhi Chief Minister Rekha Gupta over the government's handling of cases involving children. In a video message, he described her approach towards cases of child rape as "insensitive" and "disgusting", and alleged that Delhi was becoming a "capital of child rape", citing other recent cases.

Following the incident, National Human Rights Commission member Priyank Kanoongo said, "We have taken cognisance of the incident and issued notices to the authorities. We have sought information on the child's rehabilitation, social investigation and care plan."

Centre defers Census exercise in Manipur amid NRC demands

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

The Union government has deferred Census operations in Manipur, the Chief Minister's Office said on Monday.

The decision followed a high-level review meeting in New Delhi to assess the current situation in the State. Union Home Minister Amit Shah headed the meeting, which was attended by Manipur Governor Ajay Kumar Bhalla, Chief Minister Yumnam Khemchand Singh, Union Home Secretary Govind Mohan, and other senior officials.

The focus of the meeting was on the demand raised by the people of Manipur, specifically Meitei, Pangals (Meitei Muslims), and Nagas, to update the National Register of Citizens (NRC) before conducting the Census. "It was agreed to defer the Census exercise in the State considering the feelings and aspirations of the people," the Chief Minister said.

The Chief Minister reminded certain groups in Manipur that shutdowns and general strikes would not help in pressing their demands before the government. Instead, he urged the civil society groups to continue dialogue and extend full cooperation to the administration in addressing the socio-political challenges of the State.

Yumnam Khemchand Singh

HC order on Census

The High Court of Manipur also ordered that the Census exercise in the State remain deferred until further orders. The exercise was scheduled to begin on September 1. On Monday, a Special Bench comprising Chief Justice M. Sundar and Justice A. Guneswar Sharma heard two separate petitions, one filed by the Kangleipak Students' Association and the other by Shanta Nahakpam, the convener of 14 civil society groups.

The petitions sought directions to update the NRC using 1951 as the base year and to address concerns over illegal migration from Myanmar before the Census is carried out.

Unidentified gunmen kill 3 Kuki villagers in Manipur's Kangpokpi

The Hindu Bureau
GUWAHATI

Unidentified gunmen on Monday killed three Kuki villagers, two of them women, and injured four along the same road in Manipur's Kangpokpi district, where four Liangmai Naga civilians were gunned down on August 27.

According to Kuki-Zo organisations, the incident occurred around 9.30 a.m. They said suspected members of two Naga extremist groups attacked N. Teikhang Kuki village near IT Road and opened fire while torching several houses.

The deceased were identified as Tingneichin Lhouvum, 40, Hoineineng Lhoujem, 21, and Lamtinthang Lhoujem, 36. Two women were among the injured. N. Teikhang Kuki village is close to Makui Ashang village, near where suspected Kuki extremists allegedly killed the four Nagas in the previous week.

Representational photo of security personnel.

In a statement, the Twilang Area CSO Working Committee condemned the attack and blamed it on the National Socialist Council of Nagaland (Isak-Muivah), or NSCN (I-M), and the Zeliangrong United Front (Kamson), or ZUF (K). The two Naga groups had not reacted at the time of reporting.

Railways set to facilitate travel of Nepal flood victims

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Expressing concern over the devastating floods in Nepal, Railway Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw on Monday said the Railways is making arrangements for rescued passengers arriving in India.

He said that the Railways has arranged special coaches and other necessary facilities to help them reach their destinations. "The Railway Board is working in coordination with railway zones, district and State authorities and the Ministry of External Affairs to facilitate the safe movement and return of passengers affected by the situation in Nepal," Mr. Vaishnaw said. He was speaking at the inauguration of the gauge conversion and electrification of the Nepalganj Road-Nanpara-Bahraich rail section.

SC Collegium picks new Chief Justice for Rajasthan High Court

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court Collegium on Monday recommended Chhattisgarh High Court judge, Justice Sanjay K. Agrawal, for appointment as the Chief Justice of Rajasthan High Court.

The resolution by the Collegium headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant came days after letters written by serving top court judge, Justice Sandeep Mehta, complaining of the conduct of Rajasthan Acting Chief Justice S.P. Sharma, came to light through reports in the media. Justice Mehta, in a series of three letters in August, had accused Justice Sharma of "favouritism" and misconduct.

Chief Justice Kant, in a press statement, had said the Collegium would consider Justice Mehta's allegations through an institutional mechanism. The Collegium has also recommended new Chief Justices to the High Courts of Madhya Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh. Justices Alpesh Yeshvant Kogje of Gujarat and Dr. Pushpinder Singh Bhati of Rajasthan have been suggested for appointments as Chief Justices to Madhya Pradesh and Jammu and Kashmir and Ladakh High Courts, respectively.

The Collegium has, in a separate resolution, recommended the immediate transfer of Justice Agrawal to the Rajasthan High Court, pending his appointment as its Chief Justice.

SC raps probe agencies for 'dragging feet' in powerful persons' cases

Krishnadas Rajagopal
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday said probe agencies drag their feet when it comes to investigating or interrogating persons in authority, but do not bat an eyelid in cases dealing with ordinary persons.

The observations were made by a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant while hearing a petition filed by Sumit Roy, the personal assistant to Trinamool Congress MP Abhishek Banerjee, in connection with the Salboni land-grabbing case. In the previous hearing, the court stayed the arrest of Mr. Roy.

Senior advocate Gopal Sankaranarayanan, appearing for Mr. Roy, said his questioning by the Directorate of Enforcement (ED) was mostly about his family and the political party's activities.

Solicitor General Tushar Mehta, appearing for the ED, said the ED has confronted Mr. Roy and argued for his custodial interrogation, pointing out that approximately ₹30 crore was transferred to Leaps and Bounds Private Limited, a company linked to Mr. Banerjee.

Justice Joymalya Bagchi said the Calcutta High Court had expressed considerable "despair" at the lack of intensity in the interrogation of persons in the case. "In the ordinary prism of criminal investigation, you do not bat an eyelid to pass appropriate directions to enable the investigating agencies. But an additional layer comes in when agencies investigate authorities in respect of overlapping proceeds of crime investigations. They drag their feet on custodial investigation at certain times, and activate themselves at other times," Justice Bagchi said.

Congress calls GDP numbers 'Greatly Distorted Picture'

Ramesh says consumer confidence had fallen to its lowest level since the COVID-19 pandemic

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Congress on Monday questioned the 7.8% GDP growth recorded in the April-June quarter, with the party's communication chief Jairam Ramesh describing the figures as a "GDP – Greatly Distorted Picture" of the state of the economy.

In a post on X, Mr. Ramesh said the quarterly numbers failed to reflect the "decidedly depressed" private investment sentiment among both domestic and foreign investors. He said consumer confidence had fallen to its lowest level since the COVID-19 pandemic, while prices of household essentials were rising.

Mr. Ramesh also flagged the trade deficit with China, falling household savings and record levels of household debt. He alleged that the concentration of key sectors in the hands of a few large conglomerates had aggravated inequality, claiming that the wealth of India's five richest families had risen sharply even as real wages had declined.

Family of U.S. citizen held on terror charges seeks diplomatic help over his 'poor health'

Vijaita Singh
NEW DELHI

The family of a U.S. citizen, who was arrested by the National Investigation Agency (NIA) along with six Ukrainians on charges of illegally crossing into Myanmar from Mizoram to train armed ethnic groups in weapons handling and drone warfare, has said that U.S. Ambassador to India Sergio Gor has raised the issue with Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri and U.S. Secretary of State Marco Rubio, when the latter was on a visit to Delhi in May.

The family of Mathhew Van Dyke, who was detained at the Kolkata airport on March 11 and later arrested by the NIA, has renewed calls for urgent diplomatic intervention amid concerns over his health and prison conditions.

Dyke's advocate says he is in a high-security ward in Tihar and his judicial custody has been extended till September 8.

The External Affairs Ministry is yet to respond to the issue.

Sons of Liberty International, the NGO founded by Mr. Van Dyke, said that the accused reportedly began a liquids-only hunger strike on May 6, which he attempted to end on June 18.

"A humanitarian food application was approved July 21. Matthew Van Dyke has yet to receive approved mosquito nets, and kettle. Matthew is reportedly eating only oatmeal as other purchased foods are not provided to him," it added.

The family said Mr. Van Dyke was transferred from the NIA headquarters to Tihar Jail in Delhi on April 6 "despite suffering from an injured leg, declining eyesight, and without access to his prescribed medication."

It said that his mother, Sharon Van Dyke, who is over 80, was only allowed a five-minute emergency call with him months ago.

Advocates Rohit Dandriyal and Rohit Gour applied to the Delhi Court for Mr. Van Dyke's medical treatment at a private hospital and establishment of proper communication with his family in the U.S.

"However, the Delhi Court denied both application requests on June 1 alleging foreign government communications," the statement added.

Mr. Gour said that Mr. Van Dyke is lodged in a high-security ward in Tihar and his judicial custody has been extended till September 8. "The NIA is yet to file a chargesheet and the specific allegations against Van Dyke are not clear," he said.

Mr. Van Dyke, along with six Ukrainians, has been charged under Section 18 of the Unlawful Activities (Prevention) Act (UAPA). Earlier, the NIA had told the court that they had entered India on tourist visas and later travelled to Mizoram allegedly without obtaining the required Protected Area Permit, crossed the border to Myanmar, and were allegedly planning to train anti-India ethnic armed groups there.

'Hydrocarbon exploration scheme to benefit Adani'

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

Alleging that the Centre's ₹84,084-crore Samudra Manthan scheme for offshore hydrocarbon exploration was designed to benefit the Adani Group, the Congress on Monday demanded that it either be scrapped or that its entire outlay be diverted to the public sector Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC).

Addressing a press conference here, Congress spokesperson Shaktisinh Gohil said the Union Cabinet approved the scheme last month for its first phase, and claimed that it had created a framework under which companies undertaking offshore exploration, including Adani-owned Well Spun Exploration Ltd. (AWEL), would receive substantial financial support from the government.

Mr. Gohil asked why ONGC, which had decades of experience in hydrocarbon exploration, was not being given the primary role in the national mission.

There was no response from the government or the Adani Group to the Congress's allegations.

PM calls for 'end of war' at meeting with Putin

The two leaders discuss conflicts in West Asia and Black Sea region, impact on maritime trade and safety of Indian seafarers; Putin highlights positive trends in Moscow-New Delhi economic ties

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

Prime Minister Narendra Modi on Monday met Russian President Vladimir Putin on the sidelines of the SCO summit in Bishkek and said the world "must move from endless war to end of war for the benefit of humanity".

The External Affairs Ministry said the two leaders discussed conflicts in West Asia and in the Black Sea region, where, in recent months, Indian seafarers have been attacked by both Russian and Ukrainian forces.

"Had extensive discussions with President Putin. Discussed the full range of the India-Russia Special and Privileged Strategic Partnership. It is gladdening to see significant progress across various sectors in recent years. Focus areas for India-Russia friendship remain energy, innovation, space, fertilizers, and people-to-people linkages," said Prime Minister Modi.

In a statement, the External Affairs Ministry said,

Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Russian President Vladimir Putin during a meeting in Bishkek on Monday. ANI

Number of Indian students in Russia increased almost seven-fold in a decade, says Putin

"They also shared perspectives on key regional and global issues of mutual interest, including the conflicts in West Asia and the Black Sea region which have impacted maritime trade and the safety and security of Indian seafarers. Prime Minister reiterated that dialogue and diplomacy was the way forward in resolving conflicts." The upcoming BRICS summit featured prominently in the discussion, and Mr. Modi said he "looks forward to welcoming President Putin in India for the 18th BRICS summit on 12-13 September".

80th anniversary of ties

The Bishkek meeting between Mr. Modi and Mr. Putin featured in talks during External Affairs Minister S. Jaishankar's visit to the Kremlin on August 24, when Mr. Putin had indicated that he would meet Prime Minister Modi in Kyrgyzstan and also at the BRICS summit in Delhi.

"This time, our meeting is taking place on the eve of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation Summit - an organisation that works to deepen contacts among the countries of the Global South and East, promotes the region's socioeconomic and cultural development, and contributes to building a just multipolar world," said President Putin in his remarks, reminding that next year will mark the 80th anniversary of establishment of diplomatic relations between New Delhi and Moscow.

Mr. Putin noted that the number of Indian students in Russia has increased almost seven-fold in a decade, and currently 40,000 Indians are studying in Russia.

President Putin said trade and economic cooperation between Russia and India is showing positive trends, with trade turnover increasing by more than 2%. He noted the growth in tourist exchanges between the two countries, with a 16% increase in 2025.

India rejects Hague court's Indus Waters Treaty ruling, says it has no jurisdiction

Kallol Bhattacherjee
NEW DELHI

Hours after the Permanent Court of Arbitration at The Hague said the Indus Waters Treaty remains "fully in force" and called on India to "observe its obligations", the External Affairs Ministry rejected this, saying that the "very establishment of this alleged arbitral body" was a "grave violation" of the treaty.

"This so-called Court was constituted by the World Bank in patent breach of the terms of the Treaty, and India categorically rejects its so-called award," the Ministry said on Monday.

It went on to say that India had "never recognised the existence in law of this illegally-constituted and so-called Court of Arbitration, and has consistently maintained that the very establishment of this alleged arbitral body constitutes a grave violation of the Indus Waters Treaty".

"Accordingly, India has never appeared before this body and has refused to take any cognisance of its earlier pronouncements," the Ministry said.

India had placed the Indus Waters Treaty "in abeyance" following the Pahalgam terror attack on April 22, 2025, and the Ministry, in its response on Monday, reiterated its position. "India's decision to hold the Indus Waters Treaty in abeyance remains in force," it said.

India had placed the treaty in abeyance following the Pahalgam terror attack.

The Ministry also said that "this so-called Court of Arbitration has no jurisdiction whatsoever to pronounce on India's sovereign decisions".

It added that the court's pronouncements, "now or in the future, will have no effect on India's actions in connection with the projects being undertaken by India".

Earlier, the arbitration body, considering Pakistan's plea, examined the reasons under which India placed the treaty "in abeyance" and said that "none of these grounds could justify suspension or termination of the Treaty".

Issuing an "award" on the 'Status of the Indus Waters Treaty and Order on Interim Measures concerning the Ratle Hydro-Electric Plant (RHEP)', the Permanent Court of Arbitration said, "Accordingly, the Indus Waters Treaty remains fully in force, and India must observe its obligations under the Treaty, including those relating to the design and operation of its hydro-electric projects on the Western Rivers."

It had also considered Pakistan's plea on imposing measures on India regarding the RHEP, saying, "In a unanimous decision, the Court decided to impose measures prohibiting India from concreting the RHEP dam wall and power intake structure above certain levels until 90 days after the Neutral Expert's final decision, which is expected in July 2027."

The Court of Arbitration is chaired by Prof. Sean D. Murphy of the U.S.

FIR against Rahul exposes BJP's casteist mindset: Cong.

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

After the Uttarakhand Police registered a case against Leader of the Opposition in the Lok Sabha Rahul Gandhi over his remarks on the "purification" ceremony which "insulted" Congress president Mallikarjun Kharge, the party on Sunday said it "exposed BJP's casteist mindset".

Congress general secretary (organisation) K.C. Venugopal announced that party workers across the country would take to the streets on Monday evening to demand "prosecution of the BJP leaders who insulted Kharge*ji* and to defend our Constitution against the BJP's assault on its values of social justice".

The party described the first information report (FIR) against Mr. Gandhi as an attempt to divert attention from the allegations of caste discrimination and suppress the voices demanding action against those involved in the purported "*shuddhikaran*" (purification) ceremony at the venue of Mr. Kharge's public meeting in Haldwani in Uttarakhand.

"What is worse is that the BJP jumped in to defend this abhorrently casteist behaviour, showing to the entire world that they are the biggest perpetrators of social injustice today," Mr. Venugopal said.

He alleged that the BJP

K.C. Venugopal

was willing to deploy the "entire might of the State" against those who spoke out against atrocities committed against Dalits.

"What the BJP has done is to attack the values of social justice enshrined in the Constitution, and the Congress will fight against this attack tooth and nail," he said. "We will not rest until the true culprits of the insult to Kharge*ji* are punished, and this frivolous FIR against Rahul*ji* is thrown in the dustbin."

Congress general secretary Jairam Ramesh said Mr. Gandhi had raised the issues of injustice, humiliation and discrimination faced by Dalits, and alleged that the BJP-RSS had "proved him right" within 24 hours.

'Bid to divert attention'

"This is the very mindset against which Babasaheb's Constitution stands as the greatest wall," Mr. Ramesh said, alleging that the BJP was seeking to divert attention and suppress dissent.

Congress general secretary in charge of Uttarakhand Kumari Selja questioned why no FIR had been registered against those who allegedly conducted the ritual.

"No action against those who conducted the 'purification' ritual after Congress President Shri Mallikarjun Kharge*ji*'s public meeting, but an FIR against Leader of Opposition Shri Rahul Gandhi*ji* for raising his voice against that casteist act. Is this the justice of the BJP government?" she asked.

The Congress's Scheduled Castes department chairman Rajendra Pal Gautam alleged that the incident amounted to a violation of the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act and questioned the police's failure to act against those allegedly responsible.

On the issue of FIR, BJP spokesperson Gaurav Bhatia said at a press conference: "There has never been, nor will there ever be, a leader in India more irresponsible and more anti-Dalit... than Rahul Gandhi. He should introspect."

The BJP leader said that after Mr. Kharge alleged that he had been insulted, Mr. Gandhi did not take notice of it for three weeks. "Rahul Gandhi has time to travel around the world. However, when someone from the Dalit or backward community makes an allegation, he himself does not take it seriously," he said.

SC rejects petition for mandatory ethanol disclosure at pumps

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday refused to entertain a petition alleging an element of "silent compulsion" in the rollout of E20 petrol and seeking mandatory disclosure of the ethanol content in petrol sold at fuel stations across the country.

A Bench of Justices M.M. Sundresh and Prasanna B. Varale was hearing a petition by advocate and petitioner-in-person Narendra Kumar Goswami, contending that consumers were entitled to know the composition, quality, standards and compatibility implications of the fuel they purchase. Such disclosure, the plea said, was not a "decorative consumer slogan but a constitutional requirement when the State itself creates a nationwide compulsory market".

The Bench declined to entertain the plea, observing that the petitioner could approach the competent authority with his grievance instead of directly moving the Supreme Court.

SC stays proceedings against gym owner in rioting case

Aaratrika Bhaumik
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday stayed criminal proceedings against Kotdwar-based gym owner Deepak Kumar, better known as 'Mohammed' Deepak, who was booked for rioting following an alleged altercation with Bajrang Dal workers over the name of a shop.

The top court also stayed a March 20 order of the Uttarakhand High Court, restraining Mr. Kumar from making social media posts concerning the incident and the case. Mr. Kumar came into national focus after he confronted a group of right-wing activists accused of harassing a 71-year-old Muslim shop owner, pressuring him to rename his store in the town on January 26.

A Bench of Justices Vikram Nath and Sandeep Mehta granted the interim relief while seeking the Uttarakhand government's response on Mr. Kumar's petition challenging the High Court's refusal to quash the First Information Report (FIR) against

The court also stayed an order restraining Deepak Kumar from making social media posts concerning the case. FILE PHOTO

him. "Issue notice returnable within four weeks. In the meantime, proceedings pursuant to the impugned FIR shall remain stayed, and also the effect and operation of the impugned order passed by the High Court," the Bench said in its brief order.

'Good Samaritan'

Appearing for Mr. Kumar, senior advocate A.M. Singhvi submitted that a case of rioting was not made out against his client as the essential ingredients of the offence were absent. He contended that Mr. Kumar had intervened only after Bajrang Dal members confronted a Muslim shopkeeper over the use of the word "Baba" in the name of his shop. "How can a Good Samaritan be subjected to this kind of a complaint?" Mr. Singhvi asked, questioning the initiation of criminal proceedings against his client.

He also assailed the High Court's direction restraining Mr. Kumar from posting about the incident on social media, describing it as a "blanket gag order". He contended that instead of granting relief to Mr. Kumar, the High Court had imposed an additional restriction on him.

Taking the submissions into account, the Bench stayed both the criminal proceedings and the operation of the High Court directive, and sought the Uttarakhand government's response within four weeks. In its March order, the High Court rejected his prayers for police protection, registration of an FIR against those who had allegedly assembled outside his gym on January 31, and a departmental inquiry against police officials. It had observed that the reliefs sought were an attempt to "sensationalise" the issue and could interfere with the investigation.

TIRUMALA TIRUPATI DEVASTHANAMS - TIRUPATI
TENDER NOTICE / REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

RFP/Tender Notice No.: Roc.No.02/DEO/TTD/Tpt/2026-27, Date: 27.08.2026.
TTD invites offline sealed Technical and Financial Proposals under Two- Bid System from eligible and reputed academic institutions/organizations for Selection of an Academic Partner for Providing Integrated Offline Classroom Coaching for Medical, Engineering and Allied Professional Entrance Examinations to Intermediate Students of TTD Junior Colleges for the years 2026-28 (2 years). Bid document available in TTD website www.tirumala.org, from 01.09.2026. **Last Date & Time for Submission: 25.09.2026 @ 3.00 PM.**
For Details: Phone: 0877-2264062, E-mail:deottd@gmail.com., Website: www.tirumala.org.

TTD-40021(31)/1/2026-PRO SEC(Adv.No.167) Date:31-08-2026 **EXECUTIVE OFFICER**

Office of the Director, Department of Animal Husbandry, Uttarakhand, Dehradun
E-PROCUREMENT NOTICE

No: 2860-61 /Purchase Cell/ 2026-27/ **Dated 31-08-2026**

The Chairman, State Purchase Committee, Department of Animal Husbandry, Uttarakhand, on behalf of the Government of Uttarakhand, invites separate e-tenders for Rate Contract for the supply of Veterinary Allopathic Medicines and Veterinary vaccines for Veterinary Hospitals/ Indenting Officers of Uttarakhand. Tender documents shall be available for download on uktenders.gov.in from September 01, 2026, at 10:00 AM. Online bid submission shall close on September 14, 2026, at 5:00 PM.

Director/Chairman State Purchase Committee
Department of Animal Husbandry,
Uttarakhand, Dehradun.

TRAVANCORE DEVASWOM BOARD
Devaswom Commissioner Office
Nanthancode, Thiruvananthapuram - 695 003
E-mail: dcotdb@gmail.com Ph: 9188911421

ROC NO: 26/2026/SAB **31-08-2026**

Re E-Tender Notice for Sabarimala

Competitive Re e-tenders are invited from experienced manufacturers, distributors, and contractors through **https://etenders.kerala.gov.in** for the supply of required materials for the preparation and distribution of offering Prasadams (Vazhipadu Prasadam) in connection with Mandala-Makaravilakku, Meda Vishu, Monthly Poojas, and other requirements for the year 1202 ME (2026–2027) at Sabarimala, Pamba and Nilakkal Devaswoms under the Travancore Devaswom Board.

Sl.No	Item Required	Quantity	EMD
1.	Powdered Jaggery	5,000 MT	10,00,000/-

Submission starting date : 01-09-2026, 10.00 AM
Re E-Tender closing date : 13-09-2026, 10.00 AM
Re E-Tender opening date : 14-09-2026, 10.00 AM

- More details and conditions are available at our website **www.travancoredevaswomboard.org**
- All tender processing - related queries will be entertained only online.

Sd/-, Devaswom Commissioner

WATCO
OFFICE OF THE MANAGING DIRECTOR, WATCO
Ground Floor, Unnati Bhawan,
H.B.Colony, Satyanagar, Bhubaneswar-751007, Odisha, India
Telefax: - +91-674-2571444; E-mail – mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com .

INVITATION FOR BID (IFB) - Bid Identification No. WATCO(W)-14/2026-27, Dtd.25.08.2026

WATCO No. 9912 / Date: 25.08.2026

1. Name of the work :- 1. Annual Maintenance of Facultative Pond, Wet Well and Pumping Station at Meherpalli.
2. Annual Operation and Maintenance of STP, P7 and Septage Treatment Plant and all SPS.
3. Estimated Cost : Rs.63.18 Lakh to Rs.257.62 Lakh
4. Period of completion : 12 (Twelve) Months
5. Date & Time of availability of bid document in the portal. : From 5.00 PM of Dt. 02.09.2026 to 5.00 PM of Dt. 22.09.2026
6. Last date / time of receipt of bids in the portal : 5.00 PM of Dt. 22.09.2026
7. Date & Time of opening of technical bids : 12.30 PM of Dt. 24.09.2026
8. Name and Address of the Officer Inviting Bid : MD, WATCO, Telefax:- 0674-2571444. E-Mail : mdwatcoodisha@gmail.com
9. The bidders have to participate in ONLINE bidding only.

Further details can be seen from the web site www.tendersodisha.gov.in .

(Managing Director), WATCO

13001/1704/2627 OIPR-13001/13263/1/26-27/0014

GOVERNMENT OF ODISHA
HIGHER EDUCATION DEPARTMENT
Lokaseva Bhavan, Sachivalaya Marg, Bhubaneswar-751001
Phone: 0674-2954600/ 7894709964 I Website: https://dhe.odisha.gov.in I
Mail : rusa.odisha@gmail.com

REQUEST FOR PROPOSAL

Higher Education Department invites sealed tenders from eligible bidders for the following work: The complete set of bidding documents and other details are available at **https://dhe.odisha.gov.in**

Sl. No.	Name of the Work	Tender No.	Availability of RFP Document	Last date for submission of bids	Opening of technical bids	Tender Fee	EMD
1	Procurement, Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Laboratory Equipment & its accessories for Ravenshaw University, Kataka (RDE, Bhubaneswar) under of PM-USHA	PM-USHA: 03/2026	31/08/2026 to 22/09/2026 (up to 4:00 PM)	22/09/2026 (till 4:00 PM)	24/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	₹ 10,000/- + Applicable GST	₹ 5,00,000/-
2	Procurement, Supply, Installation & Commissioning of Laboratory Equipment & its accessories for Maharaja Sriram Chandra Bhanja Deo University, Mayurbhanj (RDE, Baleshwar) under of PM-USHA	PM-USHA: 04/2026	05/09/2026 to 28/09/2026 (up to 4:00 PM)	28/09/2026 (up to 4:00 PM)	30/09/2026 at 4:00 PM	₹ 10,000/- + Applicable GST	₹ 5,00,000/-

Bids for separate works must be sent separately by Speed Post/Registered Post only in the following address:
Joint Secretary to Govt. cum SPD (RUSA/ PM-USHA), Higher Education Dept., Lokaseva Bhavan, Bhubaneswar-751001.

Sd/-
Joint Secretary-cum-SPD (PM-USHA)

11001/287/2627 OIPR-11001/11001/1/26-27/0043

INBRIEF

Navy commissions *INS Nipun* for advanced operations

The Indian Navy commissioned *INS Nipun* on Monday at the Naval Dockyard in Mumbai. It is the second Diving Support Vessel (DSV) of the Nistar class and will significantly enhance the Navy's capabilities in deep-sea diving, underwater intervention, and submarine rescue. Presiding over the ceremony was Chief of the Naval Staff Admiral Krishna Swaminathan. According to the Ministry of Defence, *INS Nipun* is a specialist platform built to undertake complex underwater operations. The vessel was indigenously designed and built by the HSL in Visakhapatnam. Its induction marks another step towards self-reliance in defence shipbuilding.

Bomb threat forces diversion of Air India Express flight

An Air India Express flight from Saudi Arabia's Dammam to New Delhi was diverted to Ahmedabad after a crew member discovered a tissue paper carrying a warning message of a "bomb" aboard the aircraft. After the aircraft landed in Ahmedabad, security agencies checked it and found nothing suspicious, said Assistant Commissioner of Police (ACP), 'G' Division, V. N. Yadav, according to *PTI*. The official said an investigation has been launched. The flight had 32 passengers, who were accommodated at Terminal 2 of the Ahmedabad airport. Air India Express said that the aircraft will be released for operations after necessary security checks are completed.

Conman Sukesh gets 8-year jail term for posing as SC judge

A Delhi court sentenced conman Sukesh Chandrasekhar to eight years of rigorous imprisonment last week for impersonating a Supreme Court judge and attempting to influence judicial proceedings to secure bail in another criminal case. Chief Judicial Magistrate Harshita Mishra of Tis Hazari court sentenced Chandrasekhar on August 29 under Sections 170, 189 and 507 IPC. According to the sentencing order, the accused made multiple calls to a judicial officer on April 28, 2017, allegedly posing as a Supreme Court judge from South India and using a regional accent to make the impersonation appear genuine.

AIIMS cancels test at 2 Jaipur centres after 'power issues'

A computer-based examination centre in Jaipur's Sitapura area came under scrutiny on Monday after technical problems disrupted an All India Institute of Medical Sciences recruitment exam, a day after an internal power failure at the same facility forced the cancellation of the NEET-PG 2026 exam for 2,445 candidates. The same iON Digital Zone facility was being used for the AIIMS Common Recruitment Examination-5. The institute cancelled the CRE-5 at two exam centres in Jaipur following a disruption caused by internal power supply issues, a source said. The AIIMS has also directed TCS, which operates the exam centres, to submit a detailed report.

Jharkhand, Bihar sign pact on Sone water sharing

Amit Bhelari
PATNA

Bihar and Jharkhand signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) on sharing Sone river water on Monday.

The agreement was inked in Delhi in the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah, Bihar Chief Minister Samrat Choudhary, Jharkhand Chief Minister Hemant Soren, and Union Jal Shakti Minister C.R. Patil.

Mr. Choudhary said that a formal consensus has been reached to allocate 5.75 million-acre feet (MAF) of the river water to Bihar and 2 MAF to Jharkhand. The two States had a dispute over sharing 7.75 MAF of water allocated for then undivided Bihar under a 1973 agreement.

Mr. Shah said the agreement had resolved a long-pending water dispute in eastern India. He said it would provide irrigation water to lakhs of farmers in rural Bihar and Jharkhand and drinking water for a large population.

He added that this marked the fourth water agreement between States this year, which would enhance water availability for irrigation, rural development and drinking purposes.

After hottest August, bleak outlook for September rain

Many parts of the country are expected to remain drier than normal, says weather agency; as of August 31, monsoon rainfall was 14% below normal, with only central India recording a surplus

Jacob Koshy
NEW DELHI

India is likely to experience below-normal rainfall in September, with the India Meteorological Department (IMD) on Monday forecasting rainfall across the country to be at least 9% short of the long-period average of 167.9 mm. This comes after India experienced the hottest August since 1901.

Many parts of the country are expected to remain drier than normal, although parts of northwest, northeast, east, east-central India and isolated areas of southeast peninsular India could receive "normal to above-normal rainfall".

September brings in about a fifth of the June-September monsoon rain, less than July's 32% and August's 29%. In recent years, September rainfall has seen a relative uptick. As of August 31, India's cumulative monsoon rainfall was about 14% below normal, with central India in surplus but the northwest, east and northeast, and south peninsula all recording deficits. The shortfall was particularly pronounced in the east and northeast, and in the southern peninsula.

The IMD's models indicate that El Niño conditions are likely to intensify during the remainder of the monsoon. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

The IMD's outlook at a press briefing comes on the back of a dry August. India received 213.3 mm of rain in August, the seventh-lowest since 2001. The country's mean temperature reached 28.01 degrees Celsius, or about 0.67 degree Celsius above normal. The average minimum temperature, at 24.36 degrees Celsius, was also the highest on record.

IMD Director-General Mrutyunjay Mohapatra explained this as a consequence of the ongoing El Niño, which dries out the atmosphere and raises temperatures. However, the month was not uniformly dry, with repeated low-pressure systems bringing heavy rain across the Indo-Gangetic Plains and parts of central and eastern India.

For September, the IMD expects above-normal maximum temperatures over most of India and above-normal minimum temperatures over most areas, adding to the prospect of a warm, relatively dry end to the monsoon.

Four low-pressure systems, precursors to cyclonic storms, and mostly originating in the Bay of Bengal, persisted for a combined 26 days in August. This is substantially longer than the climatological average of 16.3 low-pressure days. However, their rainfall activity was confined to the Indo-Gangetic Plain. The systems repeatedly formed over the Bay of Bengal, moved west-northwest, and weakened over central and northern India.

Western Disturbances

Frequent Western Disturbances – extra-tropical storms originating in the Mediterranean – also interacted with the monsoon circulation and low-pressure or cyclonic circulations, helping concentrate intense rainfall over eastern, east-central and parts of northwestern India rather than producing a more widespread monsoon revival.

The IMD's models indicate that El Niño conditions are likely to intensify during the remainder of the 2026 southwest monsoon season. The IMD's July 31 outlook for August had indicated "below-normal" rainfall over much of the country, and said this "matched" observations over many regions.

Five-member NCLT Bench to hear Subhash Chandra case

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The National Company Law Tribunal (NCLT) on Monday formed a five-member Bench to decide on media baron Subhash Chandra's repayment plan in a personal insolvency case involving claims of more than ₹22,000 crore after a Division Bench failed to reach a majority verdict.

The Division Bench had referred the personal insolvency case against the Essel Group chairman to the tribunal's president for fresh adjudication after failing to reach majority consensus on a proposed ₹6.5 crore repayment plan despite referring the matter to a third judge.

The five-member Bench, formed for the first time in the NCLT's history, will be led by president Justice Anupinder Singh Grewal. The other members are Bachu Venkat Balaram Das, Mahendra Khandelwal, Atul Chaturvedi and Ravindra Chaturvedi.

Earlier, the matter had been referred to the third member, as the two-member Division Bench of Ashok Kumar Bhardwaj (Member Judicial), and Reena Sinha Puri (Member Technical), gave a split verdict on the repayment plan.

Remarks on Col. Sofiya: M.P. govt. yet to sanction Minister's prosecution

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Supreme Court on Monday recorded that the State of Madhya Pradesh is yet to give sanction for the prosecution of its Minister, Kunwar Vijay Shah, who is accused of making derogatory remarks about Colonel Sofiya Qureshi, an Army officer who briefed the media during 'Operation Sindoor'.

In May, the State government had argued that Mr. Shah possibly intended to "praise" Colonel Qureshi, but could not articulate his admiration suitably.

On Monday, the State's Intelligence chief appeared before a three-judge Bench headed by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant to inform that the investigation against Mr. Shah was complete and submitted in a sealed cover, awaiting State sanction for prosecution. The State said the file for sanction was awaiting decision at the gubernatorial level. The request for sanction for prosecution was made to the State government a year ago, in August 2025.

The court, in the previous hearing, had found the Minister's conduct "unfortunate". "We know that when a political personality wants to praise, how well they can do it. If he wanted to apologise, he should have done it immediately," the Chief Justice had addressed Mr. Mehta in the May hearing.

Senior advocate Maninder Singh, appearing for Mr. Shah, had submitted that the Minister had made a public apology. He sought an end to the case against the Minister.

CERN is exploring how India can be part of its future: Director-General

Vinaya Deshpande Pandit
MUMBAI

The world needs more mega-science projects, Mark Thomson, Director-General of CERN (European Organization for Nuclear Research), said in Mumbai on Monday.

He was in the city for the India premiere of *The Peace Particle*, a documentary on the CERN, at the Tata Institute of Fundamental Research. Mr. Thomson also delivered an address on "Particle physics: today and tomorrow".

While answering questions on the future projects of the CERN, Mr. Thomson said the Future Circular Collider would push the boundaries of innovation, technology, and imagination. The Future Circular Collider would be a new 91-km ring, which is expected to be operational by 2045-48. Its final stage would collide electrons and positrons. It has not yet been approved, but the CERN expected a positive decision by 2028, he said.

CERN D-G Mark Thomson. VINAYA DESHPANDE PANDIT

"Also, we are pausing for four years to bring a brighter version of LHC [Large Hadron Collider], which will be more powerful. We will use technologies we have not used before, because they were not there. In the very long term, we are looking at what happens in the future, after the LHC. We call it the Future Circular Collider. This will be an ambitious project, pushing the boundaries of technology, innovation and imagination, and is a project for humanities. Not just for particle physics. It is a scientific, visionary project," he said.

Particle accelerator

The LHC, built by CERN, is the world's largest and most powerful particle accelerator. The 27-km tunnel accelerates two beams of subatomic particles to near the speed of light and smashes them together. The Higgs boson was discovered using it.

The LHC was officially shut down on June 29, 2026. It is scheduled to remain offline till 2030.

The High-Luminosity LHC will have 10 times more brightness than the LHC.

"It will be an incredible scientific opportunity which will give a lot more data, better detectors and new techniques. It has real discovery potential," Mr. Thomson said.

He said that while we now know a lot about the universe, many deep mysteries remain, such as why it is made only of matter with hardly any antimatter, and what constitutes the unknown 95% of its mass and energy.

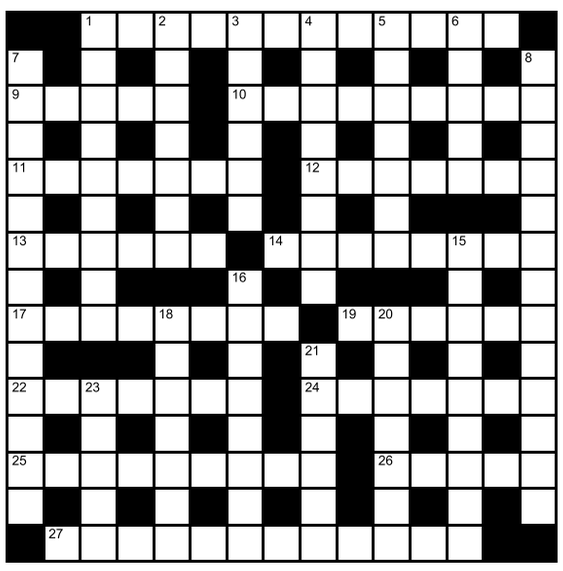
On the CERN's interest in India, Mr. Thomson said the country had great technological strength. "India has excellent technologies, is well-organised and has brilliant people. We are looking at CERN's future and how India can be a part of that," he said in conversation with *The Hindu* after the programme.

TH CROSSWORD + 14887

(set by Karaoke)

Solve this puzzle online and access more puzzles at *https://thehindu.com/crosswords*

SCAN TO PLAY



Across

1 Unintentional action in Persian Gulf essentially at war with Israel Defence Forces (8,4)
9 Mock trials at frequent intervals for some edible pods (5)
10 Outlaws stashing ill-gotten money? Certainly not (2,2,5)
11 East Pak remains around border region (7)
12 One who is challenged at mineral springs with disorder (7)
13 Armed combat ultimately turned on (6)
14 Boy in cab supplying frothy milk for kids (8)
17 Turn out space traveller and regret (4,4)
19 It is caustic when heads are rolled in "money down" (6)
22 Justify previous policy about income-tax initially (7)
24 Pall-bearer mourning at the end near watercourse carrying last rite (7)
25 Slashes advertisement without final budget and achieves nothing (4,2,3)
26 Admit adult, no girl, right? (3,2)
27 Brat needs old school for calculus (12)

Down

1 India and others in shape for an intense response (9)
2 Inventor of photographic film from America shot on vacation in style in retreat (7)
3 Perhaps Rob did spend time in prison (2,4)
4 His mind goes blank when adult cinemas are abandoned (8)
5 Reportedly a few tie the knot without resistance and argument (7)
6 Main line on a mine lost current, unfortunate! (5)
7 Playing cricket once with West mainly was something very difficult (6,7)
8 Hasty prophecy maybe for treatment of mental illness (13)
15 Home loan ahead of time (2,7)
16 Tollgate kept in shambles after intrusion of essential security (8)
18 Be prepared to handle, core business captured by rogue trade (7)
20 It flows essentially from coin melted with oxide primarily (7)
21 She preys on easy-goers near square (6)
23 Part of flower is soft, extremely elegant and lovely primarily (5)

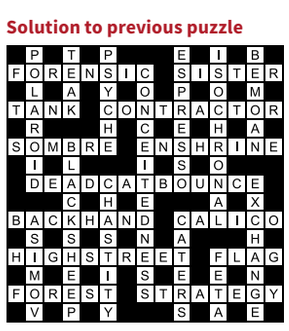
SUDOKU

	3	2			9	5		8
						3	1	
		8			1			
6		5	4		7			
				9				
			3		8	1		9
			5			4		
	4	3						
5		7	9			2	8	

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★★★★

No.SS6990 Distribution: www.knightfeatures.com

Solution to previous puzzle



Solution to yesterday's Sudoku

2	3	7	6	8	5	1	4	9
8	5	1	2	4	9	7	6	3
6	9	4	7	3	1	8	5	2
7	2	3	5	6	4	9	8	1
5	6	9	1	7	8	3	2	4
4	1	8	3	9	2	5	7	6
1	4	2	8	5	3	6	9	7
9	7	5	4	1	6	2	3	8
3	8	6	9	2	7	4	1	5

FAITH

Tirukkural and the Gita

Tirukkural, written by Tiruvalluvar, is one of the Tamil literature's greatest ethical works and is honoured as the "*Ulaga Podhu Marai*" (universal scripture). In concise couplets, it teaches the essential principles of human life – *aram* (virtue), *porul* (wealth and social responsibility), *inbam* (love), and the higher goal of *veedu* (liberation or moksha). Its teachings transcend language, religion, race, and nationality, making it relevant to all humanity. It guides individuals in righteousness, truth, compassion, generosity, patience, gratitude, justice, good governance, and social responsibility, said Thaneerpalli Krishnan Swamy in a discourse. Tiruvalluvar emphasises that knowledge alone does not make a person great; love, compassion, good character, and the ability to understand others' suffering are equally important.

There are significant similarities between Tirukkural and the Bhagavad Gita. Both emphasise dharma, righteous action, karma, spiritual wisdom, human effort and liberation. Hindu dharma teaches that the atma is spiritual in nature and that the wise recognise the same spiritual reality in different beings. Similarly, Tirukkural emphasises moral equality and compassion towards living beings.

Most importantly, both works direct human beings towards spiritual liberation. Krishna teaches surrender to God as the means to transcend karma, maya, and samsara. Similarly, Tiruvalluvar speaks of crossing the "great ocean of birth" by reaching God's feet. Thus, the Bhagavad Gita and Tirukkural both guide humanity towards dharma, right action, devotion, self-discipline, compassion, and ultimately liberation from the cycle of birth.

INBRIEF

Mahindra Aerostructures to make A320 fuselage skins

Airbus has awarded a contract to Mahindra Aerostructures to manufacture and supply fuselage skins for covering the rear fuselage and tail sections of the Airbus A320neo and A321XLR aircraft under a multi-year programme with delivery targeted for 2028. The components will be manufactured at Mahindra Aerostructures' facility in Bengaluru and supplied to Airbus' manufacturing facility in Augsburg, Germany.

ISP shows 8 sub-sectors posted double-digit growth in June

The index of services production released on Monday for the third time on a trial basis showed eight of 19 service categories recorded double-digit growth in June this year. The statistics ministry released the Index of Services Production (ISP) for the month of June 2026 in respect of 19 sub-sectors, with base year 2024-25. Except for air transport, all categories recorded positive growth in June on an annual basis, a statement by the statistics ministry said. PTI

Avantel bags ₹118 crore contract from DRDO

Technology solutions provider for defence and communication sectors Avantel has secured a contract for ₹117.88 crore from DRDO's Defence Electronics Applications Laboratory (DEAL) for development, installation and commissioning of a Ground Segment Hub for voice and data communication using an Indian geostationary satellite. The order reflects confidence in its technological and execution capabilities, Avantel said. The contract is to be executed by Feb. 2029.

India's GDP growth at 7.8% in Q1, slower than last quarter but quicker than last year

Stronger performance was driven by the manufacturing sector as well as some broad services categories such as utilities, financial services, real estate, IT, public administration and defence

T.C.A. Sharad Raghavan
NEW DELHI

The growth in India's Gross Domestic Product (GDP) stood at 7.8% in the April-June 2026 quarter (Q1 FY27), quicker than the 6.9% recorded in Q1 of last year, but slower than the 8.6% of the January-March 2026 quarter.

The stronger performance in Q1 of this year compared with last year has been driven by the manufacturing sector as well as some broad services categories such as utilities, financial services, real estate, IT, public administration and defence. "India's exemplary GDP growth of 7.8% during Q1 of FY 2026-27 is a Herculean feat," Prime Minister Narendra Modi said in a post on X. "The collective strength of our people ensured India delivered such growth despite oil price shocks and supply chain issues in the midst of global uncertainties."

Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman also took to social media to point out that nominal GDP in Q1 of FY 2026-27 is estimated to have grown by 10.3%, while real Gross Value Added (GVA) growth came in at 8.2%.

"The credit for this strong performance goes to the people of India and their hard work," she added in her post on X. "Reforms undertaken by the NDA Government, together with an agile management of the economy, are bearing results."

The laggards: The mining slipped into a contraction of 2.4% in part due to a high base of 12.4% growth in Q1 of last year. GETTY IMAGES

Speaking at the press conference following the release of the data, Chief Economic Adviser V. Anantha Nageswaran said that the key message from the data was that "we are witnessing continued resilience in the Indian growth performance" and that this resilience is backed up by high-frequency indicators.

Some economists have, however, pointed out that while the Q1 growth was a positive surprise, growth in the months ahead is expected to slow.

"A deficient south-west monsoon, amid El Niño conditions, poses downside risks to agriculture and rural demand, while unfavourable base effects are likely to weigh on growth from Q2," Vikram Chhabra, Senior Economist at financial services firm 360 ONE Asset said.

The manufacturing sector grew by 9.2% in Q1 of 2026-27, a three-quarter high. "Manufacturing growth has been very impressive at 9.2%, which comes over 8.3% [in Q1 last year]," Madan Sabnavis, chief economist at the Bank of Baroda explained. "Here it is again the infra-based companies which have contributed to growth based on the results of companies for Q1."

Overall, Mr. Sabnavis said that the data showed that growth has been spearheaded by capital formation, as measured by the Gross Fixed Capital Formation (GFCF), which has increased to 34.3% of GDP in nominal terms from 31.4% last year, and grew 20.4% in Q1 of this year. "This is a major takeaway as this involves both private and government expenditure with the former being driven by data centres and power, besides metals," he added.

Broad-based growth

The construction sector grew 7.7% in Q1 of 2026-27 compared with 5.2% in Q1 of last year.

The third broad category of the secondary sector – Electricity, Gas, Water Supply & Other Utility Services – saw growth coming in at 8.9% in Q1 of 2026-27, although some of this is likely a low base effect since the sector had contracted 1.8% in Q1 of 2025-26.

The tertiary sector, comprising services, cumulatively grew 10% in Q1 of 2026-27 compared with 8% in the same quarter of the previous year. Within this, the 'Financial, Real Estate, Ownership of dwelling, IT & Professional Services' category grew at 12.1% in Q1 of this year compared with 8.8% of last year.

The agriculture sector, however, saw growth slowing to 3.6% in Q1 of 2026-27 from 4.4% in Q1 of 2025-26. The mining and quarrying sector slipped into a contraction of 2.4%, in part due to a high base of 12.4% growth in Q1 of last year.

ONGC to infuse ₹1 lakh crore for deepwater exploration: Chairman

Saptaparno Ghosh
NEW DELHI

Oil and Natural Gas Corporation (ONGC) has plans to infuse ₹1 lakh crore for deepwater and ultradeep water exploration by 2030, Chairman and CEO Arun Kumar Singh told reporters on Monday.

The company plans to drill 87 deepwater and ultra-deepwater wells during the period, he added.

Separately, Rajarshi Gupta, Managing Director of the explorer's foreign operations arm, ONGC Videsh, told reporters that the Delhi-headquartered explorer was in talks with Venezuelan authorities for acquiring operatorship of their assets in the South American country and expecting a development to pan out in the next three months.

Elaborating on the deepwater and ultra-deepwater drilling ecosystem,

Arun Kumar Singh

Mr. Singh said there was "better technology" at the firm's disposal and the overall initiative was fuelled by the government's push.

ONGC Videsh holds 40% interest in the San Cristobal oil project, while the remaining is with Venezuela's Petroleos de Venezuela S.A. (PDVSA). It holds another 11% stake in the Carabobo project.

"The target is to be the designated operator," Mr. Gupta said, adding "What we are negotiating is the fiscal terms, the operating terms and the subsurface conditions for evacuation."

Happiest Minds set to merge with ITC Infotech

The Hindu Bureau
BENGALURU

Ashok-Soota-promoted Happiest Minds Technologies Ltd. on Monday signed a definitive agreement to combine its business with ITC Infotech India Ltd., to create a scaled, AI first global technology services enterprise with an annual revenue of ₹8,000 crore by FY28. As part of the transaction, ITC Infotech will acquire an aggregate minority stake of 22.1% in Happiest Minds from the Promoter and Promoter entities across two tranches for a total consideration of ₹1,330 crore (average price of ₹395/share). The companies will have a combined employee strength of over 19,000.

Govt. notifies ₹1.3 lakh-crore semicon scheme's phase two

The Hindu Bureau
NEW DELHI

The Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology notified the second phase of the India Semiconductor Mission (ISM 2.0), targeting a broad range of sops for the electronics manufacturing sector. ISM 2.0 has an outlay of ₹1.28 lakh crore, with all 'pillars' of categories being fungible insofar as the share of investments they may get under the scheme.

"People should feel dependent on India," IT Minister Ashwini Vaishnaw said at a press conference following the notification. "People should become dependent on our country, on our industry, on our production, on our design.

Ashwini Vaishnaw

That makes us really valuable in the entire supply chain. That should be our goal as a country."

Six pillars

ISM 2.0 has six pillars where government incentives will flow: design, with a focus on chips in industries of strategic priority, and those that are owned by Indians or OCIs; machines and materials, which will incentivise capital equipment manufacturing and chemicals and gases needed in electronics manufacturing; setting up more fabs, for which capital subsidies will be offered up to 40% by the Centre; packaging and testing facilities, which will also receive capital subsidies; research and development, which will be subsidised up to 75% of project cost; and talent development, which will enjoy the same extent of support as R&D.

ISM 1.0 gave 50% capital subsidy to chip projects, but this was cut to 40% in phase 2 on increased enthusiasm among global players and additional support provided by States.

GRT to buy 74% of Tribhovandas Bhimji Zaveri for ₹1,033.71 cr.

The Hindu Bureau
CHENNAI

Chennai-based GRT Jewellers India Pvt.Ltd. (GRT) will be buying a majority stake in Tribhovandas Bhimji Zaveri Ltd. GRT, in a statement, announced the signing of a share purchase agreement with the promoters of Tribhovandas Bhimji Zaveri Ltd. to buy 74.12% stake in the firm.

As per the SPA, GRT would buy the promoters' stake for an aggregate value of up to ₹1,033.71 crore. The consummation of the pact will be subject to regulatory approvals closing conditions. GRT will also be launching an open offer for another 26% as per applicable SEBI regulations.

GRT will also be launching an open offer for another 26% as per applicable SEBI regulations

G.R. 'Ananth' Ananthapadmanabhan, MD, GRT Jewellers, said: "This very well fits into our strategy of spreading presence across India with TBZ's 37 stores.

Shrikant Zaveri, CMD, TBZ, said what began five generations and 162 years ago as a single store in Zaveri Bazaar has now grown through decades into 37 locations across India.

'FY27 fiscal deficit at 26.8% full year target at end July'

Press Trust of India
NEW DELHI

The Centre's fiscal deficit for 2026-27 stood at 26.8% of the full-year target at July end, according to data released by the Controller General of Accounts (CGA).

The deficit was at 29.9% of Budget Estimates (BE) of 2025-26 for the first four months of FY26.

In absolute terms, the fiscal deficit, or gap between the government's expenditure and revenue, was ₹4,55,144 crore in the April-July period of FY27.

The Centre has set a fiscal deficit target of 4.3% GDP, or ₹16.96 lakh crore for the current fiscal.

According to the CGA, the Centre's net tax revenue was about ₹8.45 lakh crore, or 29.5% of the corresponding BE of 2026-27 of total receipts, up to July.

Under check: The Centre transferred ₹3,72,354 crore to States, or₹56,190 crore lower than the previous year. GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCK

In the corresponding period of the previous fiscal year, the net tax revenue was at 23.3% of that year's BE.

The data on monthly accounts showed total expenditure during the first four months was at about ₹17.62 lakh crore, or 32.9% of BE. In the year-ago period, it was at 30.9% of BE.

The Centre transferred ₹3,72,354 crore to State governments as devolution of share of taxes during the period, which is ₹56,190 crore lower than the previous year.

Honda Motorcycle eyes steady growth as 2W market widens

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

India's two-wheeler industry's double-digit growth continues to be supported by evolving mobility needs, premiumisation, export demand and potential rural recovery even as it stays sensitive to monsoon, financing availability, input costs and geopolitics, said Tsutsumu Otani, president & CEO, Honda Motorcycle & Scooter India Pvt. Ltd. (HMSI).

He said geopolitical developments pushed up freight costs and extended transit timelines on some routes, prompting HMSI to

Tsutsumu Otani

boost localisation and supply-chain resilience.

On E20, Mr. Otani said HMSI had not observed any customer concerns due to the fuel use.

He added HMSI was investing about ₹2,400 crore to expand manufacturing capacity.

'HDFC CEO's move may cause leadership transition risk'

Lalatendu Mishra
MUMBAI

HDFC Bank MD & CEO Sashidhar Jagdishan's decision not to seek reappointment introduces a degree of leadership transition risk as the succession was not previously anticipated, Moody's said on Monday.

Mitigating risks

"While leadership changes at systemically important banks can create uncertainty around strategy execution and risk management, HDFC Bank's strong franchise, deep senior management bench and one of the strongest financial profiles among Moody's-rated banks in India mitigate these risks," said

Sashidhar Jagdishan

Devang Rajkotia, AVP, Moody's Ratings.

An orderly succession process and continuity in strategy execution will be key to sustaining stakeholder confidence and limiting any negative credit implications, he added.

On Monday, several brokerages recommended investors to accumulate or buy HDFC Bank's shares which underperformed 28% year to date.

Finding successor

Speculation has been rife as to who will succeed Mr. Jagdiahan. The board has stated that it has initiated the process to find the successor well within time.

While the current Deputy MD Kaizad M. Bharucha has emerged as a strong contender, the names of several external candidates are doing the rounds.

IIFL in a note stated while Mr. Bharucha may seem a probable successor choice, the 15-year whole time director ceiling means he will have a maximum of only one tenure.

Branches key amid digital banking rise, says KVB's Babu

The Hindu Bureau
HYDERABAD

Branches continue to play a crucial role, particularly for retail, agricultural and MSME clients though digital banking, making everyday transactions easier, Karur Vysya Bank MD and CEO Ramesh Babu said after opening 16 branches.

"The new branches will help us get closer to clients and offer them the convenience of personalised service and digital banking," he said opening the branch in Hyderabad's Gachibowli and the rest virtually.

The new facilities are in Tamil Nadu, Telangana,

Ramesh Babu

Andhra Pradesh, Karnataka and Delhi NCR and take KVB's nationwide branch network to 919.

The private sector lender's total business as of June 30 stood at ₹2,27,267 crore with deposits of ₹1,22,587 crore and advances of ₹1,04,680 crore.

NIIF raises ₹19,000 crore for second infra fund

The Hindu Bureau
MUMBAI

National Investment and Infrastructure Fund Ltd (NIIF), India's sovereign-anchored alternative asset manager, said its NIIF Infrastructure Fund II raised ₹19,000 crore ($2 billion). The target is ₹30,000 crore ($3.2 billion).

"The first close is anchored by the GoI and supported by a high-quality investor base spanning sovereign wealth funds, pension funds, insurance companies and leading Indian financial institutions," NIIF said. Also, NIIF expects to raise ₹9,000 crore in co-investment capital.

JERUSALEM

Five Palestinians killed in Israeli airstrikes in Gaza City, medics say

REUTERS

Israeli airstrikes killed five people west of Gaza City on Monday, according to the Al-Shifa Hospital and rescuers, while the Israeli Army said it targeted Hamas "operatives". Despite a U.S.-backed ceasefire that took effect in October 2025, at least 1,318 people have been killed according to the Palestinian Health Ministry. AFP

SEOUL

North Korea calls U.S., South Korea, and Japan maritime drills a threat

REUTERS

Maritime drills by South Korea, the United States and Japan are a "threat" to North Korea, Pyongyang said on Monday, branding Washington as hostile and vowed to strengthen its nuclear force. The remarks from North Korea's Foreign Ministry come as U.S. President Donald Trump seeks a meeting with Kim Jong-un. AFP

TORONTO

Google Maps to show Lake Ontario as 'Lake America' for users in U.S.

AFP

Google has updated its maps application to rename Lake Ontario as "Lake America" for users in the U.S., reflecting an order by President Donald Trump that changed the lake's name, amid an escalating trade war with Canada. Ontario Premier Doug Ford responded with a billboard-sized message: "Lake Ontario. Now and forever." AP

TAIPEI

'Unpredictable' China strengthens air and sea control nearby: Taiwan

REUTERS

Beijing is tightening its grip on the air and sea around Taiwan, Taipei said in its annual report on China's military threat, adding that the regional security situation "continues to escalate", noting a "rising unpredictability" in China's decision-making due to an "unprecedented" purge of senior military officers. REUTERS

U.S., Iran exchange strikes for first time in weeks, escalating conflict

Washington carries out strikes on Iranian island in the Strait of Hormuz; Tehran retaliates by attacking U.S. military bases in Jordan and UAE; Trump threatens to 'hit hard' while Pezeshkian calls for 'dialogue'; three dead in American strikes, says Iran

Agence France-Presse
TEHRAN

U.S. President Donald Trump threatened to hit Iran "hard" after the two countries traded fire for the first time in over a month, while Iran's President warned that more fighting with the U.S. was not in his country's interest.

Late on Sunday, the United States said it had carried out strikes on an Iranian island in the Strait of Hormuz, with Tehran quickly retaliating by attacking U.S. military targets in West Asia.

"We're going to hit them hard," Mr. Trump said. "There will be a response."

Defiance display: Pedestrians walk next to an anti-U.S. mural on a street in Tehran on Monday. AFP

The United States said it attacked Iranian rocket launchers on the island of Larak to prevent Tehran planting mines in the key shipping lane.

Iran responded with missile and drone attacks aimed at Jordan and the United Arab Emirates, saying they targeted U.S. forces there, but President Masoud Pezeshkian later on Monday called for dialogue.

"We continue to strive for a path of agreement and understanding, and we believe that continuing the war is neither in our interest, nor in the interest of the region," he said at a summit in Kyrgyzstan, adding "the solution to the existing problems is dialogue and cooperation".

Iranian state media reported that three people were killed in the U.S. attack on Larak.

Iran's Revolutionary Guards said the ballistic missile attack on two U.S. air bases in Jordan caused "heavy damage". Jordan's Army said it had intercepted eight missiles, without stating their origin.

Iran also said it targeted U.S. personnel at an air base in the UAE and shot down an American drone over Hormuz. Abu Dhabi said it intercepted a drone over the country's waters, but dismissed claims that Al Minhad Air Base had been targeted as "baseless".

Economic pressure

U.S. Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent vowed to keep up the economic pain. "We are going to continue exerting pressure, and we've had very good discussions here already," Mr. Bessent said at a meeting of G20 finance leaders.

He said a turning point in the pressure campaign could come "within weeks or months".

Nepal flood toll surges to 939; search on for trapped workers

Associated Press
KATHMANDU

Rescuers raced to free hundreds of workers believed to be trapped in tunnels at hydropower sites that were buried in mud by catastrophic flooding on the Nepal-China border, as the combined deaths in both countries surpassed 950, with more than 4,400 people missing.

A private-sector association representing power companies said at least 900 workers were unaccounted for at 12 hydropower projects in Nepal's Rasuwa and Nuwakot districts. About 500 of those workers were believed to be trapped in tunnels.

At least one expert said that some workers could have access to oxygen, but others warned that the chances of finding survivors were diminishing. An Indian Army officer deployed as part of a specialised tunnel rescue team said rescuers were digging through "sludge".

Solemn duty: Paramilitary personnel prepare the bodies of flash flood victims for burial in Chitwan, Nepal, on Monday. AP

On the Chinese side, rescue and recovery efforts included rebuilding the road leading to the Gyirong Port border crossing that regulated travel between China and Nepal.

Nepal's disaster agency said on Monday that 939 bodies had been recovered, with 3,925 people missing, including 592 foreigners. As of Sunday, Chinese officials reported 16 deaths and 546 missing. Chinese state media said 261 of the missing were foreigners.

The August 26 disaster was sparked by a glacial collapse, the U.S. Geological Survey said.

UN panel presents legal case for broad slavery reparations

Agence France-Presse
GENEVA

Countries are legally obliged to provide broad reparations for harms resulting from both direct and indirect involvement in the transatlantic African slave trade, a UN committee said on Monday.

Issuing a fresh interpretation of an important international rights treaty, the UN watchdog said the accord obliges countries to work to redress the harms caused by slavery.

"States parties must implement comprehensive reparatory measures for people of African descent, covering all aspects of remedies," the UN Committee on the Elimination of Racial Discrimination (CERD) said in its findings. It stressed that reparatory justice combined "a wide range of measures conceived as monetary, non-monetary and structural".

While not legally-binding, committee member Pela Boker-Wilson said the findings carry "authoritative weight", and can be used by officials to inform judicial review, by courts as an interpretative tool, as well as in litigation aspects.

At least 12.5 million Africans were taken and sold between the 15th and 19th centuries in what the CERD called the largest forced displacement in history.

Russia, Israel behind disinformation on Ceuta crisis: Sanchez

Reuters
MADRID

Spanish Prime Minister Pedro Sanchez said on Monday there were signs Russia and Israel had spread the disinformation over Spain's migration policy that triggered last month's rush of migrants into Ceuta, but no evidence of Moroccan involvement.

Over 72,000 migrants irregularly crossed from Morocco into the tiny Spanish territory between July 30 and 31 in an unprecedented surge at one of the European Union's only two land borders with Africa. At least 100 people died in the attempt, according to Ceuta's local authorities.

Spanish Opposition parties have accused Rabat of deliberately allowing the mass crossing, an accusation Morocco has denied.

"When people talk and speculate about the participation of Moroccan authorities, I deny this outright," Mr. Sanchez said.

Mr. Sanchez said research by the EU's diplomatic service EEAS had indicated that Russian and Israeli networks had been behind the spread of disinformation in conjunction with far-right networks.

Some 5,000 migrants have stayed in Ceuta since the border rush, triggering protests from locals against the Spanish government's handling of the crisis.

Magsaysay honour for Myanmar activist, Singapore lawyer, Bangladeshi aid giver

Associated Press
PHILIPPINES

A Singaporean diplomat who led adoption of UN oceans treaty, a Myanmar activist who put his freedom on the line for democracy, and a former Bangladeshi teacher who brought compassion to the poor were named on Monday as the winners of this year's Ramon Magsaysay Awards.

Singaporean lawyer and diplomat Tommy Koh, 88, was recognised for promoting international dialogue and the rule of law. He is best known for presiding over a U.N. conference of more than 150 countries, which adopted the U.N. Convention on the Law of the Sea in 1982.

Bo Kyi, Runa Khan and Tommy Koh. RAMON MAGSAYSAY FOUNDATION

"Of enormous significance to maritime countries, this 'constitution for the oceans' defined territorial waters and the economic rights of countries to their coastal waters and provides mechanisms for settling disputes," the awards body said.

Bo Kyi, the 61-year-old winner from Myanmar, has spent seven years in prison for a life spent in resistance against widespread human rights violations by Myanmar's military.

In March 2000, Bo Kyi and fellow former political prisoners organised the Assistance Association for Political Prisoners, which has "devoted itself to documenting political imprisonment, supporting detainees and their families and ensuring the continued visibility of the junta's political prisoners in Myanmar," the awards body said.

Runa Khan, 67, of Bangladesh won the award for "her profound empathy for the poorest of the poor in her country."

Coming from an affluent family, she first served as a teacher to poor children in 1979. In 2002, she established an organisation called "Friendship Bangladesh" that helped the most destitute "deal with climate change, educate their children, empower women, create livelihood opportunities and bring social justice to the excluded," according to the awards body.

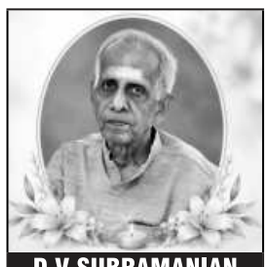
OBITUARY & REMEMBRANCE

DEATH

OBITUARY

Our beloved
Malathi Padmanabhan
(Amma, Chithi, Akka, Aunty, Malu)
passed away peacefully on 29th August 2026 leaving behind her abundant love and affection to everyone she has met. We will miss her.
On behalf of family and friends.

DEATH



D V SUBRAMANIAN
1929 - 2026
Formerly of India Meteorological Department
Passed away on August 30 2026
He will be dearly missed by Shobhana & C. R. Rajendran, Aravindakshan, Nirupama, Vasudha & Sanjay Sondhi, Grandchildren, sister Rajeshwari Gopal and Family, Nieces and Nephews, and a large circle of friends.
Ph: 9840789582

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GOVERNMENT OF TAMIL NADU
AGRICULTURAL ENGINEERING DEPARTMENT
T1/30213/2026 TENDER NOTICE Date: 29.08.2026

For and on behalf of the Governor of Tamil Nadu, e-Tenders are invited from Manufacturers or Authorised Sole Distributor for Sl. No. 1 to 3 and Manufacturers or Authorised Sole Distributor or Authorised Dealer for Sl. No. 4 to 6 by the Chief Engineer (AE), Agricultural Engineering Department, 487, Anna Salai, Nandanam, Chennai-35 for the following items, as per the terms and conditions and detailed specification listed in the tender document.

Sl No	Tender No.	Tender for the supply of	EMD (Rs. in lakh)
1	T1-1/ 2026-2027	60 Nos. of Tractor 2 Wheel Drive	7.80
2	T1-2/ 2026-2027	60 Nos. of Rotavator	0.90
3	T1-3/ 2026-2027	3 Nos. of Truck mounted Electrical Logger	1.65
4	T1-4/ 2026-2027	5 Nos. of Track Type Paddy Combine Harvester	1.75
5	T1-5/ 2026-2027	10 Nos. of Wheel Type Paddy Combine Harvester	3.50
6	T1-6/ 2026-2027	5 Nos. of Tractor PTO Operated Disc Rotavator	0.10

The tender documents with detailed specifications and Bill of Quantity (BoQ) are available in www.tntenders.gov.in as per schedule below. Tender documents and Bill of Quantity (BoQ) can be downloaded, filled and uploaded through Internet Explorer or Microsoft Edge from the site www.tntenders.gov.in at free of cost.

Tender Publishing Date and Time	01.09.2026,10.00 AM
Tender document download – Start Date and Time	01.09.2026,10.00 AM
Bid submission - Start Date and Time	01.09.2026, 11.00 AM
Bid submission - Closing Date and Time	01.10.2026, 02.00 PM
Bid opening Date and Time	05.10.2026, 03.00 PM

The e-Tenders will be opened online through www.tntenders.gov.in on the date and time mentioned above at the office of the Chief Engineer (AE), Agricultural Engineering Department, Nandanam, Chennai.
DIPR / 2704 / TENDER / 2026 Chief Engineer (AE)

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE
DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU
0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F),
email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
Hue and Cry Notice Rule No. 712/191

SDPO City East, Jammu has intimated that accused person namely Vicky Kumar S/O Balbir R/O Rajeev Nagar, Narwal, Jammu is evading his arrest/wanted in case FIR No. 129/2011 U/S 452/436/147/148/323/109 RPC, of P/S Bahu Fort, Jammu. Despite repeated raids/efforts the accused could not be traced/still absconded.
It is therefore requested that Hue and Cry Notice of above mentioned accused is being published for the information of Police establishments / Public in general having any clue related to the whereabouts / present location of above named accused, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact / Telephone numbers.
Description Roll :-
Name : Vicky Kumar
S/O : Balbir
Address : Rajeev Nagar, Narwal, Jammu
Age : 30-35 Years
Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-
1. DPO, Jammu : 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
2. SSP Jammu Mail I.D : sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
3. PCR Jammu : 0191-2605949
4. SP City South : 0191-2430002
5. SDPO City East : 01912433778
6. P/S Bahu Fort : 0191-2475133
Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu
DIP/J- 9089/26, Aug 31 2026

THE START OF IT ALL

From a Barcelona product to a champion with Argentina

GETTY IMAGES

Lionel Messi joined Barcelona as a 13-year-old in 2000 and shone in the youth ranks before making his senior debut at 16 in a friendly against Porto in 2003. He made his LaLiga debut in October 2004 and scored his first league goal the following May in a match against Albacete. What he achieved with Argentina is history.

MR. CONSISTENT

Prolific Messi bows out with the second-most international goals

REUTERS

Lionel Messi has the second-most goals in all internationals (125), behind his contemporary, Portugal's Cristiano Ronaldo (146). The Argentine legend is also the second-highest goalscorer in FIFA World Cup history with 21 in 34 matches, behind France forward Kylian Mbappe (22).

GLITTERING

Be it Brazil or Qatar, Messi wowed fans with Golden Ball at his feet

GETTY IMAGES

Lionel Messi is the only player to win the World Cup Golden Ball twice, earning the prize in the 2014 and 2022 editions. While Messi provided four goals and one assist in Brazil, he delivered seven goals and three assists in Argentina's title-winning campaign in Qatar. In the most recent WC, he secured the Silver Ball.

THE LIONEL THAT HELPED

Messi, Scaloni and their successful partnership for *La Albiceleste*

GETTY IMAGES

Lionel Scaloni's appointment as coach in 2018 proved a game-changer for Lionel Messi and Argentina. In 2021, in the middle of the Covid pandemic, Argentina defeated Brazil 1-0 in the final to win the Copa America, its first major title in 28 years. The crowning glory came in Qatar in 2022 when Messi's side lifted the World Cup.

Messi bids goodbye after 21 magical years

The show-stopper leaves the international arena with an Argentine record 125 goals in 207 matches; despite being hurt, he says the time had arrived to bring down the curtains on a storied career

FOOTBALL

Agencies
BUENOS AIRES

Lionel Messi has ended his decorated career as a player for Argentina at 39, after nearly two decades representing the National team.

The eight-time Ballon d'Or winner is his country's record appearance-maker and scorer with 125 goals in 207 games, having transformed a complicated relationship with the senior side into a story of redemption and triumph.

Messi, who played in six World Cups, won the tournament in Qatar in 2022 and led Argentina to the final again, before losing to Spain in the USA earlier this year.

"It was a decision that hurt – and still hurts deeply – but I understand that the time has come," Messi wrote on social media.

"I swear to you that I always gave it my all – not just in these last few years when we won everything but before that too. I always fought and left everything on the field for this jersey, to bring you joy and make you feel proud to be Argentine through football," added the veteran.

Messi revealed that he wrote his retirement letter on July 21 – two days after losing the World Cup final – but waited to publish it because his father was facing health issues that eventually claimed his life. Jorge Messi passed away in his native Rosario on August 8.

Messi had made his debut for the National team in 2005, but his journey was fraught with frustration until he finally lifted the World Cup in 2022.

"Thank you for all the love these past 20 years. I'm going to miss hearing you all from the inside. Now I'm going to be one of you, cheering and supporting you from the outside [through thick and thin, even more so]," said Messi.

Change of mind

He had briefly retired in 2016 – after defeats in the 2014 World Cup final and back-to-back Copa America title deciders – but later reversed his decision.

He went on to bag Copa titles in 2021 and 2024.

In the letter, the Inter Miami captain, however, did not mention how long he intends to continue playing professional football.

"I leave with the peace of mind and pride of having given you – along with my teammates – moments we once only dreamed of. Experiencing this with you was incredible. I love you all," he added.

Messi played for Inter Miami over the weekend, scoring four in a 7-1 win over CF Montreal in Major League Soccer.

The art and the artist: Messi's wizardry often left defenders chasing shadows. During two decades of dominance, he was head and shoulders above the rest. GETTY IMAGES, REUTERS & AFP

Leo's glorious position in football is set in stone

K.C. Vijaya Kumar

In football's hallowed legacy of individual brilliance shaping collective achievement, the pantheon was always vested with a duopoly: Brazil's Pele and Argentina's Diego Maradona.

Carving his own niche

However, just like the suave manner in which he befuddled defenders, Lionel Messi also carved his own niche with these giants.

Greatness in the beautiful game can never be discussed without mentioning the magician that Messi has always been.

As he announced his international retirement, Messi leaves a global terrain that he adorned with such aura. He was driven by the philosophy that if there was a goal to be scored, he would be the man to do it or at least grant the final assist.

However, Pele and Maradona did not face the extreme scrutiny that shadowed Messi in an age of intrusive social media. For years, the 'club over country' debate was often used to denigrate Messi.

His exemplary stint with FC Barcelona was used as a crutch to run him down while using his tenure with Argentina as a contrast. Messi had to find his light while dealing with Maradona's massive shadow.

Sporting greats thrive on prodigal talent, self-belief, adrenaline and most importantly the applause from the fans. Messi often searched for that last bit. It did not matter if he was the most-feted footballer ever in the history of the sport, he had to win the World Cup.

Ultimate prize

He precisely did that at Doha in 2022, marshalling his unit to the ultimate glory, one that Maradona last secured in 1986. While the rest of the world loved him, to gain that emotion from his followers back home was special for Messi. Finally, Maradona's shadow was cast aside as Messi glowed in his own luminescence.

He wanted an encore this year but Spain had the last word in the World Cup final. The Maradona replication was again at play as Argentina was runner-up in 1990.

To see Messi on the turf is to be aware of magic-realism, the kind that writers like Gabriel Garcia Marquez dished out in their epics. Messi offered hope, hoodwinked rivals with speed and pauses, and sold a dummy with his feint of feet.

Statistics would reveal 125 goals from 207 appearances for Argentina, but he was more than just numbers.

To see him at his best, was to be aware of an incandescent legend. Messi's glorious position in football is set in stone. He will be sorely missed.

Messi's international journey

Breaking down the genius' strikes

Year	Goals
2005	0
2006	2
2007	6
2008	2
2009	3
2010	2
2011	4
2012	12
2013	6
2014	8
2015	4
2016	8
2017	4
2018	4
2019	5
2020	1
2021	9
2022	18
2023	8
2024	6
2025	3
2026	10
Total	**125**

Appearances	Goals	Competition
61	54	Friendlies
72	36	World Cup qualification
34	21	FIFA World Cup
39	14	Copa America
1	0	Finalissima

BY OPPONENT (top-10)

Bolivia	11
Ecuador	7
Venezuela	7
Uruguay	6
Algeria	5
Brazil	5
Chile	5
Estonia	5
Guatemala	5
Paraguay	5

LA ALBICELESTE CAREER

125 goals

and 68 assists in 207 appearances across 21 years. Holds the country's all-time record for both appearances and goals

TITLES WON

- Under-20 World Cup (2005)
- Olympic Games gold (2008)
- FIFA World Cup (2022)
- Copa America (2021 and 2024)

INDIVIDUAL HONOURS

- FIFA World Cup - Golden Ball (2014 and 2022)
- FIFA World Cup - Silver Ball (2026)
- Copa America - Golden Ball (2015 and 2021)
- Copa America - Golden Boot (2021)

1 The only player to score a World Cup goal in his teens, 20s and 30s

1 The first to score in the group stage, round of 16, quarterfinal, semifinal and final of a single World Cup

1 Has the most World Cup goal involvements (33: 21 goals, 12 assists), most World Cup assists (12) and most World Cup appearances (34)

3 The first player to captain his country in three World Cup finals 2014 2022 2026

47 Messi made his *La Albiceleste* debut on August 17, 2005, coming on as a substitute in the 63rd minute. He, however, received a red card just 47 seconds later for a controversial challenge

28 Messi ended Argentina's 28-year trophy drought in 2021 when it defeated Brazil at the Maracana to lift the Copa America

2016 Retired from international football on June 26, in the aftermath of the defeat to Chile in the Copa America final, before reversing his decision on August 12 later that year

> I love, I loved, and I will always love being on the national team. I gave everything I had and I have nothing more to give, and besides, there are some very talented young players coming up behind me who deserve to be there
>
> **LIONEL MESSI**

Compiled by Anirudh Velamuri

Navone hands Djokovic his earliest Slam loss since 2006

The Serb endures his first-ever defeat in the opening round of the tournament; former champion Medvedev posts an easy win over Gaston; Kenin eclipses Venus in straight sets

US OPEN

Agence France-Presse
NEW YORK

An ailing Novak Djokovic suffered his earliest Grand Slam exit in 20 years on Sunday, falling in five brutal sets to Mariano Navone in the first round of the U.S. Open.

The 48th-ranked Argentine's 7-6(5), 5-7, 4-6, 6-2, 6-1 victory ended Djokovic's latest bid for a record 25th Grand Slam title.

It also ended his run of 78 Grand Slam first-round victories, a streak stretching all the way back to Djokovic's loss to Paul Goldstein at the 2006 Australian Open.

Djokovic vomited on court and struggled with late-match cramps but appeared to have finally taken control when he broke Navone for a 2-1 lead in the fourth set with a vintage backhand winner down the line.

But Navone won the next five games, raising his arms in celebration after fighting off two break points for a 5-2 lead and breaking Djokovic again to force the fifth set.

Djokovic took a medical timeout before the final set, receiving massage on his spine and another delivery of medication.

But Navone jumped to a 3-0 lead in the decisive set and despite the urging of fans there was no road back for the Serb as his opponent dropped just one point on his own serve as he sprinted to the finish line.

"It's unbelievable," an ecstatic Navone said after triumphing in his first meeting with his longtime idol. "It's a dream come true, I mean seriously, 100%.

Djokovic broke Navone in the second game as he rolled to a 3-1 lead.

But the 39-year-old was clearly struggling and with Navone gaining confidence Djokovic had to claw out of 0-40 hole to hold for 4-1, looking weary as Navone began to extend the rallies.

Venus bows out

Venus Williams bowed out of her 26th US Open singles appearance early Monday morning, falling in straight sets to fellow American wild card Sofia Kenin after not getting on the court until midnight.

The 46-year-old lost 6-2, 7-6(6) in what could be the final singles match at a Grand Slam, if not her illustrious career. It was her 14th consecutive singles defeat dating to her last victory in Washington in July 2025.

Daniil Medvedev, the 2021 U.S. Open champion, shook off his miserable preparation for the tournament by beating Hugo Gaston 6-4, 6-2, 6-4. The No. 7 seed was just 1-3 in the North American hard-court swing, usually a time he thrives.

Other winners on Sunday included No. 9 Elina Svitolina, No. 19 Jasmine Paolini and No. 31 Leylah Fernandez, the 2021 U.S. Open runner-up.

Marin Cilic, the 2014 U.S. Open champion, and 2022 runner-up Casper Ruud both withdrew with injuries.

The big upset: Navone kept his composure to hold off Djokovic in five sets to snap the Serb's streak of 78 Grand Slam first-round victories. AFP & REUTERS

TOP RESULTS

First round: Men: 7-Medvedev bt Gaston (Fra) 6-4, 6-2, 6-4; 27-Etcheverry (Arg) bt Kopriva (Cze) 6-3, 6-4, 6-0; Shapovalov (Can) bt Kecmanovic (Srb) 6-4, 4-6, 6-4, 6-1.
Van Assche (Fra) bt 29-Norrie (GBr) 6-7(6), 6-2, 6-2, 6-3; 20-Paul (USA) bt Wong (Hkg) 6-7(3), 6-1, 6-3, 6-3; Navone (Arg) bt 4-Djokovic (Srb) 7-6(5), 5-7, 4-6, 6-2, 6-1.
Women: Pliskova (Cze) bt Vandewinkel (Bel) 2-6, 7-5, 6-3; 11-Kostyuk (Ukr) bt Hunter (Aus) 6-4, 6-1; 18-Alexandrova (Rus) bt Kessler (USA) 6-2, 6-2; Vekic (Cro) bt Gibson (Aus) 6-2, 4-6, 6-3; Kenin (USA) bt Venus Williams (USA) 6-2, 7-6(6); 31-Fernandez (Can) bt Shuai (Chn) 6-3, 6-2; Stefanini (Ita) bt Yastremska (Ukr) 6-3, 4-6, 6-1; 9-Svitolina (Ukr) bt Sierra (Arg) 6-1, 6-2.

Tuesday's Picks

MEN
1-Zverev vs Sonego
5-Cobolli vs Comesana
6-De Minaur vs Guerrieri
9-Fritz vs Blanch
Monfils vs Vallejo

WOMEN
2-Rybakina vs Frodin
4-Gauff vs Sonmez
5-Andreeva vs Tjen
12-Bencic vs Putintseva
17-Eala vs Stoiana

Tilak and Shreyas put South in front; Central and East cancel each other out

DULEEP TROPHY

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

South Zone weathered a blistering early morning bowling effort from India pacer Gurnoor Brar (four for 70) to finish day two of the Duleep Trophy semifinal 90 runs in the green at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here on Monday.

From an overnight 40 for two, South was reduced to 80 for five. But skipper Tilak Varma played all day (106 batting, 225b, 7x4), and combined with Shreyas Gopal (87, 169b, 11x4) for an excellent, match-turning 175-run partnership.

If not for a flurry of wickets towards close – from 255 for five to 270 for nine – South would have been in a healthier position. Nevertheless, with Tilak still around, South can hope to turn the screw further on day three, starting from 285 for nine.

It was an uncharacteristic innings from the usually dashing 23-year-old Hyderabad batter.

His half-century took 149 balls and contained no boundaries, and the first hit past the ropes came on the 154th delivery, helping South secure the first-innings lead.

Shreyas was a tad faster but eschewed none of his partner's caution, safely cutting and steering his way to his fifty from 107 deliveries. But just when the 32-year-old seemed set for his seventh First Class ton, an attempted glide to third-man brought about his downfall.

A mini collapse ensued, and it was only then that Tilak shifted gears, and reached his eighth First Class hundred from 219 balls with back-to-back boundaries off Gurnoor.

But in the morning, Gurnoor would have had no inkling of the things to come. Off his fifth ball, he turned N. Jagadeesan inside-out and rearranged his stumps.

R. Smaran, the 2025-26 Ranji Trophy top-scorer, was consumed by another mesmerising delivery that hit the top of off-stump. K. Himateja was sent back next ball to push South to the brink only for Tilak and Shreyas to turn the tables.

On the adjacent ground where East Zone was playing Central, proceedings were in stark contrast.

Where South scored 73 runs in the opening session, East, propelled by Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's manic 92 (81b, 7x4, 7x6), scored as many as 183.

But from 200 for two, Ishan Kishan's outfit was dismissed for 266, the same first-innings total as Central.

In what is now a one-innings shoot out, Central was 45 for three at stumps, with captain Rajat Patidar too back in the hut.

The scores:
North Zone 195 vs. South Zone 285/9 in 94 overs (Tilak Varma 106 batting, Shreyas Gopal 87, Gurnoor Brar 4/70).
Central Zone 266 & 45/3 in 20 overs vs. East Zone 266 in 57 overs (Abhimanyu Easwaran 69, Vaibhav Sooryavanshi 92, Harsh Dubey 4/66).

Need of the hour: Tilak and Shreyas' 175-run stand for the sixth wicket rescued South. K. MURALI KUMAR

Exceptional Sooryavanshi the focal point at the CoE

N. Sudarshan
BENGALURU

Vaibhav Sooryavanshi's care-free, adolescent excellence graced big-ticket First Class cricket, as the 15-year-old made an entertaining 81-ball 92 on day two of East Zone's Duleep Trophy semifinal versus Central Zone at the BCCI Centre of Excellence here on Monday.

In an innings that lasted 118 minutes and was studded with seven sixes and as many fours, Sooryavanshi took on every bowler, and put on 161 glorious runs for the opening wicket with Abhimanyu Easwaran (69, 106b, 8x4).

He was dropped on 40 by Yash Rathod at backward point off Saransh Jain while trying a wild cross-batted heave. But what is boyhood if frightening frankness isn't accompanied by tiny flaws?

Pacer Yash Thakur was the first to bear Sooryavanshi's brunt, smashed as he was for a flurry of fours and two sixes, one down the ground and the other hooked.

Saransh, who had just returned from Sri Lanka following his debut Test, induced a false stroke in his very first over only for Yash Rathod to make a mess of it.

Sooryavanshi, however, was unaffected. Reputation has rarely bothered him, and in the IPL, he didn't spare even the likes of Jasprit Bumrah and Josh Hazlewood.

A falling reverse sweep off Saransh was his response, and though that did not fetch the desired result, he hoisted the offie over long-on to bring up his half-century from 42 balls.

Sooryavanshi then collected maximums off medium-pacer Aryan Panday and left-arm spinner Harsh Dubey, before launching another blitzkrieg against Saransh.

The seasoned Madhya Pradesh spinner was sent soaring above long-off, violently reverse-swept for four, and then muscled over cow-corner.

Another attempt at a hoick ended Sooryavanshi's stay as he was caught at deep mid-wicket off Dubey.

But it was not before he became the youngest half-centurion in Duleep Trophy history, breaking Rajasthan batter Laxman Singh's record for Central Zone from January 1969 when the latter was 16.

Sooryavanshi smashed boundaries aplenty. K. MURALI KUMAR

Crowning glory

Reigning supreme: South Delhi Superstarz players pose with the Delhi Premier League trophy after beating Central Delhi Kings in the final on Sunday. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

SNAPSHOTS

Jamil names squad for international friendlies

Forward Ryan Williams has found a place in the 26-man India squad, named by head coach Khalid Jamil for the international friendlies against Panama, Brazil and Uruguay.

The squad: Goalkeepers: Albino Gomes, Gurpreet Singh Sandhu, Prabhsukhan Singh Gill, Som Kumar; **Defenders:** Abhishek Singh, Akash Mishra, Anwar Ali, Bijoy Varghese, Valpuia, Jay Gupta, Pramveer Singh, Ricky Meetei; **Midfielders:** Anirudh Thapa, Ashique Kuruniyan, Farukh Choudhary, Apuia, Macarton Nickson, Mohammed Sanan, Ricky Shabong, Sahal Abdul Samad; **Forwards:** Edmund Lalrindika, Irfan Yadwad, Manvir Singh, Rahim Ali, Ryan Williams, Vikram Partap Singh.

Chennai Bulls reigns supreme

Chennai Bulls tallied 311 points to take the top spot and win ₹15 lakh in the national-level Equestrian Champions League (ECL) in Coimbatore on Sunday.

LIVE TELECAST

Duleep Trophy (semifinals), Day 3, JioHotstar, 9.30 a.m.

Women's T20 Asia Cup: Sony Sports Ten 1 & LIV, 8 p.m.

US Open: SS Select 1, 2 & JioHotstar, 8.30 p.m. & 4.30 a.m. (Wednesday).

VIS-*The Hindu* u-15 inter-school football tournament inaugurated

Sports Bureau
CHENNAI

Vellore International School (VIS), Chennai, and *The Hindu* inaugurated the third edition of the under-15 inter-school football tournament at the VIS campus in Kayar on Monday.

The tournament features 64 school teams from Chennai, Kancheepuram, Tiruvallur, Vellore, Chengalpattu and Tiruvannamalai.

The inaugural ceremony was attended by chief guest Daisuke Korenaga (chairman, Football Club Jurong, Singapore), Dr. G.V. Selvam (vice-president, Vellore Institute of Technology, and chairman, VIS), K. Prabhakaran (principal, VIS), Rohit Ramesh (director, *The Hindu* Group) and L.V. Navaneeth (CEO, *The Hindu* Group).

Speaking at the inauguration, Rohit Ramesh said, "We, at *The Hindu*, believe that journalism isn't just about reporting the news; it's about supporting the stories that build our community. Sports is one of the most powerful vehicles for that. It teaches discipline, resilience and the value of teamwork – lessons that go far beyond the football field."

The tournament was officially declared open by Korenaga, who kicked off the opening match between KC High International School and P.A.K. Palanisamy Higher Secondary School.

Gets the ball rolling: Daisuke Korenaga kicks off the first match as G.V. Selvam, Rohit Ramesh and L.V. Navaneeth look on. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

Winfield wins feature

HYDERABAD: Trainer Darius Byramji's grey mare Winfield, ridden by Neeraj Rawal, won the Mahabubabad Plate, the main event of Monday's (Aug. 31) races.

The winner is owned by Mr. Arun Alagappan rep. Arun Alagappan Racing LLP, Mr. Chandrakanth Kankaria & Mr. Haider Soomar.

1. A. KRISHNASWAMY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. III) (1,200M): STATE MAN (Dhanu S. Deora) 1, Vital Sign (B.R. Kumar) 2, Shadow Fax (Mukesh K) 3 and Dyanoosh (Afroz K) 4. Not run: Red Hot Punch. 7-1.2, 1-1/4 and 1. 1m, 13.90s. ₹37 (w), 17, 16 and 17 (p). SHP: 41, THP: 37, FP: 341, Q: 208, Tanala: 2, 868. Favourite: Tootsie Darling. Owner: Mr. Ravi Dunu Meghawat. Trainer: Magan Singh.

2. GADWAL PLATE (1,200M): SHE'S A BOMB (Mukesh Kumar) 1, Modin (Akshay K) 2, Vinfast (Neeraj) 3 and Gacchanmanasvin (M.S. Deora) 4. 9-1/4, 3 and 3/4. 1m, 13.68s. ₹53 (w), 13, 11 and 16 (p). SHP: 29, THP: 57, FP: 119, Q: 45, Tanala: 273. Favourite: Modin. Owners: Mr. G. Krishnamohan Rao, Mr. P. Ranga Raju & Mr. Mirza Ayub Baig. Trainer: D. Netto.

3. A. KRISHNASWAMY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200M): PERFECT ATTITUDE (Antony Raj S) 1, Home Run (Akshay K) 2, Arion One (B.R. Kumar) 3 and Federer (P. Ajeeth K) 4. 3-1/2, 2-3/4 and 6. 1m, 13.38s. ₹16 (w), 10, 10 and 12 (p). SHP: 20, THP: 24, FP: 28, Q: 18, Tanala: 44. Favourite: Perfect Attitude. Owners: Ms. Ameeta Mehra, Mr. Atul N. Amersey rep. by So Blest Trading Co. Pvt. Ltd & Mr. Rajan Agarwal. Trainer: Darius Byramji.

4. FATEH MAIDAN CLUB TROPHY (DIV. II) (1,400M): LAZARUS (Antony Raj S) 1, Dino (Akshay K) 2, Bold Beauty (Santos Raj) 3 and Sunny Day (P. Ajeeth K) 4. 4-1/2, 4-1/2 and 3/4. 1m, 27.32s. ₹24 (w), 10, 10 and 23 (p). SHP: 25, THP: 40, FP: 58, Q: 22, Tanala: 183. Favourite: Dino. Owner: Mr. S.A. Shezad Abbas. Trainer: Raza Shezad.

5. FATEH MAIDAN CLUB TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,400M): TIGER RUBY (Surya Prakash) 1, First Lady (Mukesh K) 2, Sadiya (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Dhanadeepa (B. Nikhil) 4. Not run: Noorian. Short Head, 9-3/4 and 1. 1m, 28.32s. ₹17 (w), 11, 11 and 11 (p). SHP: 29, THP: 49, FP: 43, Q: 29, Tanala: 170. Favourite: Tiger Ruby. Owners: Mr. Srinivasa Rao Mogli & Mr. Ravi Teja Addepalli. Trainer: M.F. Ali Khan.

6. A. KRISHNASWAMY MEMORIAL TROPHY (DIV. I) (1,200M): DARING SPIRIT (Akshay Kumar) 1, Turiya (Abhay Singh) 2, Mystical Dawn (P. Ajeeth K) 3 and Petra Act (D.S. Deora) 4. 2, 2 and 6-1/2. 1m, 13.87s. ₹19 (w), 10, 23 and 10 (p). SHP: 72, THP: 38, FP: 79, Q: 71, Tanala: 180. Favourite: Daring Spirit. Owners: M/s. Arun Alagappan Racing LLP, Mr. Chandrakant Kankaria & Mr. Bhaskar Shyamraju. Trainer: A. Imran Khan.

7. MAHABUBABAD PLATE (1,800M): WINFIELD (Neeraj Rawal) 1, N R I Triple Power (Shivam) 2, Andre (Antony Raj) 3 and Corte Madera (P. Sai K) 4. 7-1/4, Short Head and 3/4. 1m, 51.05s. ₹35 (w), 21, 13 and 23 (p). SHP: 38, THP: 32, FP: 89, Q: 43, Tanala: 158. Favourite: N R I Triple Power. Owners: Arun Alagappan rep. Arun Alagappan Racing LLP, Mr. Chandrakanth Kankaria & Mr. Haider Soomar. Trainer: Darius Byramji.

8. BHUPALPALLY PLATE (1,400M): DECEMBER CASPIAN (Mohit Singh) 1, Secret Option (A.A. Vikrant) 2, Beech Wood (Gaurav) 3 and American Gangster (T.S. Jodha) 4. 1-1/2, 2-1/4 and 4-1/2. 1m, 29.06s. ₹33 (w), 15, 15 and 20 (p). SHP: 87, THP: 54, FP: 301, Q: 226, Tanala: 863. Favourite: American Gangster. Owner: Mr. Gurjinder Singh. Trainer: Jasbir Singh.

Jackpot: 70%: ₹2,106 (296 tkts.) & 30%: 274 (970 tkts.).
Mini Jackpot: (i) 1,590 (144 tkts.), (ii) 246 (401 tkts.).
Treble: (i) 280 (88 tkts.), (ii) 151 (170 tkts.), (iii) 141 (347 tkts.).

AFP

Nobody can take away the piece of history I achieved

Enekwechi stresses he wants to stay consistent at the top level before his decline; says Nigerian throwers are grappling with infrastructure and funding issues

INTERVIEW

Chukwuebuka Enekwechi

Y.B. Sarangi

Chukwuebuka Enekwechi presents a fine example of how perseverance can reward an athlete. Despite funding issues, the Nigerian lived in the USA for years to pursue his studies and shot put career before ultimately writing a bit of sporting history. He became the first shot putter from his country to win gold at the Commonwealth Games, achieving the feat in Glasgow.

It was a moment of immense pride for the 33-year-old as he recorded a mark of 21.07m and pipped one of his idols, New Zealand's Worlds and Olympic medallist Tom Walsh. Fresh from his CWG glory, Enekwechi, who hails from the Anambra State, lived up to his billing by securing the top place with 20.78m at the World Athletics Continental Tour Silver meet at the Kalinga Stadium in Bhubaneswar.

During an interaction, he spoke about his journey, ambitions and his experience of competing in India.

How did you feel after becoming Nigeria's first shot putter to win gold at the Commonwealth Games?

It was amazing, especially at that moment. My life hasn't changed much, but it was a piece of history. It was a huge honour. Many people tried before me and came close. For me to be the first person in history, it's something that nobody can take away from me. And I made a lot of people proud and happy. That means the world to me.

You had clinched a silver in the 2018 CWG. What happened after that?

It was eight years ago. A lot can change in one year. I tried to get a medal in Birmingham (2022) but I didn't. I was fourth. The pressure doubled leading up to Glasgow. But I knew I had to stay consistent, work hard and take it extremely seriously. I prepared very well, but I was also a bit lucky to have that win. So I'm very grateful.

How did you get into shot put?

I just wanted to lift weights and I had to do something. I had to join a team to lift weights. So I joined athletics on a whim, and things just kept getting better and better.

What challenges do Nigerian throwers face?

It's mostly infrastructure issues. A lot of the attention goes towards sprints and events that already have funding from shoe companies. The throws (events) don't get much funding. That would make a big difference... some of it is like investing in coaching and facilities.

The other thing is that I've had a lot of international success. Maybe leaning into that, positioning me in a position where I can help out some of the young guys coming up. That would be a very big benefit for the nation.

Where do you train and how is the funding now?

Funding... it's not there. But I train in Lafayette, Indiana (USA). I went to school at Purdue University and that's where I train now. I moved there for schooling and after I graduated, I just stayed there and continued to train. I'm 10 years out of school, so I've been there for 15 years now.

What advice will you give to young Nigerian throwers?

Give yourself a chance because when you look at me, I'm not the biggest thrower. I'm probably the shortest guy in the field: I'm 180 centimetres tall. And if you looked at me, especially before I put on a lot of muscle, you would not have thought of me as world-class or as a 22-metre shot putter. But I took a chance on myself and I was able to execute it. What it means is that many more kids can do what I did or even better.

BISWARANJAN ROUT

Do you get the opportunity to go back to Nigeria?

Yeah, I go to Nigeria once or twice every year... for the National championships, for the sports festival. I take that opportunity to coach some of the local talent. Just kind of give them advice, give the coaches advice... just like there's so much support for the Indian talent. That's how I feel for my countrymen. I want them to succeed just as much as anybody would for their country. I do as much as I can to help.

What's your next goal?

I would love to get another major medal and improve my personal best. I'm 33 years old now, but every year I seem to find something new to add to my repertoire. I just want to keep improving. Before I start to decline, I just want to be consistent at a high level.

Do you have anything specific in mind?

I want to keep making finals and compete for a medal at major championships. That would be awesome.

Who are your inspirations?

Some of the guys who are still competing. I looked up to Joe Kovacs for a long time. He's one of the throwers who's not the biggest but super powerful and consistent. I followed him and added my own stuff to get to a world-class level.

And the funny thing is I'm like that for some younger throwers now. It's kind of full circle. Joe was a big inspiration for me... Reese Hoffa, Ryan Whiting and Adam Nelson. A lot of the guys who are still involved in the sport... even Walsh. We're not that different in terms of age, but he was achieving at such a high level when I was still in university. These guys are friends now. But I looked up to them and I kind of learned from them.

> One thing I can tell about India is that Indians are very proud of their culture. We had a good immersive experience — the music, meeting some of the dignitaries, the art styles, culture, food. This is my first time in India. New experiences are always welcome. I had a lot of fun.

Have you made some Indian friends?

Yeah. I met two of the local guys. I've known Tajinderpal Singh Toor for years now. I just met Samardeep Gill in Glasgow. In shot put, we're all competitors but we're also colleagues. So there's always respect in the first place. I know the guys were cheering each other on in between rounds. Even though we compete hard, there's a lot of support within the group.

How was the experience of coming to India and competing here?

It was very nice. One thing I can tell about India is that Indians are very proud of their culture. We had a good immersive experience. The music, meeting some of the dignitaries, the art styles, culture, food. We were immersed in the culture. I've been at it for 10 years now. This is my first time in India. New experiences are always welcome. I had a lot of fun.

What two districts can teach us about dealing with rural waste

Worldwide, around 2.7 billion people do not have their waste collected, and of them 2 billion live in rural areas, an analysis by the UN Environment Programme has found; where people cannot manage waste, they dump it on land or in rivers, streams, and seas, or burn it, a major concern in India

Mahima Jain
MAJULI/BENGALURU

On April 30, 2025, Bibhash Bormedhi looked on as a tonne of waste left Majuli on a boat across the Brahmaputra river. "This was the first time the waste from Majuli crossed the Brahmaputra, instead of being dumped into the river," Mr. Bormedhi, Project Manager at waste management non-profit Sahaas, which led the initiative, said.

On Independence Day 2024, in Arunachal Pradesh's Tawang District, villagers from Zemithang Circle sent away 4.4 tonnes of garbage in a lorry. Nestled in the folds of the Himalaya, between 6,900 feet and 8,000 feet high, they had segregated their waste for the first time. The truck made a 390-km journey lasting over 12 hours to scrap dealers in Tezpur, Assam.

Behind these efforts lay months of preparation, creative ways of financing, and a growing awareness that waste was becoming a mounting problem in the remotest corners of India.

Women in Gobuk, Upper Siang, Arunachal Pradesh, gather for the monthly 'Swachchata Divas', a collection drive where the community brings and segregates its household waste. FURTHER AND BEYOND FOUNDATION/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

'Data does not exist'

The country produces 1.7 lakh tonnes of waste every day, per the Central Pollution Control Board. Of this, 22% ends up in landfills and 17% is unaccounted for. Activists groups and experts have said data on rural waste are simply not counted at all.

"Waste data for rural areas doesn't exist," said Siddharth Singh, programme manager, Solid Waste Management and Circular Economy, Centre for Science and Environment (CSE), New Delhi. Urban and rural local bodies are tasked with solid waste management and data collection, including volumes and expenses, but they rarely do the needful, Mr. Singh added.

Earlier this month, the Supreme Court pulled up the Union and State governments for not institutionalising the Solid Waste Management Rules 2026. The court ordered that regulatory bodies must be notified, staffed, and provided with the necessary infrastructure to function effectively.

Data show a rise in per-capita spending in India's rural areas. More consumption also results in more waste.

"Food, beverages, personal care or hygiene products – almost everything is wrapped in plastics or multi-layered packaging," Mr. Singh said. "These goods have penetrated the remotest rural markets."

Waste management has not, however.

Worldwide, around 2.7 billion people do not have their waste collected – and of them 2 billion live in rural areas, an analysis by the UN Environment Programme (UNEP) found.

Where people cannot manage waste, they dump it on land or in rivers, streams, and seas, or they burn it, which is a major concern in India.

"In Majuli, people used to throw the waste in their fields or in the river," Brojen Pegu, a Majuli local, said. "When it flooded every year, the river carried the waste away."

For centuries, organic waste was used to feed livestock or as manure. But more plastics and other non-biodegradable materials have led to a mixed waste today, which is harder to decompose.

Majuli's method

Alakesh Gogoi, District Official, Swachh Bharat Mission and the Public Health Engineering Department, said his department built the Central Material Collection Facilities (CMCFs) in 19 of 20 panchayats and mini-collection facilities in most of the 160 villages between 2017 and 2022. However, neither were these tin sheds used nor were the workers mobilised. In 2024, Sahaas teamed up with the departments, he said.

A waste management system needs several other components besides CMCFs, according to Mr. Bormedhi.

Community participation goes hand-in-hand with operationalising collection and transportation.

Village leaders, homestay and hotel owners, schools and self-help groups participated in awareness programmes, and handed out bags for storage and segregation.

Simultaneously, the logistics of managing the non-biodegradable waste was fine-tuned, Mr. Bormedhi said.

This included funding, staffing, and training sanitation workers; arranging for vehicles for transport; operating the material collection facilities; and finding recyclers.

Today, garbage is collected in 19 of 20 panchayats despite the locals facing floods and erosion, Mr. Gogoi said.

A community-led model

In the land-locked and mountainous villages of Tawang, there was no escape for garbage.

Having sanitation workers collect garbage from door to door wouldn't work here because the settlements are scattered, Alifa Zibrani, senior project coordinator with Himalayan Fringes Project, Further and Beyond Foundation, a nonprofit focused on community-led waste management, said.

Instead, in 2024, through the Project, local officials and village leaders came together to pilot a community-led model of waste management in Chullyu in Keyi Panyor district. Within two years, the model had been adopted by a third of Tawang district and parts of Keyi Panyor and Upper Siang districts as well.

"Every household is responsible for segregating biodegradable and non-biodegradable waste. They store it in their homes. And then once a month, the community comes together and segregates the waste on a 'collection day'," Tashi Dondhup, additional deputy commissioner, Lumla Circle, which adopted the model as well, said.

Data show a rise in per-capita spending in India's rural areas, which also results in more waste; experts said that while 'food, beverages, personal care or hygiene products', almost all of which are 'wrapped in plastics', have 'penetrated the remotest rural markets', waste management has not

are also smaller community-led MRFs in Chullyu and Gobuk in Upper Siang.

Here, 12 full-time MRF operators and dozens of women from self-help groups perform the secondary sorting, into 35 categories.

The locals also wash and dry sanitary napkins and diapers, which are also stored at MRFs. More than 20 tonnes have been sold to recyclers, generating a revenue of ₹3.53 lakh.

Villagers gather during a waste-collection drive in Taksang, Zemithang Circle, Tawang District. Taksang is 11,000 feet above the sea level. FURTHER AND BEYOND FOUNDATION/SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

"We don't have any sanitation workers. Every village organises a collection day called *Swachchata Divas* (Cleanliness Day)," Ms. Zibrani said. A designated location in the village becomes the collection and sorting point, where "residents gather with sacks full of waste, and sort it into 22 categories. Some even clean the streets along the way."

So far, 26 villages that are part of the project have organised more than 150 *Swachchata Divas* and collected 30 tonnes of waste. The waste is taken to material recovery facilities (MRF), sites in Zemithang, Lumla and Daporijo where it is received, sorted, and processed. There

Monthly fee

Per the UNEP, the most expensive step in the waste management chain is collection: in the form of crew wages, vehicle fuel and maintenance, insurance, and other indirect costs. A recent CSE report on plastic waste management, which Mr. Singh co-authored, also found that primary collection and transportation account for the bulk of costs in Indian cities.

The report examined the case of rural Dharamshala, where nearly 50% of the primary collection cost was attributed to manpower.

The Himalayan Fringes Project eliminated the costs associated with sanitation workers and door-to-door collection. And to keep the operations financially sustainable, the community has set up accountability and independent financing mechanisms. Specifically, each region has a central committee chaired by a Circle Officer and a Lama (an influential religious leader) as secretary. At the village level, a *gaon bura* (village head) and a treasurer lead the committees that draft waste management policies, and set the rules, responsibilities, and fines. They meet every quarter.

Households are asked to pay a monthly fee of ₹50. Shops and cafes pay ₹100.

"Money is the biggest problem to run such a system," Deewan Mara, former Zemithang Circle Officer, now officer and district magistrate, Daporijo, and a State Silver Medal winner for his work on managing waste, said.

First and last mile

Majuli's 1.67 lakh people are served by 37 sanitation workers and 19 sorting staff.

Mridul Das, 38, from Silakola is one of them. Most people segregate their waste, he said. "But in every 100 households there may be 30 who still give mixed waste. They don't listen."

Recently, Mr. Gogoi's department and the Panchayat and Rural Development Department purchased 21 e-vehicles – including the one Mr. Das drives – and 15 tricycles, and approved funds for the collection crew.

The transportation cost to recyclers is high in rural areas because the waste travels farther, Mr. Singh said, rendering the task less attractive for scrap dealers.

Ms. Zibrani said it costs ₹45,000 to send one truckload of waste from Arunachal Pradesh to Assam. Initially, the locals in Tawang volunteered their vehicles for collection. But over time, the project's success drew the attention of Senior State government officials, who donated a truck. Yet the cost of fuel and driver is still Rs 20,000 per trip, she added. Apart from this, some two tonnes of multi-layered plastics were sent to a processing plant at Lhou in Jang sub-division, where it was used to make paver blocks, Mr. Dondhup said.

'Show a way'

Between April 2025 and May 2026, Majuli transferred 16.78 tonnes of waste and earned ₹1.47 lakh. Mr. Bormedhi said there have been three boat transfers, which are expensive, so now Majuli sells its waste to local scrap dealers as well.

However, there have been no takers for black polythene and textile scrap, and Majuli's long-defunct plastics management facility is undergoing repairs. Many CMCFs are also filling up quickly.

According to Mr. Singh, it is not uncommon to find rural collection facilities filled to the brim with baled waste, and with few takers. Mr. Bormedhi is not discouraged, however. Since 2024, Majuli has collected 82.4 tonnes of waste and thus prevented it from ending up in the Brahmaputra and the ocean, he said.

"All we are trying to do is to show a way. A model where rural waste management can work."

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NASA astronaut evaluates the AstroRad vest onboard the International Space Station in 2022. 2S0CKZ (CC BY-SA)

AstroRad vest offers lighter shield against solar storms

Vasudevan Mukunth

Despite their best efforts to settle the moon and later Mars, humans may never become a spacefaring species, more than a few experts have said over the years. An important reason for this view is radiation. The earth has a magnetic field that keeps harmful radiation at bay, but astronauts who fly beyond this field are at risk of developing cancer and other serious health problems.

A common fix for this problem has been to add more shielding for astronauts. However, every additional kilogram increases the launch cost by a large amount, and it is often also impractical to add enough shielding to a crew capsule to cope with a major outburst of radiation from the sun.

To this end, an Israeli company named StemRad has, along with Lockheed Martin, developed a vest called AstroRad. StemRad had originally made the suit for emergency responders on the ground

Radiation remains a major obstacle to long duration human spaceflight because astronauts beyond earth's magnetic field face increased risks of cancer and other health problems

who may be exposed to nuclear radiation. The company adapted it for spaceflight, with a twist: AstroRad has more safeguards over the chest, abdomen, and pelvis, where there are large amounts of bone marrow, which make blood, and sensitive organs like the heart and the lungs. It also uses hydrogen-rich polymers to block radiation – materials rich in hydrogen slow energetic particles efficiently because hydrogen nuclei are similar in mass and so maximise energy transfer during collisions – rather than lead, which is more dense.

In 2019 and 2020, NASA arranged for astronauts to test AstroRad onboard the International Space Station. They wore it as they performed ordinary activities and gave feedback on its comfort and functionalities, allowing engineers on the ground to make improvements.

NASA tested the improved version onboard its Artemis I mission in 2022. In this mission, the crew capsule carried two human-shaped dummies named Helga and Zohar as it travelled around the moon before returning to the earth. Both Helga and Zohar were fit with materials designed to mimic human tissue as well as radiation sensors. Zohar wrote AstroRad while Helga did not.

The results of analysing the data retrieved from the dummies were published in *Science Advances* on August 12. Using data collected during Artemis I to inform models of historical solar radiation events, researchers – from StemRad, Lockheed, the German, Israeli, and U.S. space agencies, and institutions in the U.S. – found AstroRad could reduce the effective radiation dose an astronaut would have received during the August 1972 solar storm by 60% and during the October 1989 solar storm by 40%. These amount to 193 and 131 fewer days, respectively of exposure to deep-space radiation.

Per the team, for astronauts heading back to the moon and eventually to Mars, AstroRad could allow astronauts to partially work through a solar storm instead of having to shelter themselves for the duration – a small but important step towards making interplanetary human spaceflight a safe reality.

That said, one particular shortcoming of the vest is that it can only deal with particles from the sun. Galactic cosmic rays that originate beyond the solar system remain harder to block.

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